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6000: Sin and salvation

- 6010: Sin
- 6100: Aspects of sin
- 6500: Salvation
- 6600: Aspects of salvation

6010: Sin

- 6020: sin
- 6040: sinners

6020: sin

Primarily a wrong relationship with God, which may express itself in wrong attitudes or actions towards God himself, other human beings, possessions or the environment. Scripture stresses that this condition is deeply rooted in human nature, and that only God is able to break its penalty, power and presence.

6021: sin, nature of

Scripture portrays sin in terms of wrongness before God in a variety of different ways, such as uncleanness, guilt or rebellion.

The basic nature of sin

All sin is directed against God

PSA 51:4 See also GEN 13:13; EXO 10:16; JDG 10:10; PSA 41:4; LUK 15:18

Sin is essentially a lack of faith in God

ROM 14:23 See also HEB 11:6

Descriptions of sin

Corruption of God's good purposes

DEU 32:5 See also GEN 6:11–6:12; DEU 9:12, DEU 31:29; JDG 2:19

Doing evil in God's sight

JHN 3:19–3:20 See also JDG 2:11; PSA 34:12–34:16; PRO 8:13; ISA 59:6–59:7; MAT 12:35 parallel LUK 6:45

Ungodliness

JUD 1:14–1:15 See also ISA 9:17, ISA 32:6; 1TI 1:9

Rebellion against God's authority

ISA 30:9 See also DEU 9:7; 1SA 15:23; PSA 78:40, PSA 78:56; JER 3:13; HOS 7:13

The breaking or transgression of God's laws

1JN 3:4 See also 1SA 13:13–13:14; 1CH 10:13; NEH 9:29; MIC 1:5, MIC 7:18; ROM 2:23, ROM 4:15, ROM 5:14–5:17; JAS 2:10–2:11

Straying from the right path

ISA 53:6 See also PSA 58:3, PSA 95:10, PSA 119:10, PSA 119:21, PSA 119:118

Incurring a debt

MAT 6:12 See also MAT 18:21–18:35

Falling short of a standard

ROM 3:23 The words most commonly used for “sin” in the OT and NT originally signified “missing the mark”.

Uncleanness

PSA 51:2; ISA 1:16 See also PSA 51:7; HEB 9:14

Kinds of sin

Sins of omission

JAS 4:17 See also MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42; MAT 25:45

Deliberate sins

LUK 12:47 See also NUM 15:30–15:31; DEU 1:42–1:43, DEU 17:12; PSA 19:13; ISA 57:17; ROM 1:32

Unintentional sins

LUK 12:48 See also LEV 4:1–4:5; NUM 15:22–15:29; DEU 4:41–4:42; ACT 3:17; 1TI 1:13

Sin against the Holy Spirit

MRK 3:29–3:30 parallels MAT 12:31–12:32, LUK 12:10 See also 1JN 5:16

6022: sin, causes of

Sin is the result of the fall, at which the creation rebels against God its Creator.

Sin as a result of the devil's activity

The devil's instigation of the first sin

GEN 3:13 See also GEN 3:1–3:6; 2CO 11:3; REV 12:9

The devil's role as tempter

1TH 3:5 See also MAT 4:1–4:11 parallels MRK 1:12–1:13, LUK 4:1–4:13; MAT 6:13

The devil as the source of sinful behaviour

JHN 8:44 See also JHN 8:38, JHN 8:41; 1JN 3:8, 1JN 3:10

The sins of angels

2PE 2:4 See also JUD 1:6

Sin as a power in the world

Sin's reign from the time of Adam

ROM 5:12 See also GEN 4:7; JHN 8:34; ROM 5:21, ROM 6:16

Sin uses the law to provoke sinful desires

ROM 7:5 See also ROM 7:7–7:12; 1CO 15:56

The world is under sin's dominion

1JN 2:16 See also LUK 21:34; TIT 2:12

Sin is rooted in human nature

The human heart is dominated by sin

JER 17:9 See also MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21–7:22; ROM 1:24; HEB 3:12

Human nature is fundamentally opposed to God

ROM 8:5–8:8 See also ROM 7:14–7:25; GAL 5:17–5:21; EPH 2:3; 2PE 2:10, 2PE 2:18

The act of sinning

Sin results from giving in to evil desires

JAS 1:14–1:15 See also ROM 13:13–13:14; JAS 4:1; JUD 1:16

Sin results from the human desire to be like God

GEN 3:5 See also ISA 14:12–14:14; EZK 28:2

Sin results when the body is placed at sin's disposal

ROM 6:13 See also MAT 5:29–5:30, MAT 18:8–18:9 parallel MRK 9:43–9:47

Sin results from the influence of others

1CO 15:33 See also EXO 23:33; 1KI 11:3; PRO 1:10, PRO 22:24–22:25

The seriousness of leading others into sin

MRK 9:42 parallels MAT 18:6, LUK 17:1–17:2 See also 1CO 8:9–8:13

6023: sin, universality of

All human beings sin and are guilty in the sight of God on account of an inherently sinful disposition, which can be traced back to Adam. Acts of sin thus arise from a sinful human heart. The basis of cleansing and cancellation of “original sin” is the atoning death of Jesus Christ.

Adam, the cause of universal sin

ROM 5:19 See also GEN 3:1–3:24; ROM 5:12; 1CO 15:22

The universe is in subjection to sin

GAL 3:22 See also ROM 5:21, ROM 11:32

Sin is inherent in human nature

Sinfulness from birth

PSA 51:5 See also JOB 25:4; PSA 58:3

The sinful heart

GEN 6:5 See also GEN 8:21; ECC 9:3; JER 17:9; MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21

The sinful nature

EPH 2:3 See also ROM 8:6–8:8; GAL 5:19–5:21

The universality of sin

No-one is righteous

ROM 3:9–3:19 See also PSA 5:9, PSA 10:7, PSA 14:1–14:3 parallel PSA 53:1–53:3; PSA 36:1, PSA 140:3; ISA 59:7–59:8

All have sinned

ROM 3:23 See also GEN 6:11–6:12; 1KI 8:46 parallel 2CH 6:36; ECC 7:20; ISA 53:6; ROM 1:18–1:32; JAS 3:2

Everyone is sinful in God's sight

1JN 1:8 See also PSA 130:3, PSA 143:2; PRO 20:9; ISA 64:6–64:7; MAT 19:17 parallels MRK 10:18, LUK 18:19; 1JN 1:10

Some characters in Scripture are described as being blameless in comparison with their contemporaries

GEN 5:24 Enoch; ; GEN 6:9 Noah; ; 1KI 15:5 David

Jesus Christ alone is sinless

HEB 4:15; 1PE 2:22 See also ISA 53:9; LUK 23:47; 2CO 5:21; HEB 7:26; 1JN 3:5

6024: sin, effects of

Sin affects every level of human existence, including the sinner's relationship with God, with other human beings and with the environment.

The effects of sin on individuals

Lack of peace of mind

ISA 57:20–57:21 See also JOB 15:20–15:35; PSA 38:5–38:8; PRO 13:15–13:22; LAM 1:20–1:21

Bondage to a continuing habit of sin

JHN 8:34 See also PRO 5:22; ROM 6:16; 2TI 2:16

Physical death

1CO 15:56 See also GEN 2:17, GEN 3:19; PRO 21:16; ROM 5:12–5:14, ROM 6:21–6:23; 1CO 15:22; JAS 1:15

The sinful life is equivalent to death

EPH 2:1 See also ROM 7:9, ROM 7:13, ROM 8:10; COL 2:13

The effects of sin on the sinner before God

Uncleanness

ISA 64:6 See also PSA 106:39; ISA 6:5; JER 2:22; LAM 1:8; MAT 15:18–15:20 parallel MRK 7:20–7:23

Guilt

EZR 9:6 The prayer of Ezra. See also GEN 3:10; PSA 38:3–38:4, PSA 44:15; ISA 59:12–59:13; JER 3:25, JER 14:20

Separation from God

ISA 59:2 See also DEU 31:18; ISA 1:15, ISA 64:7; EZK 8:6; HOS 5:6; MIC 3:4; EPH 2:12

The effects of sin on Israel

PRO 14:34 See also JOS 7:1–7:16 Achan's sin; 1KI 8:33–8:40 the consequences of sin for Israel; ISA 1:4–1:9 the plight of Judah; ROM 1:21–1:32 the condition of humanity

The effects of sin on the world

The ground cursed

GEN 3:17–3:18 See also JER 12:13; ROM 8:20–8:22

The land polluted

LEV 18:25 See also GEN 4:10–4:12; NUM 35:33–35:34; PSA 106:38; ISA 24:4–24:6; JER 3:1

6025: sin, and God's character

In his righteousness and holiness, God detests sin and its effects upon humanity. In his mercy and grace, he makes available a means of atonement, by the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.

God's character and sin

God himself is perfect

HAB 1:13; 1JN 1:5 See also DEU 32:4; JOS 24:19; PSA 97:2; ISA 6:3

Jesus Christ is sinless

1PE 2:22 See also ISA 53:9; 2CO 5:21; HEB 1:9; HEB 7:26–7:27; 1JN 3:5

God's people are to be holy

1PE 1:15–1:16 See also LEV 11:44; LEV 11:45; LEV 19:2; LEV 20:7; MAT 5:48; 1TH 4:7; 1JN 3:3

God's attitude to sin

God knows all sin

JER 16:17 See also JOB 10:14; PSA 139:1–139:4; JER 2:22; HOS 7:2; AMO 5:12; HEB 4:13

God grieves over sin

GEN 6:6 See also ISA 63:10; EPH 4:30

God hates sin

PSA 11:5 See also DEU 25:16; 2SA 11:27; PSA 5:5; PRO 6:16–6:19; ZEC 8:17; LUK 16:15

Sin provokes God's anger

ROM 1:18 See also 2CH 36:16; EZK 20:8; AMO 1:3; JHN 3:36; EPH 5:5–5:6; COL 3:5–3:6

God is also merciful and gracious

EXO 34:6–34:7 See also NEH 9:17; NEH 9:31; PSA 78:38; PSA 103:8–103:14; LAM 3:22–3:23; MIC 7:18–7:19; ROM 11:32

God's patience with sinners

2PE 3:9 See also ROM 2:4; ROM 9:22; 1TI 1:16

Jesus Christ is the supreme revelation of God's love for sinners

Jesus Christ's ministry of forgiveness

1TI 1:15 See also MAT 9:2 parallels MRK 2:5; LUK 5:20–5:21; LUK 7:36–7:50; LUK 15:1–15:10; LUK 19:5–19:10; JHN 8:1–8:11

God's love shown in Jesus Christ's death

ROM 5:8 See also JHN 3:16–3:17; EPH 2:4; 1PE 3:18; 1JN 4:9–4:10

The risen Christ gives grace to sinful people

1JN 2:1 See also ROM 8:34; HEB 2:17–2:18; HEB 4:15–5:2

6026: sin, God's judgment on

Sin comes under the judgment of God, in that it contradicts his nature and opposes his purposes.

God's judgment on sin

God is the judge of sin

ISA 26:21 See also PSA 99:8; ISA 13:11; AMO 3:14; ZEP 1:12; 1TH 4:6

God's judgment is certain

ROM 2:12 See also PSA 37:38; PRO 11:21; HEB 9:27

God's judgment is in proportion to the seriousness of the sin

JER 21:14 See also DEU 25:2; ISA 59:18; MAT 7:1–7:5; LUK 12:47–12:48; ROM 2:5–2:6

God's judgment under the Sinaitic covenant

EXO 20:5 parallel DEU 5:9 The Sinaitic covenant makes references to the judgment of future generations for the sins of their parents but, as a principle, this is abolished by later prophets. LEV 26:14–26:39; ; DEU 28:15–28:68; JER 31:29–31:30; ; EZK 18:1–18:32

John the Baptist and Jesus Christ warn of judgment

MAT 3:10 parallel LUK 3:9 See also MAT 3:12; MAT 7:19; MAT 12:36–12:37; MRK 9:42–9:49

Ways in which God judges sin

God causes sin to bring evil to the sinner

2CH 6:23 See also DEU 19:19; EST 7:10; PSA 7:15–7:16; ISA 30:13

God abandons people

ISA 64:7 See also DEU 31:17–31:18; JOS 7:11–7:12; LAM 4:16; EZK 39:23–39:24

Unrepentant sinners to be expelled from the church

MAT 18:17 See also 1CO 5:1–5:13

God exercises judgment through a country's legal system

1PE 2:14 See also ROM 13:3–13:4

Untimely death is God's judgment on all sin

GEN 2:17 See also LEV 20:1–20:17; 1CH 10:13; PRO 11:19; ROM 1:32; 1CO 11:29–11:30

Sinners are excluded from the kingdom of God

REV 22:15 See also 1CO 6:9–6:10; GAL 5:9–5:21; REV 21:27

Occasions of God's judgment on sin**OT examples**

GEN 3:16–3:24 expulsion from Eden; ; GEN 6:1–7:24 the flood; ; GEN 18:20–19:29 Sodom and Gomorrah; ; DEU 9:1–9:5 The Canaanites (the Anakites were earlier inhabitants of Canaan).; 2KI 17:7–17:23, 2KI 24:10–24:20

The destruction of Jerusalem

LUK 11:47–11:51, LUK 13:34–13:35

God's final judgment of the world

REV 21:8 See also ISA 66:24; MAT 25:31–25:46; 2TH 1:8–1:9; 2PE 3:7; JUD 1:7

6027: sin, God's remedy for

Under the old covenant, sin was forgiven through sacrifice, prefiguring the atoning death of Jesus Christ, which brings forgiveness of sins under the new covenant.

Atonement for sins in the OT was through the shedding of blood

LEV 17:11

Kinds of sin offering in the OT

The sin offering was for unintentional sins

LEV 4:1–5:13 See also NUM 15:22–15:31

The guilt offering was for unintentional sins, where restitution was required

LEV 5:14–6:7 See also NUM 5:5–5:10

The annual Day of Atonement cleansed the nation of sin

LEV 16:1–16:34 See also EXO 30:11–30:16; LEV 23:26–23:32; HEB 9:7

The priests made atonement on occasions of deliberate national sin

NUM 16:46–16:48 Aaron stops the plague after Korah's sin; ; NUM 25:13 Phinehas stops the plague after Moab caused Israel to sin.

Sacrifices of atonement needed to be accompanied by repentance and a willingness to obey

Worshippers recognised the need for repentance and obedience

PRO 21:3 See also PSA 40:6–40:8, PSA 51:16–51:17

The prophets declared the need for obedience

ISA 15:22 See also ISA 1:11–1:17; JER 7:21–7:23; HOS 6:6; MIC 6:6–6:8

The prophets warned of judgment to bring people to repentance

2KI 17:13 See also ISA 31:6–31:7; JER 4:1–4:4, JER 35:15; EZK 3:16–3:19; JON 3:4–3:10

The death of Jesus Christ brings forgiveness for sin

Jesus Christ died on behalf of sinful humanity

ROM 5:6 See also MAT 26:26–26:28; JHN 10:11, JHN 15:13; GAL 2:20

The early church proclaimed that Christ died for the sins of others

1CO 15:3 See also ROM 4:25; GAL 1:4; 1PE 3:18

Jesus Christ bore sin on the cross

2CO 5:21 See also ISA 53:10–53:12; HEB 9:28; 1PE 2:24

Jesus Christ has redeemed people by taking their place

MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45 See also GAL 3:13; 1TI 2:6; TIT 2:14

Jesus Christ's death is sacrificial

ROM 3:25 See also ROM 8:3; 1CO 5:7; EPH 5:2; HEB 7:27, HEB 10:5–10:13; 1JN 2:2, 1JN 4:10

The shedding of Jesus Christ's blood brings forgiveness

1JN 1:7 See also JHN 1:29; EPH 1:7; HEB 9:12–9:22, HEB 13:12; 1PE 1:18–1:19; REV 7:14

6028: sin, God's deliverance from

The gospel reveals the purpose and power of God to deal with sin and all of its effects. Scripture uses a range of images to express the comprehensiveness of salvation.

God's removal of sin

Atonement for sin

ISA 6:7 See also EXO 32:30; LEV 4:27–4:31; PRO 16:6; ROM 3:25; HEB 2:17

Forgiveness of sin

MIC 7:18; ACT 13:38 See also 1KI 8:35–8:36; 2CH 30:18–30:20; PSA 103:2–103:3; ISA 33:24, ISA 55:7; JOL 3:21; MAT 26:27–26:28; LUK 24:46–24:47; EPH 1:7; 1JN 1:9

Cancellation of a debt

MAT 6:12 See also MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 7:41–7:50

A covering over of sin

1PE 4:8 There is a close relation between “covering over sin” and “atoning for sin”. See also PSA 32:1, PSA 85:2; JAS 5:20

The taking away of sin

PSA 103:12 See also 2SA 12:13; ISA 6:6–6:7; ZEC 3:4; JHN 1:29; HEB 9:28; 1JN 3:5

Remembering sin no more

ISA 43:25 See also PSA 25:7; JER 31:33–31:34; 2CO 5:19

God’s deliverance for the sinner**The salvation of the sinner**

1TI 1:15 See also PSA 28:8–28:9; MAT 1:21; LUK 19:9–19:10; JHN 3:17; HEB 7:25

The image of healing

LUK 5:31–5:32 parallels MAT 9:12, MRK 2:17 See also 2CH 7:14; ISA 53:5, ISA 57:18–57:19; HOS 14:4; 1PE 2:24

The image of cleansing

PSA 51:2 See also LEV 16:30; EZK 36:25; JHN 13:1–13:11; ACT 22:16; HEB 10:22; 1JN 1:9

Redemption by God

PSA 130:8 See also ISA 44:22; TIT 2:14; 1PE 1:18–1:19

Justification before God

GAL 2:16 See also ISA 53:11; ROM 3:24–3:26, ROM 4:5, ROM 4:25, ROM 5:16–5:19, ROM 8:33

Freedom from condemnation

ROM 8:1 See also JHN 3:18, JHN 8:3–8:11; ROM 8:34

Peace with God

ROM 5:1 See also ISA 53:5; LUK 2:14; EPH 2:17

Reconciliation with God

2CO 5:18 See also ROM 5:9–5:11; COL 1:19–1:20

Sanctification to God

HEB 10:10 See also 1CO 6:11; EPH 5:25–5:26; COL 1:22

Freedom from sin and the sinful nature

ROM 7:24; 1PE 2:24 See also ROM 6:1–6:18, ROM 8:1–8:9; GAL 5:24

A transition from death to life

COL 2:13 See also LUK 15:22–15:24; EPH 2:4–2:5

Receiving eternal life

ROM 6:23 See also JHN 3:16, JHN 3:36, JHN 5:24

6029: sin, accepting forgiveness of

Sinners must respond to God’s offer of forgiveness through faith in Jesus Christ.

The conviction of sin

LAM 1:20; JHN 16:8–16:9 See also 1KI 8:38–8:40; ISA 6:5; EZK 33:10–33:11; ACT 16:29

The inward response of faith

ACT 16:31 See also MRK 1:14–1:15; JHN 3:36, JHN 5:24; ACT 13:38–13:39, ACT 16:25–16:34; ROM 3:22–3:26, ROM 10:8–10:10; EPH 2:8

The outward response of baptism

ACT 22:16 See also MRK 1:4–1:5 parallels MAT 3:1–3:6, LUK 3:2–3:6; ACT 2:38, ACT 8:36; COL 2:11–2:12; 1PE 3:21

Confession of sin

PRO 28:13; 1JN 1:9 See also LEV 16:20–16:22, LEV 26:40–26:42; 2SA 12:13; PSA 32:3–32:5; LAM 3:40; LUK 15:17–15:20; ACT 19:18

Repentance**Turning towards God**

ACT 3:19 See also 2CH 6:36–6:39; ISA 55:7; EZK 18:21; MAT 3:1–3:2 parallels MRK 1:4, LUK 3:2; ACT 17:30; 2CO 7:10; 1TH 1:9

Turning away from sin

JHN 8:11 See also JER 4:3–4:4; LUK 19:1–19:10; JHN 5:14; ROM 6:11–6:14; 1PE 2:11

The making of restitution

LUK 19:8 See also LEV 6:1–6:7; NUM 5:6–5:8; PRO 6:30–6:31; EZK 33:12–33:16

The forgiveness of others

LUK 11:4 parallel MAT 6:12 See also MAT 6:14–6:15, MAT 18:21–18:35; MRK 11:25; EPH 4:32; COL 3:13

6030: sin, avoidance of

God calls his people to avoid sin, and through Jesus Christ gives them the inner power to be victorious over it.

God’s people are to resist sin

1PE 2:11 See also PSA 97:10; PRO 4:23–4:27; 1CO 15:34; EPH 4:25–5:20; JAS 1:21

The Christian life is a constant struggle against sin

HEB 3:13 See also ACT 20:28; ROM 7:14–7:25; EPH 6:10–6:18; 1PE 5:8–5:9

God helps his people to resist sin**Release from sin through Jesus Christ’s death**

1PE 2:24 See also ROM 6:1–6:7; GAL 2:20, GAL 5:24; COL 2:11–2:12

The avoidance of sin through new life in Jesus Christ
1JN 3:9 See also 2CO 5:17; 1PE 1:23; 1JN 3:6, 1JN 5:18

Believers co-operate with Jesus Christ to avoid sin

PHP 2:12–2:13

Believers are to put to death what is sinful in them
COL 3:5 See also ROM 6:11–6:14, ROM 8:13

Believers are to exchange sinful for righteous behaviour

ROM 13:12–13:14 The words used here, and in similar passages, are those used for “taking off” old clothes and “putting on” new ones. See also EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:7–3:10; 1TI 6:11; 2TI 2:22

Believers are to allow the Spirit to inform and direct their conduct

ROM 12:2 See also ROM 8:5–8:8; GAL 5:16–5:25

Practical steps for overcoming sin and temptation

Meditation on Scripture

PSA 119:11 See also PSA 18:22–18:23; MAT 4:1–4:11 parallel LUK 4:1–4:13; 2TI 3:16–3:17

Prayerful dependence upon God

MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4 See also PSA 19:13; MAT 26:41; 1CO 10:13; HEB 4:15–4:16

Active seeking of the good

ROM 6:19 See also PSA 34:14; ISA 1:16–1:17; AMO 5:14–5:15; 1TH 5:22; 3JN 1:11

Incentives for avoiding sin

The fear of God

PRO 16:6 See also EXO 20:20; PRO 3:7, PRO 8:13

The holiness of God

1PE 1:15–1:16 See also LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7; 1CO 6:18–6:20; 1TH 4:7

The expectation of Jesus Christ’s return

1PE 4:7 See also 2CO 5:9–5:10; 1TH 5:4–5:6; 2PE 3:10–3:14

A consideration of the consequences of sin

GAL 6:7–6:8 See also MRK 9:42–9:48; ROM 6:21–6:23; HEB 6:7–6:8, HEB 10:26–10:31

The need to be a good witness to unbelievers

1PE 2:15 See also 1PE 3:1–3:2, 1PE 3:15–3:16

The role of others in avoiding sin

Bad company is to be avoided

1CO 15:33 See also DEU 7:1–7:4; PSA 1:1; PRO 1:10; 1CO 5:1–5:13

A good example is to be followed

1CO 11:1 See also PHP 3:17, PHP 4:9; HEB 12:1–12:3; 1PE 4:1–4:3

Believers are to support one another

JAS 5:19–5:20 See also MAT 18:15–18:17; GAL 6:1–6:2; 1TI 5:20; HEB 3:12

6040: sinners

All who have sinned. The term tends to be used in particular of those regarded as outside God’s covenant of grace, whose sins are therefore not forgiven.

The universality of sinful behaviour

Only Jesus Christ is sinless

1PE 2:22 See also ISA 53:9; 2CO 5:21; HEB 4:15, HEB 7:26; 1JN 3:5

Everyone else has sinned

GAL 3:22 See also 1KI 8:46; ROM 3:9–3:19, ROM 3:23, ROM 5:12, ROM 5:19

God’s mercy towards sinners

God graciously extends mercy to sinners within the covenant

PSA 25:8–25:10 See also 1KI 8:30; PSA 86:5, PSA 130:8; DAN 9:9; 1JN 1:9

Jesus Christ died for sinners

ROM 5:8; 1TI 1:15 See also ROM 8:3

Sinners as those whose behaviour excludes them from God’s covenant

Prostitutes, tax collectors, idolatrous Gentiles and the ungodly

LUK 15:1 See also DEU 23:17–23:18; 1SA 15:18; LUK 3:12, LUK 7:37–7:38; GAL 2:15; 1TH 4:5; 1PE 4:18; PRO 11:31; 2PE 2:5–2:6

Such sinners shunned by the Jews

LUK 7:39 See also PSA 1:1; PRO 1:10–1:16

The judgment of sinners

Prayers seeking their judgment

PSA 104:35 See also PSA 109:6–109:20, PSA 137:7–137:9, PSA 139:19

They are cut off from God

ISA 59:2 See also PSA 66:18; PRO 15:29; ISA 1:15; JHN 9:31; 1CO 6:9–6:10

They receive their just reward

PRO 13:21–13:22 See also PSA 1:5, PSA 34:16, PSA 37:38; ECC 2:26

Prophecies of their judgment**ISA 1:28** See also ISA 13:9, ISA 33:14; JER 4:18; AMO 9:10**Their final judgment****2PE 3:7** See also ISA 66:24; 2TH 1:8–1:9; 2PE 2:9; JUD 1:15**Jesus Christ's attitude towards sinners****Jesus Christ's association with sinners****MAT 9:9–9:13** parallels MRK 2:14–2:17, LUK 5:27–5:32
Jesus Christ's attitude and behaviour were radically different from that of his contemporaries. See also LUK 15:1–15:10, LUK 19:5–19:10; ROM 5:8; 1TI 1:15–1:16**Jesus Christ extended God's forgiveness to sinners and welcomed them into his kingdom****MAT 21:31–21:32** See also MAT 9:2–9:7 parallels MRK 2:3–2:12, LUK 5:18–5:25; LUK 7:40–7:50, LUK 15:11–15:32, LUK 18:9–18:14, LUK 19:9; JHN 8:3–8:11**Jesus Christ's behaviour led to accusations that he himself was a sinner**

JHN 9:16, JHN 9:24

Jesus Christ's refusal to accept sinful behaviour**JHN 8:10–8:11** See also MAT 4:17, MAT 18:8–18:9 parallel MRK 9:43–9:48; JHN 5:14**Jesus Christ's use of the example of sinners to teach his disciples****LUK 6:32–6:34** parallel MAT 5:46–5:47 See also LUK 16:1–16:9**Sinners in the church****Those who fall into sin should be restored****JAS 5:19–5:20** See also PSA 51:13; MAT 18:12–18:15; GAL 6:1**Unrepentant sinners should be expelled****MAT 18:15–18:17** See also 1CO 5:9–5:11**6100: Aspects of sin**

- 6103: abomination
- 6106: addiction
- 6109: alienation
- 6112: banishment
- 6115: blame
- 6118: blemish
- 6121: boasting
- 6124: condemnation
- 6130: corruption
- 6133: coveting
- 6139: deadness, spiritual
- 6142: decay
- 6145: deceit
- 6151: dirt
- 6154: fall, the

- 6160: fathers, sin of the
- 6163: faults
- 6166: flesh, sinful nature
- 6169: godlessness
- 6172: guilt
- 6178: hardness of heart
- 6181: ignorance
- 6184: imagination
- 6187: immorality
- 6193: impenitence
- 6199: imperfection
- 6203: mortality
- 6206: offence
- 6209: pagans
- 6212: participation
- 6218: provoking God
- 6221: rebellion
- 6227: regret
- 6230: rejection
- 6236: sexual sin
- 6245: stubbornness
- 6248: temptation
- 6257: unbelievers
- 6260: uncircumcised

6103: abomination

That which is utterly detestable in the sight of God, particularly sin and idolatry. Daniel predicts the establishment of an “abomination that causes desolation” on the temple mount and Jesus Christ reiterates this prophecy.

Sin is an abomination**God detests it****LEV 20:13; PRO 26:24–26:26** See also LEV 18:26–18:30; PRO 6:16–6:19, PRO 28:9; ISA 66:3–66:4**The abomination of Babylon the Great****REV 17:3–17:6** See also JER 51:6–51:8; REV 14:8, REV 19:1–19:2**Idolatry is an abomination****JER 32:32–32:35** DEU 7:25–7:26, DEU 12:31, DEU 18:9–18:13, DEU 27:15, DEU 29:17–29:18; DEU 32:15–32:16; 1KI 11:4–11:8; ; 2KI 23:13; ISA 44:19; ; JER 4:1–4:2, JER 7:30, JER 16:18; ; EZK 5:9, EZK 7:20, EZK 8:5–8:18 idolatry in the temple; ; EZK 11:17–11:21, EZK 20:30; ; HOS 9:10; ; 1PE 4:3**Unclean animals are an abomination****ISA 66:17** See also LEV 7:21, LEV 11:13–11:20, LEV 11:41–11:42; ISA 65:2–65:5; REV 18:2

The abomination that causes desolation

DAN 9:25–9:27 See also DAN 11:29–11:32, DAN 12:11–12:12; MAT 24:15–24:21 parallel MRK 13:14–13:19; REV 13:14–13:15

6106: addiction

The devotion of a person to something, whether sin in general or food, alcohol or wealth in particular, so as to become dependent upon it. A person will never be satisfied in such a state of slavery. The answer to addiction is self-control through the resources of the new life in Christ.

Addiction is the consequence of sin

2PE 2:19 See also JHN 8:34

Addiction to food, alcohol or drugs is to become dependent upon them

PHP 3:18–3:19 See also ISA 5:11, ISA 28:7–28:8, ISA 56:12; TIT 2:3

Addiction to wealth is to be controlled by it

MRK 10:21–10:22 parallel LUK 18:22–18:23 See also MAT 26:14–26:16 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:3–22:6; ACT 16:19, ACT 24:26; 2PE 2:15

Addiction never satisfies

Addiction to sinful habits does not satisfy

ROM 6:20–6:21

Addiction to food, alcohol or drugs does not satisfy

ECC 6:7 See also PRO 20:1, PRO 21:17, PRO 23:20–23:21, PRO 23:29–23:35; HOS 4:10–4:11 parallel MAT 19:21–19:22

Addiction to wealth does not satisfy

ECC 5:10 See also 1TI 6:9–6:10; JAS 5:1–5:3

The answer to addiction: self-control through the new life in Christ

PRO 23:1–23:4; ROM 6:6–6:7, ROM 6:11–6:14 See also PRO 25:16; ROM 6:16–6:19, ROM 8:12–8:15; 1CO 6:12, 1CO 9:27; GAL 5:22–5:23

6109: alienation

A state of being separate or apart from something or someone, often accompanied by an awareness of the separation. Human beings are alienated from God on account of sin. Alienation is also encountered in other areas of life, including relations between believers, and between believers and secular society.

Alienation from God because of sin

Sin causes separation from God

GAL 5:4 Those seeking to justify themselves cut themselves off from Jesus Christ's saving work; **COL 1:21** See also ISA 59:1–59:2; EZK 39:23–39:24

Seen in discomfort in God's presence

GEN 3:8–3:10 See also ISA 6:5; LUK 5:8

Seen in defeat in battle

DEU 1:42 See also NUM 14:41–14:45; JOS 7:11–7:12; JDG 2:11–2:15

Seen in unanswered prayer

ISA 59:1–59:2 See also DEU 1:45; PSA 66:18; PRO 1:28–1:30; ISA 1:15

Seen in unaccepted worship

ISA 1:11–1:14; ; AMO 5:21–5:23; ; MAL 1:10

Seen in lost closeness with God

GEN 3:23–3:24; ; EXO 33:3; ; ISA 64:7; ; EZK 8:6; ; HOS 5:6; ; JON 1:3

A sense of alienation from God

Feelings of alienation

PSA 22:1; ISA 49:14 See also PSA 39:12, PSA 42:3–42:4, PSA 42:9–42:10, PSA 44:23–44:24; ISA 40:27; LAM 2:1; MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34 Jesus Christ's alienation from God as he bore the consequences of human sin was felt and actual.

The reassurance of God's concern

ISA 49:15–49:16 See also ISA 43:1–43:5, ISA 44:21, ISA 54:7; JER 31:20

Alienation from others

Alienation caused by a third party

PRO 16:28 See also PRO 17:9; GAL 4:17 False teachers in Galatia tried to drive a wedge between Paul and the church.

Examples of alienation

GEN 3:7 Man and woman; ; GEN 4:3–4:8 Cain and Abel; ; GEN 27:41 Jacob and Esau; ; ISA 18:8–18:9 Saul and David; ; JOB 19:13–19:19 Job and his family and friends; ; PSA 69:8 the psalmist and his family; ; JER 12:6 Jeremiah and his family; ; ACT 15:39 Paul and Barnabas; ; EPH 2:12 Jew and Gentile

Overcoming alienation

Being reconciled to God

COL 1:22 See also ROM 5:11; 2CO 5:18–5:20; 1PE 2:25

Reconciliation with others

COL 3:13 See also LEV 19:18; MAT 5:23–5:24

Examples of reconciliation

GEN 33:4 Jacob and Esau; ; GEN 50:19–50:21 Joseph and his brothers; ; EPH 2:14–2:16 Jew and Gentile

God's people are aliens in the world

JHN 15:18–15:19 See also JHN 17:16; PHP 3:20; HEB 11:13–11:16; 1PE 2:11

Responsibility to the alien**God's concern for the outsider**

PSA 146:9 See also DEU 10:18; JER 30:17

The example of Jesus Christ

MAT 9:10–9:11 parallels MRK 2:15–2:16, LUK 5:29–5:30 Jesus Christ welcomed those who had been alienated by the rest of society. See also MAT 8:2–8:3 parallels MRK 1:40–1:42, LUK 5:12–5:13 Jesus Christ touched the “untouchable” man with leprosy; MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34

Equal treatment for the alien

LEV 19:34 See also EXO 12:48–12:49; LEV 24:22

Ensuring justice for the alien

DEU 24:17 The weaker members of Israelite society are of special concern. See also EXO 22:21; JER 22:3; ZEC 7:9–7:10

Special provision for the alien

LEV 23:22 God makes special provision for the poor so that they will have a share in the blessings of the land. See also LEV 19:10; DEU 24:20, DEU 14:28–14:29 The third year's tithe is shared with those without inheritance in the land.

6112: banishment

A form of punishment in which the guilty party is expelled from a region and forbidden to return. An important example is the banishment of Adam and Eve from Eden as a result of their disobedience to God.

Banishment is a punishment for disobedience

EZR 7:26 See also EXO 12:15, EXO 31:14; LEV 7:20–7:21; NUM 15:30

Banishment by God

Adam and Eve were banished from Eden because of their disobedience

GEN 3:22–3:24

God banished kings as a punishment

Nebuchadnezzar was banished from every human being because of his sin: DAN 4:25, DAN 4:32–4:33; EZK 28:16–28:17 The king of Tyre was banished from God's presence because of his sin.

God punished the people of Judah by banishing them from their land

JER 23:39 God also promised their return (Jer 32:37). See also JER 8:3, JER 24:9, JER 25:10, JER 27:10

At the final judgment, God will banish all evildoers

MAT 7:23 See also MAT 8:12, MAT 22:13, MAT 25:46

Kings used banishment as a punishment

Saul expelled all mediums and spiritists from the land: 1SA 28:3, 1SA 28:9; 1KI 15:12 Asa banished all the shrine-prostitutes from the land.

The psalmists recognised banishment as the severest of punishments

PSA 5:10, PSA 31:22, PSA 37:22, PSA 37:28, PSA 37:34, PSA 37:38, PSA 51:11, PSA 71:9, PSA 125:5; ; JON 2:4 This portion of the book of Jonah is written in the same manner as the Psalms, i.e., as Hebrew poetry.

The church is to use banishment as a means of discipline

1CO 5:12–5:13 See also DEU 17:7, DEU 19:19, DEU 21:21, DEU 22:21, DEU 22:24, DEU 24:7

6115: blame

The state of having been accused, correctly or incorrectly, of doing something wrong. Guilt is felt as a result of having been justly blamed for a crime or wrong against a person. Scripture portrays blaming others as a natural human reaction to events. Blame may often be apportioned by people on the basis of a misunderstanding, whereas God's blame of people is just. Christians should seek to lead blameless lives.

Blaming others: a basic human characteristic since the fall

GEN 3:12–3:13 NUM 20:5, NUM 21:5; ; JOS 22:15–22:18; ; 1SA 22:13–22:15; ; 2SA 3:8; ; 1KI 18:17–18:18; ; NEH 5:4–5:5; ; JOB 4:5–4:7, JOB 8:6, JOB 11:14–11:15; ; JER 38:4; ; JHN 9:1–9:2, JHN 11:21; ; ACT 6:1

Blaming God

JER 15:16–15:18 See also JOB 2:9, JOB 3:23; PSA 13:1–13:2, PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 44:9–44:26, PSA 60:1–60:3, PSA 74:1–74:23, PSA 79:1–79:5; ISA 40:27

God justly blames his people for their sins

HEB 8:8 See also ROM 9:19

Warnings about falsely attributing blame

PRO 3:30 See also PSA 71:13, PSA 109:18–109:20, PSA 109:29; ROM 14:1–14:4, ROM 15:7

Dealing with blame

By confession

PSA 32:5 See also PSA 51:3–51:7

By forgiveness

LUK 23:34 See also GEN 50:19–50:21; EPH 4:31–4:32

By correcting misunderstandings

JOS 22:13–22:34

God's people should deal gently with those who deserve blame

MAT 18:15 See also JAS 5:19–5:20

God's people should aim to live free from blame

PHP 1:9–1:10 See also GEN 17:1; PSA 19:13; 1CO 1:8; PHP 2:15; 1TH 3:13, 1TH 5:23

6118: blemish

A mark or stain which spoils something or lessens its value. The term is often used symbolically to refer to sin. The OT sacrificial system specified that only unblemished animals should be sacrificed.

A blemish is ritually unacceptable

In animals to be sacrificed

DEU 15:21; MAL 1:13–1:14 See also EXO 12:5; LEV 22:20–22:25; DEU 17:1

In priests offering sacrifices

LEV 21:17–21:23

A blemish or stain as a symbol of sin

JER 2:22 See also ISA 59:3; JUD 1:23

Sinful people represented as blemishes

2PE 2:13 See also JUD 1:12

Without blemish: physical or moral perfection

Absalom

2SA 14:25

Daniel and his companions

DAN 1:3–1:4

Jesus Christ

1PE 1:18–1:19 See also HEB 9:12–9:14

The church

EPH 5:27 See also COL 1:22

6121: boasting

Negatively, conceitedly praising oneself. Positively, trusting and exulting in who God is, and what he has done.

Boasting condemned

1JN 2:16 See also PSA 10:2–10:6, PSA 12:3–12:4, PSA 52:1, PSA 94:4; HAB 1:10–1:11; ROM 1:29–1:30; 2TI 3:1–3:2

Boasting exposed as folly

PRO 27:1 See also JDG 9:38–9:40; PRO 25:14; 1CO 3:18–3:23; JAS 4:13–4:16

Salvation by faith means no-one can boast about human merit

EPH 2:8–2:9 See also LUK 18:9–18:14; ROM 2:17–2:24, ROM 3:27, ROM 11:17–11:21; GAL 6:14

Examples of foolish boasting

ISA 10:12–10:14 See also ISA 37:24–37:25; DAN 4:28–4:30 Nebuchadnezzar; DAN 7:8, DAN 7:11, DAN 11:36; ACT 8:9–8:10 Simon the sorcerer; 2TH 2:3–2:4 the antichrist; 2PE 2:17–2:18

Legitimate boasting

Boasting in God

JER 9:23–9:24 See also 1SA 2:1–2:3; PSA 34:2, PSA 44:8; 1CO 1:27–1:31; JER 9:24; 2CO 10:7–10:18; HEB 3:6

Boasting in the results of ministry

1TH 2:19–2:20 See also ROM 15:17–15:19; 1CO 15:31; 2CO 8:24–9:3

Boasting in the conduct of ministry

2CO 1:12–1:14 See also 1CO 9:15; 2CO 11:7–11:12; 2TI 3:10–3:11

6124: condemnation

An act of judgment, in which someone rebukes and denounces the actions and motivations of others. Scripture stresses the righteousness and trustworthiness of divine condemnation but notes how human judgments are often tainted and distorted by sin.

6125: condemnation, divine

God's righteous condemnation is directed against human sin and wickedness.

God's wrath causes divine condemnation

ROM 1:18–1:20 See also REV 16:1–16:7

The reality and certainty of divine condemnation

MRK 16:15–16:16; JHN 5:28–5:29 See also MAT 12:36–12:37, MAT 25:31–25:33, MAT 25:41–25:45; 2PE 2:4–2:9

People's awareness of being under divine condemnation

2SA 24:10 See also PSA 32:3–32:5, PSA 51:3–51:4; DAN 9:7–9:14

Examples of divine condemnation

Condemnation of individuals

GEN 3:16–3:19; ; ACT 5:1–5:11; ; REV 20:11–20:15

Condemnation of groups, cities and nations

GEN 11:4–11:9, GEN 19:23–19:25; ; JOL 3:1–3:8, JOL 3:12–3:13

Divine condemnation averted through the work of Jesus Christ

JHN 3:16–3:18, JHN 5:24; ROM 8:1–8:4 See also ROM 8:31–8:34

6126: condemnation, human

The passing of judgment on others. This is valid when authorised by God, but otherwise it is frequently partial, godless and self-protecting, and therefore unacceptable.

Condemnation and the legal process: impartial judgment demanded

EXO 23:6–23:8 See also DEU 1:15–1:17, DEU 17:2–17:7, DEU 19:15; 2CH 19:4–19:7; PRO 17:15

The perversity and injustice of human condemnation

ROM 2:1–2:5 See also 2SA 12:1–12:10; DAN 6:1–6:16

People's false condemnation of Jesus Christ

ACT 13:27–13:28 See also MAT 26:59–26:63 parallel MRK 14:55–14:61

NT warnings against judgment and condemnation

MAT 7:1–7:5 parallels LUK 6:37–6:38, LUK 6:41–6:42 See also LUK 18:9–18:14; JHN 8:3–8:11; ROM 14:1–14:4, ROM 14:9–14:13

God's protection of his people from false condemnation

ISA 50:7–50:9; ; ROM 8:31–8:39

6130: corruption

A state of spiritual decay and moral dishonesty, arising from the effects of sin, which expresses itself in disobedience towards God.

Corruption of nature as a result of the fall

GEN 6:11

Sinful humanity is corrupt

ISA 1:4; ACT 2:40 See also DEU 32:20; JOB 15:16; PSA 14:1–14:3 parallel PSA 53:1–53:3; PRO 4:24, PRO 6:12; HOS 9:9; PHP 2:15; TIT 1:15–1:16

The gospel breaks the power of corruption

2PE 1:4 See also 2CO 7:1–7:2; 2PE 2:20; JUD 1:23

Examples and causes of corruption

Corruption as injustice

PSA 55:23 See also 2CH 19:7; JOB 5:16; ISA 58:6; EZK 9:9

Disobedience towards God

DEU 31:29 See also DEU 32:5; JDG 2:19

Denying the truth

1TI 6:5

Paganism

EZR 9:11

Mocking justice

PRO 19:28

Taking bribes

See also ECC 7:7

Bad company

1CO 15:33

Careless talk

JAS 3:5–3:6 See also PRO 4:24, PRO 6:12

6133: coveting

Desiring to possess something at the expense of the legitimate owner.

6134: coveting, prohibition of

Coveting is forbidden by God and can lead to terrible consequences. It occasionally refers to a commendable earnest desiring.

Coveting is forbidden by God

In the Ten Commandments

EXO 20:17 parallel DEU 5:21 **ROM 7:7–7:8** Coveting is provoked by the law that forbids it. See also ROM 13:9–13:10

Through the prophets

ISA 5:8, ISA 57:17; ; EZK 33:31; ; AMO 2:6, AMO 5:11–5:12, AMO 8:5–8:6; ; MIC 2:2

In Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 6:19–6:21 See also LUK 12:15

Coveting has some terrible consequences

2SA 11:2–11:4 adultery; ; 1KI 21:18–21:19 murders; MAT 18:1–18:3; ; MRK 9:33–9:35 parallel LUK 9:46–9:48; ; 1CO 6:9–6:10; ACT 5:3–5:10 God's judgment

Further examples of coveting

JOS 7:21 See also DEU 7:25; JOS 22:20 Achan; 1SA 2:12–2:15 Eli's sons; 1SA 8:3 Samuel's sons; 1SA 15:9–15:10

Saul; PRO 30:16; JER 6:13, JER 8:10; HAB 2:5 Israel's enemies are likened to the grave, always swallowing people and never satisfied; ACT 8:13–8:23 Simon the sorcerer

Believers may pray to be free from coveting

PSA 119:36

Godly people claim not to have coveted

Samuel

1SA 12:3–12:5

Paul

ACT 20:33 See also 1CO 9:12; 2CO 7:2, 2CO 11:9, 2CO 12:14–12:18; 1TH 2:5

Coveting as a commendable earnest desiring

A desire for the greater spiritual gifts: 1CO 12:31, 1CO 14:1, 1CO 14:39; 1TI 3:1 a desire to serve in a leadership role in the church

6135: coveting, and other sins

Covetousness is associated with other sins and brings trouble with it.

Coveting is linked with other sins

Idolatry

EPH 5:5 See also 1CO 10:6–10:7; COL 3:5

Pride

PSA 10:3

Sexual sin

MAT 5:28 See also 1TH 4:5

Laziness

PRO 21:25–21:26

Covetousness is one of many sins which pollute a person

MRK 7:21–7:23

Love of money is covetousness

It is a source of evil

1TI 6:9–6:10 See also PRO 10:2, PRO 22:16, PRO 28:20, PRO 28:22, PRO 30:8–30:9

Examples of those who love money

LUK 16:14; JHN 12:5–12:6 See also MAT 23:25 parallel LUK 11:39; 2PE 2:3, 2PE 2:14 False teachers are “experts in greed”.

Believers must not be lovers of money

HEB 13:5; 1PE 5:2 Elders must not be greedy for money. See also EXO 18:21; EPH 5:3; 1TI 3:1–3:3

Love of money characterises the last days

2TI 3:1–3:2

Coveting brings trouble

JAS 4:1–4:2 See also PRO 15:27, PRO 28:25, PRO 29:4

Even a gift can be given covetously

2CO 9:5 The gift translated as “one grudgingly given” literally means a “covetous gift”.

6139: deadness, spiritual

Being morally and spiritually without life, therefore without a relationship with God. This condition, being the result of original sin, brings wrath and judgment and can be changed only by the sovereign, intervening grace of God.

Spiritual deadness is humanity's condition by nature

It is linked to physical death

GEN 2:17 See also GEN 3:3, GEN 3:19; PRO 11:19; EZK 18:20–18:31; JHN 8:21–8:24; ROM 1:32, ROM 6:23

It is the universal consequence of sin

EPH 2:1 See also GEN 8:21; 1CH 10:13; PSA 51:5, PSA 58:3; PRO 21:16; JHN 6:53; ROM 3:23, ROM 5:12–5:13, ROM 5:17; COL 2:13

It is confirmed in the law

ROM 5:20 See also ROM 7:4–7:12, ROM 8:2–8:4; GAL 2:19

It is evidenced in the human mind

ROM 8:6; ; 2CO 4:4; ; COL 1:21; ; TIT 1:15

It is evidenced in the human body

ROM 7:24 See also ROM 6:12–6:14, ROM 6:16, ROM 8:10; 1CO 15:50; 2CO 5:10; GAL 6:7–6:8; EPH 4:22; 1TI 5:6; JAS 3:6

Spiritual darkness brings judgment

God's judgment is final

LUK 16:26 See also ISA 66:24; MAT 8:12, MAT 25:30–25:32; MRK 9:43–9:49; LUK 13:28; HEB 9:27; 1PE 1:17

The second death

REV 20:14–20:15 See also MAT 25:41; 1JN 5:16–5:17; JUD 1:12; REV 2:11, REV 21:8

Rescue from spiritual deadness is initiated by God

He brings salvation

EPH 2:4–2:5 See also PSA 103:12; ISA 26:19; EZK 37:1–37:14

He brings union with the death of Jesus Christ

ROM 6:4 See also ROM 6:5–6:10; 2CO 4:10, 2CO 5:15–5:17; GAL 2:19–2:20, GAL 5:24, GAL 6:14; PHP 3:10; COL 2:12

He brings union with the resurrection of Jesus Christ
COL 3:1 See also ROM 5:21, ROM 6:11; REV 20:4-20:5

He brings ultimate physical resurrection
ROM 8:10-8:11 See also 1CO 15:42-15:49

Concern for those who are spiritually sleepy
EPH 5:14 See also ROM 13:11; 1TH 5:5-5:7; REV 3:1-3:2

6142: decay

As a consequence of the fall, all created things have a tendency to waste away and spoil. Jesus Christ brings deliverance from this.

Decay was decreed as a result of the fall

In human beings
GEN 2:17

In the world
GEN 3:17-3:19 See also ROM 8:20

Decay is the common experience of humanity
PSA 90:3-90:10 See also PSA 49:8-49:9

A decaying world is not worth clinging to
MAT 6:19-6:20 See also PSA 102:26; LUK 12:33; 1JN 2:15-2:17

Jesus Christ is free from decay
ACT 2:24-2:31 See also PSA 16:8-16:11; ACT 13:34-13:37; HEB 7:26, HEB 13:8

Believers are redeemed from decay
2CO 4:16 See also JOB 19:26; JHN 3:16

Christians are “salt” in a decaying world
MAT 5:13 See also MRK 9:50; LUK 14:34

The world to come is free from decay
1PE 1:3-1:5 See also ROM 8:21; 1CO 15:42; HEB 12:28, HEB 13:14; REV 21:4

Examples of the link between sin and decay
 LEV 26:14-26:16, LEV 26:39; NUM 5:20-5:22, NUM 5:27; DEU 28:22, DEU 32:24; JOB 18:13; ; PSA 32:3, PSA 49:13-49:14, PSA 106:15, PSA 106:43, PSA 112:10; ; ISA 5:24, ISA 10:16, ISA 17:4, ISA 24:16, ISA 64:7; ; JER 49:7; LAM 2:6, LAM 2:8; EZK 4:17, EZK 24:23, EZK 33:10; HOS 4:3, HOS 8:10; HAB 3:16; ; JAS 5:2

6145: deceit

Behaviour, in words or actions, which is deliberately intended to make people believe things that are not true.

6146: deceit, and God’s nature

Deceit is totally contrary to the nature and purposes of God. The gospel is grounded in the complete truthfulness and trustworthiness of God, whereas sin is based upon self-deception.

God’s nature and purposes are not based on deception

Deceit is contrary to the nature of God
TIT 1:2 See also JHN 16:13; 1PE 2:22

God cannot be deceived
1CH 28:9 See also PSA 139:1; ACT 5:3; 1CO 4:5

Jesus Christ does not deceive
 ISA 53:9

Satan’s power rests on deception
JHN 8:44 See also GEN 3:1-3:4; 2CO 11:3, 2CO 11:14; 2TH 2:9-2:10

The coming antichrist will rely on deception
2JN 1:7 See also MAT 24:24 parallel MRK 13:22; REV 13:14

False prophets and false teachers rely on deception
2CO 11:13 See also JER 14:14, JER 23:26; EZK 13:6; ACT 20:30; ROM 16:18; EPH 4:14; 1TI 4:2; TIT 1:10-1:11; 2PE 2:1-2:3

Deception is at the heart of human sin

The fall took place through deception
GEN 3:1-3:4, GEN 3:13 See also 1TI 2:14

Deception is a characteristic of fallen human nature
JER 17:9 See also JOB 15:35 PSA 5:9, PSA 10:7, PSA 35:20, PSA 36:3; MIC 6:12; ROM 3:13 PSA 38:12, PSA 116:11; PRO 12:5; JER 9:4-9:5 deceptive friends and brothers; HOS 11:12; NAM 3:1; MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21-7:22; ROM 1:29; 2TI 3:13; TIT 1:12

Examples of deceit

GEN 4:9 Cain; GEN 12:13, GEN 20:2; GEN 26:7 Isaac; ; GEN 27:19 Jacob; ; GEN 31:7 Laban; ; GEN 37:31 Joseph’s brothers; ; EXO 8:29 Pharaoh; ; JOS 9:4 the Gibeonites; 1SA 21:2, 1SA 21:13; 2SA 13:6 Amnon; ; 1KI 13:18 the old prophet; ; 2KI 5:22 Gehazi; ; MAT 2:8 Herod; MAT 22:18 parallels MRK 12:15, LUK 20:23

6147: deceit, practice of

Deceit is condemned by God as an attempt to deny his sovereignty and his revelation of himself.

Deceit is forbidden by God

Condemnation of deception in general
LEV 19:11 See also PRO 12:22, PRO 24:28

False witnesses condemned

EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20 See also PRO 12:17, PRO 14:5, PRO 19:9

False measures prohibited

LEV 19:35 See also DEU 25:13; PRO 11:1, PRO 20:10; MIC 6:11

Spiritual deception condemned

TIT 1:16 See also MAL 1:14; MAT 23:27–23:28; LUK 6:46; ROM 2:21

Deception must not be found in the people of God**God's people must not practise deceit**

1PE 2:1 See also JOB 27:4; PSA 24:3–24:4, PSA 32:2; ZEP 3:13; JHN 4:24; 1CO 5:8; EPH 4:25; COL 3:9; 1PE 3:10; REV 14:5

Christian leaders in particular must not deceive

2CO 4:2 See also 2CO 1:12, 2CO 2:17; 1TH 2:3–2:5; 1TI 3:8; TIT 1:7

God's people warned against being deceived

EPH 5:6 See also JER 29:8; 1CO 6:9–6:10, 1CO 15:33; GAL 6:7; COL 2:8; 2TH 2:3; 1JN 3:7

Deceit results in God's judgment

PSA 5:6 See also DEU 25:16; PSA 55:23, PSA 119:118; PRO 20:17, PRO 21:6; JER 9:8–9:9; EZK 13:9; ACT 5:9–5:10; REV 21:8, REV 21:27, REV 22:15

6151: dirt**Throwing dirt to signify contempt**

2SA 16:13 See also NAM 3:6

Bathing to remove dirt

1PE 3:21

Comparative use of dirt to emphasise abundance**Metaphorical use of filth to represent sin**

ISA 4:4 See also PRO 30:11–30:14; ISA 28:8; JAS 1:21; REV 17:4

Refuse indicating worthlessness

1CO 4:13 See also 2KI 9:37; PSA 83:10; ISA 5:25; JER 8:2, JER 9:22, JER 16:4, JER 25:33; LAM 3:45; PHP 3:8–3:9

6154: fall, the

The departure by creation, including human beings, from the patterns and standards set for it by God. Creation now exists at a lower level of integrity and fulfilment than that which God originally intended for it.

6155: fall, of Adam and Eve

The first human beings abused their God-given freedom. Their original disobedience and resultant expulsion from the Garden of Eden is usually referred to as “the fall”.

The first sin was the disobedience of Adam and Eve to God's command

GEN 2:17, GEN 3:1–3:7 See also HOS 6:7; ROM 5:12, ROM 5:14; 2CO 11:3; 1TI 2:14

Causes of the fall**Disobedience**

GEN 2:16–2:17, GEN 3:1–3:3; ; ISA 43:27; ; HOS 6:7

Through satanic deception

GEN 3:4, GEN 3:13; ; 2CO 11:3; ; 1TI 2:14

Evil desire

GEN 3:6

Adam and Eve tried to hide their disobedience

GEN 3:8–3:13 See also JOB 31:33

The disobedience of Adam and Eve affected every relationship in life**Relationship with God**

GEN 3:22–3:23 See also GEN 4:14; PSA 90:3–90:10; ROM 1:20–1:21

Relationships among human beings

GEN 3:16 See also GEN 4:1–4:8; ROM 1:18–1:32; EPH 2:1–2:3, EPH 2:11–2:12

The relationship between human beings and the creation

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also GEN 3:14–3:15, GEN 4:10–4:12; ROM 8:19

The consequences of the disobedience of Adam and Eve**It leads to death and punishment**

ROM 5:12 See also ROM 1:18; 1CO 15:21–15:22; 1TH 1:10, 1TH 2:14–2:16

Sin springs from within the human mind, will and emotions

JAS 1:13–1:15 See also JAS 4:6–4:7; 1JN 2:15–2:17

6156: fall, of humanity

On account of their relation to Adam, all human beings have an inherent bias towards evil due to sin. Individual acts of sin reflect this bias, often referred to as “original sin”.

All human beings, except for Jesus Christ, are sinful

ROM 3:23; HEB 4:15 See also GEN 6:5, GEN 6:11–6:12; PSA 14:1–14:3, PSA 51:5; ISA 64:6–64:7; JHN 8:7; ROM 3:9–3:20, ROM 5:12–5:19; EPH 2:1–2:3

Every part of a person is affected by sin

The heart

JER 17:9 See also GEN 6:5, GEN 8:21; 1SA 17:28; 2CH 12:14; PSA 66:18; JER 5:23; MAT 5:28, MAT 15:8, MAT 15:19

The body

ROM 6:6 See also ROM 6:12–6:13; 1CO 6:13, 1CO 6:19–6:20

Human nature

ROM 8:5–8:8 See also ROM 7:5; 1CO 5:5; GAL 5:19–5:21, GAL 6:8; EPH 2:3

Believers are warned not to fall from grace

HEB 3:12–3:14 See also MAT 24:12–24:13; 1CO 15:2; GAL 5:4; HEB 4:11, HEB 12:15; 2PE 3:17; REV 2:4–2:5

God is able to keep believers from falling

JUD 1:24 See also JOB 33:14–33:18; ROM 16:25; EPH 6:13; 1JN 5:18

6157: fall, of Satan and his angels

Satan and his angels rebelled against God and were removed from their positions of authority. They are now destined for judgment.

The rebellion of Satan and his angels

ISA 14:12–14:15 Written about a king in Isaiah's own time, this passage has been used by both Jews and Christians as a description of the fall of Satan; **JUD 1:6** See also JOB 4:18; EZK 28:15; LUK 10:18; REV 12:7–12:9, REV 12:12

The results of the rebellion of Satan and his angels

Constant spiritual warfare on the earth

REV 12:17 See also MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33; ACT 13:10; 2CO 11:13–11:15; GAL 5:16–5:18; 1TI 3:6–3:7; JAS 4:7; 1PE 5:8–5:9

God's punishment

2PE 2:4 See also MAT 25:41; JUD 1:6; REV 19:20, REV 20:10

6160: fathers, sin of the

Children may suffer on account of the sins committed by their forebears, just as they may also be blessed for their sake. Nevertheless, Scripture teaches that each individual must take responsibility for his or her own sin.

Children suffer the ill-effects of their fathers' sins

EXO 34:6–34:7 See also EXO 20:4–20:6 parallel DEU 5:8–5:10; LEV 26:39; NUM 14:18, NUM 14:31–14:33; JOS 7:24–7:25; 1KI 16:34; JOS 6:26; JOB 21:19; ISA 14:21; JER 32:18

The exilic prophets emphasised individual responsibility for sin

EZK 18:20 See also JER 31:29–31:30; EZK 18:1–18:20

Children share in the blessing of their fathers

GEN 17:4–17:7, GEN 26:24; DEU 7:9 See also GEN 6:17–6:18, GEN 15:18–15:19; EXO 2:23–2:25, EXO 20:4–20:6 parallel DEU 5:8–5:10; NUM 25:10–25:13; 2SA 7:11–7:16; 1KI 11:12–11:13, 1KI 11:31–11:34; LUK 1:50; ROM 11:28–11:29

6163: faults

Human weaknesses and failings which are sinful in themselves, and may lead to further sin. It is common, often as a means of averting blame, to put undue focus on the faults of others. However, where necessary, faults should be exposed and responsibility properly attributed. Jesus Christ lived a faultless life and God's people are challenged to live lives that are above reproach. The church will one day be presented without fault before God.

The variety of human faults

A flawed human nature

ROM 7:14–7:23 See also GAL 5:17; EPH 2:3; 2PE 2:18

Human weaknesses and failings

ROM 15:1 See also ROM 8:28, ROM 14:1–14:2

Faults in thought, word and deed

PSA 78:57 disloyalty and unfaithfulness to God; ; PRO 14:21 not showing concern for others; ; ISA 53:6 selfishness in going one's own way; ; HOS 7:16 unwillingness to turn to God; ; JAS 3:2 failure to control the tongue; ; JAS 4:17 failure to do what is right

Finding fault with others

Passing blame to others

GEN 3:12 Adam blames Eve for his disobedience. See also EXO 32:22–32:24 Aaron blames the Israelites for the golden calf; 1SA 13:11–13:12 Saul blames his troops' impatience and Samuel's late arrival for his disobedience; 1SA 15:20–15:21 Saul blames his soldiers for the failure to carry out God's instructions; MAT 25:24–25:25 The man who buried his talent blames his action on his master's hardness.

Criticising and judging others

MAT 7:1–7:5 See also JAS 4:11–4:12, JAS 5:9; JUD 1:16

Finding fault with God's appointed leaders

EXO 17:3 See also EXO 15:24; NUM 14:2; JOS 9:18; ACT 11:2-11:3; 2CO 10:1

Finding fault with God's people

MAT 5:11 parallel LUK 6:22 See also EXO 5:16-5:17; PSA 41:6; PSA 71:10; DAN 6:24

Finding fault with God

PSA 78:19 See also EXO 16:7; NUM 14:27; NUM 21:5; EZK 35:13

Finding fault with Jesus Christ

LUK 6:7 parallels MAT 12:10, MRK 3:4 See also MAT 9:3 parallels MRK 2:7, LUK 5:21 Jesus Christ is accused of blasphemy because he claims to forgive sin; MAT 9:11 parallels MRK 2:16, LUK 5:30 Jesus Christ is criticised for his association with "sinners"; MAT 15:2 parallel MRK 7:5 Jesus Christ is criticised for failure to conform to ceremonial cleansing traditions; MAT 26:59-26:61 parallel MRK 14:55-14:59 false charges brought against Jesus Christ at his trial; JHN 9:16 Jesus Christ is accused of breaking the Sabbath.

Confronting human faults**Accepting blame for one's own faults**

PSA 51:3-51:4 See also JON 1:12; LUK 15:18

God holds his people at fault

JER 17:4 See also HEB 8:8-8:9; JER 31:31-31:32

Faults cannot be hidden from God

PSA 19:12; PSA 44:21; PSA 90:8; ; ECC 12:14; ; 1CO 14:25

Confronting others with their faults

MAT 18:15-18:17; GAL 6:1 See also LUK 17:3; JAS 5:19-5:20

Examples of those confronted with their faults

2SA 12:7 David; ; 1KI 14:7-14:9 Jeroboam; ; 2CH 16:9 Asa; ; DAN 5:23 Belshazzar; ; MAT 14:3 parallel MRK 6:18 Herod; ; ACT 5:3 Ananias and Sapphira; ; GAL 2:11-2:12 Peter

God can deal with human faults**Freedom from the power of sin**

ROM 6:11-6:12; ROM 8:3-8:4; ; 2CO 5:17; ; GAL 5:16

Strength for service

2CO 12:9-12:10; ; PHP 4:13

Forgiveness

PSA 65:3; ; EPH 4:32; ; COL 2:13; ; 1JN 1:9

Faultlessness**Faultlessness shown by Jesus Christ**

1PE 2:22 See also ISA 53:9; JHN 8:46; HEB 4:15; 1PE 1:19; 1JN 3:5

God's people are to be above reproach

1PE 2:12 See also ROM 12:17-12:18; 2CO 8:20-8:21 Paul ensures that his handling of money is above criticism; PHP 2:14-2:15 1TI 3:2; TIT 1:6 2PE 3:14

The church will be presented faultless before God

JUD 1:24-1:25 See also EPH 5:27; COL 1:22; 1TH 3:13; 1TH 5:23

6166: flesh, sinful nature

The physical aspect of human beings, which distinguishes them from God and is therefore frequently used in the NT as a symbol of human sinful nature in contrast with God's perfection. (The Greek word for "flesh" is sometimes translated by other words and phrases in the passages cited in this theme.)

Flesh as the bodily substance of human beings**As individuals or in relation to others**

PSA 84:2 See also GEN 2:23-2:24; GEN 29:14; 1CO 15:39 GAL 2:20; PHP 1:22-1:24

As the means by which Jesus Christ identified with the human race to bring salvation

JHN 1:14 See also EPH 2:15; HEB 10:20; 1JN 4:2

As subject to mortality

ISA 40:6-40:7 See also PSA 78:39; ACT 2:31; 1CO 15:50

As subject to weakness

2CH 32:8 See also PSA 73:26; MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38

Flesh as contrasting human nature with God's perfection

The powerlessness of human beings contrasted with God's eternal power

ISA 31:3 See also JHN 3:6; JHN 6:63

Human or worldly standards contrasted with God's standards

JHN 8:15 See also 1CO 1:26; 2CO 5:16; 2CO 10:3-10:4

Flesh as denoting the sinful nature of human beings**The tendency to sin**

ROM 7:18 Paul does not mean that no goodness at all exists in people; nor that the physical aspect of human beings is inherently evil. He means that humans are invariably infected by evil and subject to its power. See also JER 17:5

The conflict in human experience between the sinful nature and the Spirit of God

GAL 5:17 See also ROM 8:4-8:9; GAL 5:19-5:25

The sinful nature is opposed to God and his will

This opposition finds expression in a range of acts and attitudes

GAL 5:19–5:21 See also ROM 7:14–7:25, ROM 8:7, ROM 13:13–13:14; 1CO 6:9–6:11; EPH 5:5; JAS 1:14–1:15; 1PE 2:11; 2PE 2:10, 2PE 2:18; 1JN 2:16

Confidence in the law is futile

ROM 8:3 Because of the sinfulness of human nature, God's law is powerless to bring people into relationship with God; **GAL 3:3** Even the attempt to find acceptance with God through keeping his law is an act of the sinful nature because it involves rejecting his offer of salvation through his grace. See also ROM 7:25; PHP 3:3–3:9

The sinful nature controls human behaviour in ways which run counter to God's purpose

ROM 8:8 See also ROM 7:5

The sinful nature therefore makes people subject to God's judgment and to death

ROM 8:13; EPH 2:3 See also GAL 6:8

Believers are not controlled by the sinful nature

Through Jesus Christ's entering into human flesh, God delivers from the power and consequences of human sinfulness

ROM 8:3 See also EPH 2:15

Believers have crucified the sinful nature

ROM 7:5–7:6 See also ROM 8:8–8:9; GAL 5:24; COL 2:11

The power of God's Spirit enables believers to continue to resist the sinful nature

ROM 8:13 See also ROM 13:14; GAL 5:13; COL 3:5–3:6; 1PE 2:11

God's provision of church discipline in eliminating the sinful nature

1CO 5:5 The discipline of excluding a sinner from the church community is intended to bring him to repentance and so abandon his sinful course of action. Repentance provoked by physical suffering is possibly also in mind.

6169: godlessness

An outlook and lifestyle which does not acknowledge God. God frustrates the evil purposes of the godless and judges them. Believers are to guard against godlessness.

Godlessness is an outlook and lifestyle which does not acknowledge God

PSA 14:1–14:3 parallel PSA 53:1–53:3 See also JOB 35:9–35:10; PSA 10:4–10:11, PSA 36:1–36:4; PRO 11:9, PRO 30:8–30:9

Examples of godlessness

Judah's religious leaders: JER 23:11–23:12, JER 23:15–23:17; HEB 12:16 Esau

God frustrates the evil purposes of the godless

JOB 8:11–8:19, JOB 34:29–34:30; ; PSA 9:17–9:20

God judges godless people and nations

ROM 1:18 JOB 13:15–13:16, JOB 15:34, JOB 20:4–20:5, JOB 27:8–27:10, JOB 36:8–36:13; PSA 50:16–50:22; ; ISA 10:6, ISA 33:13–33:14

Believers are to guard against godlessness

JUD 1:3–1:23 See also 1TI 4:7, 1TI 6:20–6:21

Jesus Christ will turn godlessness away from Israel

ROM 11:26–11:27

6172: guilt

Primarily a state of being at fault, often accompanied by a feeling of being in the wrong. Scripture affirms that human guilt arises from sin before God, and can only be purged through accepting the forgiveness offered through the death of Jesus Christ.

6173: guilt, and God

All human beings are guilty in the sight of God, and all require forgiveness and expiation of their sin. Guilt can arise through failing to know what is right, through failing to do what is right and through giving in to temptation to do wrong.

Guilt as the objective condition of sinners

Guilt results from intentional sin

LEV 6:1–6:7; JAS 2:10 See also NUM 5:5–5:7; DEU 24:14–24:15; EZR 9:13–9:15; EZK 22:1–22:4; JHN 16:7–16:8

Guilt results from unintentional sin

LEV 4:13 See also LEV 4:22, LEV 4:27; ACT 3:17–3:20

Guilt as an accumulation of sin

HOS 13:12 See also EZR 9:6; ISA 1:4, ISA 24:20

God's knowledge of human guilt

PSA 69:5 See also GEN 4:8–4:10; JOS 7:1–7:26; JER 2:22; 1CO 4:4–4:5

God's anger at human guilt

2CH 24:18 See also NUM 32:10–32:13; 2KI 22:11–22:13; HOS 12:13–12:14; ROM 1:18, ROM 2:5–2:8; EPH 5:6–5:7

God's determination to punish the guilty**God himself punishes the guilty**

NUM 14:18 See also EXO 20:5; JER 25:12; NAM 1:2–1:3

Human judges are to punish the guilty

DEU 25:1–25:3 See also PRO 17:15, PRO 24:23–24:25; ROM 13:1–13:5; 1PE 2:13–2:14

6174: guilt, human aspects of

Scripture affirms that all are guilty in the sight of God, and explores the various ways in which guilt affects human life, before offering forgiveness of guilt through the death of Jesus Christ.

Human awareness of guilt

PSA 51:3–51:5 See also GEN 42:21; PSA 32:1–32:4; JHN 8:3–8:11; HEB 9:9; 1JN 3:19–3:20

Human beings are held responsible for their guilt

LEV 5:17 See also ISA 24:5–24:6; EZK 18:19–18:20; HOS 10:1–10:2, HOS 13:16; MAT 12:35–12:36; ROM 14:12; 2CO 5:10; REV 20:12

Guilt defiles human life

ISA 59:1–59:3 See also PSA 51:1–51:7; JER 2:22; HEB 10:22

Human experience of guilt**Feelings of guilt in general**

HEB 10:1–10:2 See also 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; 2CO 7:10; HEB 10:22; 1JN 3:19–3:20

Guilt produces feelings of anguish and despair

MAT 27:3–27:5 See also EZR 9:1–9:7, EZR 10:1; PSA 40:11–40:12; PRO 28:17; LAM 1:20

Guilt produces feelings of shame and disgrace

EZR 9:6 See also JER 23:38–23:40

Guilt produces feelings of fear and terror

ISA 6:1–6:7 See also GEN 3:8–3:10; ISA 33:14

Guilt produces feelings of unworthiness

LUK 15:21 See also EZR 9:13–9:15; PSA 51:11 The fear of being cast out of God's presence is the result of the psalmist's sense of guilt; LUK 5:8; 1CO 15:9

6175: guilt, removal of

Through the death of Jesus Christ, God has provided a means of removing guilt, thus opening the way for believers to know the blessings of a right relationship with him.

The removal of guilt is God's work

JER 2:22, JER 50:20; ROM 8:33 "Justify" is a legal term which includes the meaning "to declare not guilty". See also 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; PSA 32:1–32:5; ISA 6:1–6:6

The removal of guilt requires confession

PSA 32:5 See also 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; PSA 51:14; JER 3:12–3:13; ACT 11:21; ROM 2:4; 2TI 2:25; 1JN 1:8–1:9

The removal of guilt by the OT sacrificial system**Guilt removed by the guilt offering**

LEV 6:6–6:7 See also LEV 19:20–19:22; EZR 10:18–10:19

Guilt removed by the sin offering

NUM 15:27–15:28 See also LEV 5:5–5:6; NUM 6:9–6:11

Guilt removed by the Day of Atonement

LEV 16:20–16:34

Animal sacrifices are ultimately ineffective in removing guilt

HEB 10:1–10:4 See also HEB 9:9

The removal of guilt by Jesus Christ's sacrificial death

ISA 53:10–53:12 This prophecy finds its ultimate fulfillment in the person of Jesus Christ; **HEB 9:14** See also JHN 1:29 The point of John's image is that Jesus Christ will be sacrificed, as lambs were, to remove people's guilt; ROM 5:9 The blood of Jesus Christ referred to here is his shed blood, and therefore speaks of his (sacrificial) death; 2CO 5:21 Human guilt is transferred to Jesus Christ, in order that believers might become righteous before God; TIT 2:14; HEB 9:28, HEB 10:11–10:14; 1JN 1:7

The results of guilt being removed**A clean conscience**

HEB 9:14, HEB 10:22

Peace with God

ISA 53:5; ; ROM 5:1; ; COL 1:19–1:20

Access into God's presence

ROM 5:1–5:2; ; EPH 2:18

Joy

PSA 32:1–32:11; ; ROM 5:1–5:2

Hope

ROM 5:1–5:2

A desire to worship God

PSA 51:14–51:15

A desire to serve God

ISA 6:6–6:8; ; JHN 21:15–21:20

6178: hardness of heart

Primarily, in Scripture, a persistent inner refusal to hear and obey the word of God. Also, in a more general sense, an uncaring or unsympathetic attitude towards other people.

Kinds of hardness of heart

As disobedience towards God

PSA 95:8–95:9 Referring to the disobedience of the Israelites in their wilderness wanderings. See also **HEB 3:7–3:9****EPH 4:18** See also **PRO 28:14**; **ZEC 7:12**; **ROM 2:5**; **HEB 3:12–3:15**, **HEB 4:5–4:7**

As the work of God

EXO 10:20 God's judgment on Pharaoh was to confirm him in his stubbornness so that he might feel the full weight of his wrath; **ISA 6:10** See also **JHN 12:40**

As an uncaring attitude towards other people

DEU 15:7 See also **PSA 17:10**, **PSA 73:7**, **PSA 119:70**; **MAT 19:8** parallel **MRK 10:5**; **JAS 2:15–2:16**; **1JN 3:17**

Examples of hardness of heart

Pharaoh

EXO 7:13, **EXO 7:22**, **EXO 8:19**, **EXO 8:32**, **EXO 9:7**, **EXO 9:34–9:35**

Israel

1SA 6:6; ; **JER 5:23**, **JER 9:14**, **JER 11:8**, **JER 13:10**, **JER 16:12**, **JER 18:12**, **JER 23:26**

Zedekiah

2CH 36:12–36:13

Jesus Christ's disciples

MRK 6:51–6:52, **MRK 8:17**

Jesus Christ's generation

MAT 13:15, **MAT 19:8** parallel **MRK 10:5**; ; **MRK 3:5**

Paul's hearers

ACT 28:25–28:27

God's remedies for hardness of heart

Repentance

PSA 51:17 See also **1KI 8:46–8:49**; **2CH 34:27**; **JER 3:17**; **EZK 18:31**

A work of grace

EZK 11:19 God's promise to Israel. See also **1KI 8:58**; **JER 31:33**; **EZK 36:26**

6181: ignorance

A state of lack of knowledge or information, including a failure to know the person, will and ways of God. Scripture emphasises the importance of a true knowledge of God and makes such knowledge available.

6182: ignorance, and human situation

Ignorance is part of the human condition: as finite creatures, human knowledge is incomplete, but human beings can trust God, whose knowledge is complete, to guide their steps.

Ignorance of God

Finite human beings cannot know God completely

ECC 11:5 See also **JOB 38:1–38:7**; **ECC 3:11**

This ignorance will be dispelled at Jesus Christ's return

1CO 13:9–13:12

Ignorance of the future

Human beings are ignorant of future events

ECC 8:7–8:8 See also **ECC 3:22**, **ECC 9:12**, **ECC 10:14**, **ECC 11:2**, **ECC 11:6**; **ACT 20:22**

Human beings are ignorant of the time of Jesus Christ's return

MRK 13:32–13:36 parallel **MAT 24:36–24:44**

Presumptuous plans should therefore be avoided

JAS 4:13–4:16 See also **PSA 39:6**; **PRO 27:1**; **LUK 12:16–12:21**

God's guidance is essential

PRO 20:24 See also **PRO 19:21**; **JER 10:23**

Ignorance of doctrinal matters

Within the church

1TH 4:13–4:18 See also **1CO 10:1–10:10**, **1CO 12:1–12:11**

God has established teachers to combat ignorance

1CO 12:28 See also **EPH 4:11–4:13**; **1TI 4:13**, **1TI 5:17**; **2TI 3:16–3:17**

Ignorance may lead to death

PRO 9:17–9:18 See also **PRO 4:19**, **PRO 7:21–7:23**

6183: ignorance, of God

A lack of knowledge of God, regarded as inexcusable by Scripture. God has made his existence, nature and power known to all through creation. God himself is not ignorant of human sin, but is able to discern the real intentions of human minds and wills.

Ignorance of God is inexcusable

God is made known through creation

ROM 1:18–1:20 As God is made known to all through nature, human ignorance of God is inexcusable. See also **PSA 19:1–19:4**; **ACT 14:17**, **ACT 17:24–17:28**; **ROM 2:14–2:15**

God revealed himself to Israel

NEH 9:13–9:14 See also EXO 19:10–19:11, EXO 19:16–19:19; PSA 103:7, PSA 147:19–147:20; EZK 20:5

Ignorance of God is linked to sin and rebellion**Among the Gentiles**

EPH 4:18–4:19 See also EXO 5:2; JHN 4:22; ACT 17:23; 1TH 4:3–4:5

In Israel

ISA 1:2–1:3 See also ISA 56:10; JER 2:8–2:9, JER 4:22, JER 5:4–5:5, JER 8:7–8:12, JER 9:6, JER 10:21; HOS 4:1, HOS 4:6; AMO 3:10

Ignorance of God in the ministry of Jesus Christ**Among the religious leaders**

JHN 8:13–8:19 See also MAT 22:23–22:32 parallels MRK 12:18–12:27, LUK 20:27–20:38; JHN 8:54–8:55, JHN 16:2–16:3

Among his disciples

JHN 14:8–14:11 See also LUK 18:31–18:34; JHN 14:5–14:7

God is not ignorant of human sin and motives

GEN 6:5; HEB 4:13 See also EXO 3:7; JOB 28:12–28:28; PSA 139:1–139:6, PSA 147:5; EZK 11:5; MAT 6:8; ACT 1:24

Human ignorance of sin and the revelation of God**The fall brought knowledge of sin**

GEN 3:22 See also GEN 3:4–3:7

The OT law exposed the nature of sin

ROM 7:7 See also ROM 3:20, ROM 4:15, ROM 5:13

Human ignorance does not excuse sin**By individuals**

LEV 5:17–5:19 The law made provision for atonement of sins committed as a result of ignorance. See also LEV 4:27–4:35; NUM 15:27–15:29; EZK 45:20

By the nation

LEV 4:13–4:21 See also NUM 15:22–15:26; HEB 9:7

By leaders

LEV 4:22–4:26 See also LEV 4:3–4:12

Sin committed in ignorance incurs a lesser judgment than other sin

LUK 12:47–12:48 See also PRO 24:12; ROM 2:14–2:15

Repentance of sin committed in ignorance brings forgiveness

GEN 20:1–20:18 See also ACT 3:17–3:20; 1TI 1:13

Ignorance of God and salvation**There is no salvation outside Jesus Christ**

ACT 4:12 See also JHN 14:6; 1TI 2:5–2:6

Believers have a responsibility to remove ignorance of the gospel

ROM 10:14–10:17 See also MAT 28:19–28:20

Ignorance and God's judgment**The justice of God in salvation**

GEN 18:25 See also DEU 32:4; NEH 9:33; PRO 24:12; DAN 4:37; LUK 12:47–12:48

God's judgment falls on all who do not know him

2TH 1:8–1:10 See also PSA 79:6; JER 10:25; ROM 2:8

God's judgment falls severely on those who choose to disobey him

PRO 1:28–1:32 on Israel; ACT 17:29–17:31; ; HEB 2:2–2:3; ; 2PE 2:20–2:22

6184: imagination

The human ability to form mental pictures, often used to refer to human desires or schemes which are inclined towards evil. Scripture often treats the human heart as the focus of the imagination.

6185: imagination, inward desires

The usually sinful inclinations of a heart which is by nature corrupt and stubborn, but which may be renewed by God, resulting in purified desires.

The heart is the source of human desires

PRO 4:23 See also PSA 10:3; MAT 12:34–12:35 parallel LUK 6:45

God knows the human heart

1KI 8:39; 1CH 28:9 See also ISA 16:7 God's choice of David; PSA 7:9, PSA 19:14, PSA 26:2, PSA 38:9, PSA 44:21, PSA 139:2, PSA 139:23; PRO 15:26, PRO 21:2; JER 11:20 The plot of Jeremiah's enemies is revealed to him by the LORD; JER 20:12; EZK 11:5; REV 2:23; MAT 9:4 parallels MRK 2:8, LUK 5:22 Jesus Christ knows the thoughts of others.

The corruption of the heart**Its inclination towards evil**

GEN 6:5 See also GEN 8:21; PSA 14:1–14:3 parallel PSA 53:1–53:3; PSA 94:11; ECC 9:3; JER 17:9–17:10; MAT 15:18–15:19 parallel MRK 7:20–7:23

Corruption finds particular expression in sexual sin

ROM 1:24 See also MAT 5:28; ROM 1:26–1:27; GAL 5:19

The stubbornness of the heart

It leads to disregard for God
ISA 65:2

It produces false confidence
DEU 29:18–29:19 See also JER 23:17

It leads to idolatry
JER 9:14 See also JER 13:10

It leads to disobedience
JER 7:24 See also JER 16:12

It brings God's judgment
JER 11:8 See also PRO 28:14, PRO 29:1; JER 18:12–18:13; ROM 2:5; HEB 3:7–3:11; PSA 95:7–95:11

God allows people to continue in their stubbornness
 God hardens Pharaoh's heart: EXO 4:21, EXO 7:3, EXO 14:4, EXO 14:17; PSA 81:11–81:12; ; ROM 1:28

God's renewal of the heart

It results in purified desires
JER 24:7; EZK 36:26 See also DEU 6:6; EZK 11:19; ROM 12:2; 2CO 4:6; EPH 4:23; PHP 4:8–4:9; HEB 8:10; JER 31:33

Examples of renewed hearts
 2CH 11:16; ; NEH 9:8; ; PSA 51:10, PSA 57:7, PSA 86:11; ; JER 3:17

God delights in a pure heart
PSA 24:3–24:5 See also DEU 5:29; PSA 73:1, PSA 125:4; MAT 5:8

God fulfils the desires of hearts devoted to him
PSA 37:4 See also PSA 21:2, PSA 145:19; MAT 6:21 parallel LUK 12:34; MAT 6:33 parallel LUK 12:31

God gives the desire to follow him
1CH 29:18

The human ability to visualise in parables
 See also MAT 13:11–13:17 parallels MAT 4:10–4:12, LUK 8:9–8:10; LUK 10:23–10:24

6186: imagination, evil scheming

Human thinking, darkened by sin, expressed in plans which are in opposition to God and which seek to take advantage of others.

Human thought is darkened by sin

As a result of rejecting God's revelation
ROM 1:21 See also PSA 10:2–10:4; 2CO 3:14; EPH 4:17–4:18; TIT 1:15

As a result of excessive alcohol
 PRO 23:33

As a result of Satan's activity
 2CO 4:4; ; EPH 2:1–2:3

Sinful human thinking finds expression in evil ways

In evil schemes and plans
PRO 6:16–6:18 See also GEN 11:6; PSA 36:4, PSA 64:5–64:6; PRO 6:14, PRO 12:20, PRO 14:22, PRO 24:8–24:9; ECC 8:11; ROM 1:30

In scheming against God
2CO 10:5 See also DEU 31:21; PSA 2:1–2:2; HOS 7:15; NAM 1:11

In scheming against others
LAM 3:60–3:61 See also DEU 15:9 warnings against evil thinking as the year for cancelling debts approaches; JOB 21:27; PSA 10:2–10:3, PSA 37:7, PSA 38:12, PSA 41:7–41:8, PSA 140:1–140:2; ISA 32:7; ZEC 8:16–8:17; MAT 26:3–26:4 parallels MRK 14:1–14:2, LUK 22:1–22:2, JHN 11:53 Jewish religious leaders plot against Jesus Christ.

Human plans are an expression of pride
JAS 4:13–4:16 See also PRO 18:11; ISA 10:7–10:11, ISA 30:1; LUK 12:16–12:20

Evil plans will fail
LUK 1:51 See also EST 9:25; PSA 21:11–21:12, PSA 33:10; PRO 19:21; ISA 8:10, ISA 19:3, ISA 66:18; MIC 2:1; NAM 1:9

False prophecy comes from evil thinking
EZK 13:2–13:3 See also DEU 13:1–13:3; JER 23:16–23:17; EZK 13:17

6187: immorality

Behaviour which is contrary to the will of God for his people. Although the term may be used to refer to a wide range of immoral actions, it is used especially in relation to unacceptable sexual behaviour.

6188: immorality, nature of sexual

Sexual behaviour which is contrary to God's law.

Sexual immorality is widespread in the world
1CO 5:9–5:10 See also 1CO 7:1–7:2; REV 9:21

The cause of sexual immorality
GAL 5:19 See also MAT 15:19–15:20 parallel MRK 7:21–7:23; EPH 4:17–4:19

The folly of sexual immorality
PRO 6:32 See also PRO 5:3–5:5, PRO 5:20, PRO 6:26

Sexual immorality brings punishment

HEB 13:4 See also LEV 20:10–20:21; PRO 2:16–2:19, PRO 22:14; EZK 16:38; ROM 1:24–1:27; EPH 5:5; COL 3:5–3:6; 1TH 4:3–4:6; JUD 1:7; REV 21:8, REV 22:15

Sexual immorality has no place in the Christian life

1TH 4:3, 1TH 4:7 See also ACT 15:20, ACT 15:29, ACT 21:25; ROM 13:13; 1CO 6:9–6:11, 1CO 6:13–6:20, 1CO 10:8; EPH 5:3; COL 3:5; HEB 12:16

Forgiveness for sexual immorality

1CO 6:11 See also LUK 7:36–7:39; JHN 8:3–8:11

6189: immorality, examples of sexual**Prohibited sexual relationships****Incest**

LEV 18:6 See also GEN 19:33–19:36 Lot's daughters; GEN 35:22, GEN 38:13–38:18; LEV 18:7–18:20; 2SA 16:22; 1CO 5:1 more likely referring to his stepmother

Adultery

2SA 11:4; ; JER 23:14, JER 29:23; ; HOS 1:2; ; JHN 4:17–4:18

Prostitution

1CO 6:15–6:16 See also JDG 16:1; 1KI 3:16; HOS 4:13–4:15

Fornication

NUM 25:1, NUM 25:6; ; 1SA 2:22

Rape

GEN 34:1–34:2; ; 2SA 13:10–13:14

Homosexuality

GEN 19:5 the men of Sodom; ; JDG 19:22 the men of Gibeah

Sexual immorality among Christians

1CO 5:1; ; 2PE 2:13–2:14; ; JUD 1:4; ; REV 2:14, REV 2:20

Sexual immorality as a picture of spiritual unfaithfulness**Among God's people**

JER 3:20 See also JER 13:26–13:27 reflecting the immorality of the pagan religions in which Israel had indulged; EZK 6:9, EZK 16:15–16:17; HOS 2:1–2:10, HOS 3:1, HOS 4:10–4:12, HOS 5:4; MAT 12:39, MAT 16:4

In the world

REV 14:8, REV 17:1–17:2, REV 17:4, REV 18:2, REV 19:2

6193: impenitence

A deliberate and persistent refusal to repent or to submit to God's will.

6194: impenitence, warnings against

Scripture stresses the seriousness of impenitence. Despite the goodness of God, some sinners refuse to repent and turn to him in faith.

Impenitence is a refusal to turn from sin

HOS 7:10; ACT 7:51 See also JOB 34:33; ISA 1:4; JER 9:6; HOS 11:5

Impenitence in spite of God's invitations and warnings

ISA 66:4; ZEC 7:11–7:12 See also 2KI 17:14; ZEC 1:4JER 7:25–7:26, JER 11:7–11:8, JER 11:10, JER 13:10, JER 17:23, JER 25:3–25:4, JER 32:33, JER 44:4–44:5, JER 44:16

Impenitence in spite of God's dealings

NUM 14:11 See also NEH 9:17; MAT 11:20–11:24 parallel LUK 10:13–10:15

Impenitence in spite of God's punishment

PSA 78:31–78:32; AMO 4:6 See also ISA 9:13; JER 2:30, JER 3:2–3:3, JER 5:3, JER 30:15; ZEP 3:2; HAG 2:17

Impenitence in spite of God's goodness

ROM 2:4 See also JOB 15:11 Although inappropriate for Job, the advice is still valid; ROM 10:21

There is no remedy for persistent impenitence

2CH 36:16; 2TH 2:10 See also HEB 6:4–6:6, HEB 10:26–10:27

6195: impenitence, results of

The seriousness of the failure to repent is frequently underlined in Scripture, which provides numerous examples of impenitence and its consequences.

Warnings against impenitence

HEB 12:25 See also 2CH 30:6–30:9; JER 4:1, JER 18:9–18:10; EZK 14:6; HOS 14:1–14:2; MAL 3:7; LUK 13:1–13:5; HEB 3:7–3:19; PSA 95:7–95:8; REV 2:5, REV 2:16

Results of impenitence**Storing up wrath for the day of judgment**

ROM 2:5 See also 2CH 24:20, 2CH 36:16–36:17; JOB 36:12; PRO 1:24–1:26; AMO 4:9; ROM 1:24; 2PE 2:21

Condemnation

MAT 11:20

Hardness of heart

MAT 13:13–13:15 See also HEB 3:7–3:11

Spiritual blindness

JHN 12:40 See also ROM 11:8; REV 3:17

Being forsaken by God

2KI 17:13–17:20; ; 2CH 29:6–29:9

Examples of repentance

EXO 8:15 Pharaoh; JDG 2:19; ; 1SA 8:19; ; NEH 9:26–9:29; ; DAN 9:13–9:14; 2CH 33:23 Amon; ; 2CH 36:13 Zedekiah; ; JER 6:15 inhabitants of Jerusalem; ; MAT 21:31 the elders and chief priests; ; LUK 18:18 the hard-hearted; ; ROM 1:18–1:23 the pagans; ; REV 2:21–2:27 Jezebel, the false prophetess; REV 9:20–9:21, REV 16:8–16:11

6199: imperfection

The state of incompleteness or decay that characterises the fallen world. Although God created the world perfect, it lapsed into its present state of imperfection through human sin.

6200: imperfection, influence of

Scripture indicates that the world, including human beings and institutions, are imperfect because of the contaminating influence of sin. This influence extends to the household of faith: both Israel and the Christian church are portrayed as prone to sin and weakness.

The creation is imperfect because of sin

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also GEN 5:29; ROM 8:20–8:22

Imperfection is expressed in corruption and death

PSA 103:15–103:16; 2PE 1:4 See also 2SA 14:14; PSA 90:3–90:10; ECC 12:1–12:7; JAS 1:10; 1PE 1:24

The imperfection of the spiritual creation

JOB 4:18; JUD 1:6 See also 2PE 2:4

The universal imperfection of human beings

ROM 3:23 See also GEN 6:5; 1KI 8:46 parallel 2CH 6:36; PSA 14:3, PSA 130:3; PRO 20:9; ECC 7:20; ISA 53:6, ISA 64:6; GAL 3:22; JAS 3:2

The imperfection of the household of faith**Israel and her leaders**

NEH 9:34; JER 2:21 See also JDG 2:11–2:13; NEH 9:16; PSA 106:39; ISA 3:14; JER 50:6; EZK 20:30; MIC 3:1–3:3

The Christian church and its leaders

2CO 12:20; PHP 3:12 See also 1CO 3:1–3:3, 1CO 13:12; COL 2:20; HEB 5:12; 1JN 1:8; REV 3:2, REV 3:17

6201: imperfection, and God's purposes

The unacceptable falling short of the God-given ideal must be resisted and overcome.

Imperfection is contrary to God's purpose**In creation**

GEN 1:31

For individuals

EPH 1:4

For the church

EPH 5:25–5:27

Imperfection is unacceptable in God's presence**Sacrificial animals must be unblemished**

DEU 15:21; MAL 1:8 See also EXO 12:5; LEV 22:20–22:25; NUM 28:31; DEU 17:1

The priests must be physically perfect

LEV 21:17–21:23

Moral imperfection separates from God

ISA 59:2 See also PSA 66:18; ISA 50:1, ISA 64:7; 1CO 6:9–6:10; EPH 5:5; HEB 10:26–10:27; REV 21:27, REV 22:15

God's people should strive against imperfection

MAT 5:48 See also GEN 17:1; DEU 18:13; PSA 34:14; ROM 12:9; 2CO 13:11; COL 1:28, COL 3:5; 1TH 5:22; 2TI 2:19; HEB 6:1, HEB 12:14; 2PE 3:14

Imperfection will be dealt with at Jesus Christ's return**Creation will be remade**

ISA 65:17 See also ISA 66:22; MAT 19:28; ROM 8:19–8:21; 2PE 3:13; REV 21:1–21:5

God's people will be perfected

1JN 3:2 See also PHP 3:20–3:21

Evil will be removed

REV 21:4 See also ISA 25:8, ISA 65:19; 2TH 2:8; REV 20:10, REV 21:8

6203: mortality

The human state of being subject to death and decay. God did not create human beings to be like this; mortality is the consequence of sin and is countered by the gospel promise of eternal life in Jesus Christ.

Mortality originated in the fall

GEN 2:16–2:17

It is the decree of God

PSA 90:3, PSA 90:5 See also GEN 3:19, GEN 6:3

It is universal

ECC 3:20 See also 1CO 15:22

It is inevitable

2SA 14:14; ; JOB 30:23; ; ECC 3:2; ; ROM 6:23

It is a judgment from God**ROM 5:12** See also ROM 5:15–5:19**It leads to judgment****HEB 9:27** See also 2CO 5:10**Mortality extends to the creation**

ROM 8:20–8:21

Human beings likened to the animals

ECC 3:19

Human beings likened to the grass

PSA 90:5–90:6, PSA 103:15–103:16; ; ISA 40:6–40:7; ; 1PE 1:24; ; JAS 1:10

The natural reaction to mortality**A sense of oppression**

JOB 10:8–10:9

Carefree abandon**1CO 15:32** See also ISA 22:13**The godly reaction to mortality****Humility**

JOB 20:6–20:11; ; PSA 22:29, PSA 89:48; ; ECC 3:21–3:22

Trust

LUK 12:25

The pursuit of wisdom**PSA 90:12****Saving faith****ISA 55:6** See also PSA 39:4–39:8; 2CO 6:2**The struggle with sin**

ROM 6:12, ROM 7:14–7:25

Death is not the end**The spirit returns to God****ECC 12:7** See also PHP 1:23**The body will be raised****DAN 12:2; 1CO 15:53–15:54** See also ISA 25:8; ROM 8:11; 1CO 15:42–15:44; 2CO 5:4**Eternal life through Jesus Christ****JHN 11:25–11:26** See also MAT 25:46; 2TI 1:9–1:10; 1JN 5:11–5:12; REV 22:3–22:5**Eternal punishment for the wicked**

MAT 25:46; ; REV 14:11, REV 20:10, REV 20:15

6206: offence

A transgression or affront against the law or an individual. The gospel itself is seen as offensive by unbelievers, who are often unable to cope with its radical challenge to their unbelief.

Legal offence**DEU 21:22–21:23** See also EXO 21:15–21:25, EXO 22:1–22:5; DEU 19:15–19:21**Moral offence****EZK 22:11** See also EXO 22:16–22:17; LEV 18:6–18:23; DEU 22:13–22:30; 2SA 3:8; 1CO 6:9–6:10**An offence to others****On a national level****1SA 13:4** See also 2SA 10:6 parallel 1CH 19:6; JER 24:9**On a personal level****2SA 16:21** See also GEN 20:1–20:16, GEN 40:1; 1SA 25:14–25:28 Abigail seeks David's forgiveness for Nabal's offence; JOB 19:17; PRO 17:9, PRO 18:19, PRO 19:11; MAT 13:54–13:57 parallel MRK 6:1–6:4 The people of Nazareth take offence at Jesus Christ; MAT 15:1–15:12, MAT 17:24–17:27; JHN 6:53–6:66**Offence against God****1KI 8:50–8:51** Offence against God is synonymous with sin. See also JOB 7:21, JOB 10:14, JOB 13:23 "wrongs", "sins" and "offence" are three important OT terms for sin; JOB 14:16–14:17, JOB 34:31–34:33; PSA 59:3, PSA 139:24; ISA 43:24, ISA 44:22, ISA 59:12; EZK 18:1–18:32 Ezekiel warns that the soul who sins will die; EZK 33:10, EZK 37:23, EZK 39:24; AMO 5:12**Offence against God's house****NUM 18:1** See also NUM 18:23**The things of God are an offence to sinful people****JER 6:10; 1CO 1:22–1:24** See also GAL 5:11**A stumbling-block as an object of offence****A stumbling-block for others****ROM 14:13** The concept behind the English word "offence" is one of striking against something or someone. The image of a stumbling-block conveys the idea of tripping or falling as a result of striking against such an object. See also LEV 19:14; MAT 16:23; ROM 11:9–11:10; PSA 69:22–69:23; 1CO 8:9; 2CO 6:3**A stumbling-block for oneself****EZK 14:7** See also EZK 14:3–14:4**A stumbling-block set up by God****EZK 3:20****6209: pagans****OT use of the term "pagan"****Used of foreign adherents of heathen religions****ISA 2:6** See also 2KI 23:4–23:7; ZEP 1:4–1:6

Used of heathen religions, peoples and countries
ISA 57:8 See also LAM 1:10; AMO 7:17

In the Gospels pagans” is synonymous with Gentiles”

MAT 6:7 See also MAT 5:47, MAT 6:32 parallel LUK 12:30; MAT 18:17

The term “pagans” is used to refer to people who were neither Jews nor Christians

Pagans as idolaters

1CO 12:2 See also 1CO 10:7; EXO 32:6; 1CO 10:20

Pagans as immoral

1PE 4:3 See also 1CO 5:1

Many believers lived among the pagans

1PE 2:12 See also 3JN 1:7

6212: participation

Sharing in actions or identifying with actions or people. All human beings share in Adam’s fall and its consequences; believers share in Christ and his life.

6213: participation, in sin

The natural condition of all human beings as a result of sharing in Adam’s fall. Believers are called not to associate with, nor give approval to wickedness but to stand apart from evil as God’s holy people.

Participation in Adam

In Adam’s humanity

GEN 3:20, GEN 5:1–5:3; ; JHN 3:6; ; ACT 17:26; ; 1CO 15:48–15:49

In Adam’s sin

ROM 5:12 See also HOS 6:7; ROM 5:15–5:19; 1CO 15:21–15:22 GEN 3:17; ROM 8:20–8:21

In a sinful nature

EPH 2:3 See also ROM 7:5, ROM 7:14–7:20

Ways of participating in evil

Associating with evildoers

PSA 50:18 See also GEN 49:6; LEV 15:31; JOS 23:12–23:13; JOB 34:8; PSA 141:4; PRO 22:24–22:25; 2JN 1:10–1:11 giving hospitality to evildoers

Giving approval to evil

LEV 19:17; PSA 64:5; ROM 1:32 See also 2SA 3:28–3:29, 2SA 3:37; PSA 49:13; EZK 13:22; LUK 11:48; ACT 7:60, ACT 22:20; ROM 14:22; EPH 5:11

Sacrifice and idolatry

NUM 25:1–25:3 See also 2KI 17:33; HOS 4:17; 1CO 10:18–10:20

God’s people are not to participate in evil

God’s people are called to be holy

LEV 20:26 See also LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:2; 1PE 1:15–1:16

Separation from foreign gods

JOS 23:7 See also DEU 12:30, DEU 29:18; 1KI 11:2

Separation from the godless

EZR 10:11 Too close an association with the nations round about, particularly in marriage, would cause Israel to compromise her unique relationship with God; **2CO 6:14** Often related to marriage, this applies to all close alliances with unbelievers. See also EZR 4:1–4:3, EZR 9:1–9:2 **REV 18:4** See also EZR 10:2; NEH 2:20, NEH 10:30, NEH 13:26–13:27; JER 51:45; 1CO 7:39; 2CO 6:17; ISA 52:11

Separation from evildoers

1TI 5:22 See also ROM 16:17; 1CO 5:9–5:11; 2TH 3:14

6214: participation, in Christ

The joining of believers to Jesus Christ, through faith, whereby they are freed from participation in Adam by sharing in Christ’s death and resurrection, his nature, sufferings and glory and whereby, too, they become part of his body. Believers therefore share in the fellowship, ministry and hope of God’s people, which is anticipated by the OT and fulfilled in the church.

Believers are united with Christ

EPH 1:13 See also JHN 13:8; 1CO 1:9, 1CO 6:17; HEB 3:14

Faith liberates from participation in sin

ROM 5:15; GAL 5:24 See also ROM 5:16–5:21; 1CO 15:21–15:22; COL 2:11

Participation in Christ

In Christ’s death and resurrection

ROM 6:3–6:4; GAL 2:20 See also ROM 6:5–6:8, ROM 7:4; GAL 3:27; COL 2:12–2:13; 2TI 2:11

In Christ’s nature

2PE 1:4 See also ROM 8:29; 1CO 15:49; 2CO 3:18, 2CO 5:17; COL 3:10; HEB 12:10

In Christ’s sufferings

PHP 3:10 See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; 2CO 1:5; 1PE 4:13

In Christ’s glory

ROM 8:17 See also JHN 17:22; EPH 2:6; 2TH 2:14; 2TI 2:12

Participation in Christ’s body

1CO 10:16–10:17 See also ROM 12:5; 1CO 12:27

Sharing unity through Christ**GAL 3:28** See also 1CO 1:2; EPH 2:21–2:22; COL 3:11**Sharing a source of life****EPH 4:16** See also JHN 15:4–15:5; ROM 11:17; COL 2:19**Sharing an inheritance****GAL 3:29** See also 1SA 26:19; PSA 106:5; ACT 3:25, ACT 20:32; COL 1:12; HEB 6:17**Sharing spiritual blessings****EPH 1:3** See also ROM 15:27; PHP 1:7; HEB 6:4; JUD 1:3**Sharing a hope****1PE 5:1** See also LUK 20:35; 2TH 1:10; REV 20:6**Sharing in worship****1CO 14:26** See also 2CH 5:12–5:13; NEH 12:24**Accepting responsibility towards others****1CO 12:26** See also GAL 6:1–6:2; PHP 2:1–2:4**Sharing one another's sufferings**

2CO 1:4, 2CO 1:7; ; PHP 4:14; ; 2TI 1:8; ; HEB 10:33–10:34; ; REV 1:9

Sharing with those in need

EZE 45:16; ; ACT 4:32; ; 2CO 8:4, 2CO 9:13; ; 1TI 6:18; ; HEB 13:16

Sharing in God's work**2CO 6:1; PHP 1:5** Paul thanks the Philippians for their active support of his ministry. See also NUM 8:24, NUM 18:2; 1CH 16:38; EZR 3:2; ROM 15:30; 1CO 9:10–9:13; 2CO 5:20; GAL 2:7–2:9; PHP 4:15–4:16**Participation in Christ demands holiness****1CO 10:21** See also 1CO 6:15; EPH 5:6–5:7; COL 3:1–3:5**Participation of the nations in God's salvation****Gentiles are included among God's people****EPH 3:6** See also ROM 11:24; GAL 3:8–3:9; GEN 12:3, GEN 18:18, GEN 22:18; GAL 3:14**God's promise to include the nations****ZEC 2:11** See also ISA 2:3 parallel MIC 4:2; ISA 14:1, ISA 19:23–19:25; ZEP 2:11; ZEC 14:16**6218: provoking God**

The arousing of God's righteous anger in response to the sin of his people, particularly their idolatry.

God is provoked by sin and disobedience**DEU 9:7–9:8** See also NUM 32:9–32:13; DEU 31:29; JOS 7:1; 2SA 6:6–6:7 parallel 1CH 13:9–13:10 Uzzah's disobedience in touching the ark cost him his life; 2SA 24:1; 1KI 15:30, 1KI 16:2–16:3, 1KI 16:7, 1KI 21:21–21:22; 2KI 21:14–21:15; ISA 65:1–65:5; JER 32:30–32:33**God is provoked by the rejection of his chosen leaders and prophets****2CH 36:15–36:16** See also NUM 12:1, NUM 12:9**God is provoked by injustice****EXO 22:22–22:24** See also ISA 59:15–59:18; EZE 8:17; HOS 12:14**God is provoked by complaining****NUM 11:1** See also EXO 4:10–4:14; NUM 11:4–11:10, NUM 11:33**God is provoked by idolatry****DEU 4:25–4:26; EZE 16:26** See also DEU 9:16–9:19; JDG 2:12–2:13, JDG 3:5–3:8; 1KI 14:9, 1KI 14:15, 1KI 16:13, 1KI 16:26, 1KI 16:33, 1KI 22:53; 2KI 17:11, 2KI 22:17, 2KI 23:25–23:27; 2CH 28:25; PSA 78:58–78:59, PSA 106:28–106:29; JER 7:17–7:19, JER 8:19, JER 25:6–25:7, JER 44:3, JER 44:8; EZE 20:28**God is provoked by human sacrifice**

2KI 17:17, 2KI 21:6 parallel 2CH 33:6

6221: rebellion

A state of revolt against established divine or human authority. Scripture condemns rebellion against God and indicates the futility of Israel's frequent rebellions against him.

6222: rebellion, against God

The human race is in rebellion against God through its disobedience and unbelief.

Examples of rebellion against God**PSA 2:2** See also NUM 20:24, NUM 27:14; 1SA 15:22–15:23; PSA 66:7**Warnings not to rebel****1SA 12:14–12:15** See also NUM 14:9, NUM 17:10; PSA 2:10–2:12; EZE 2:8**Indignation expressed over rebellion against God**

PSA 5:10

The fate of the rebellious**ISA 66:24** See also DEU 13:5; PSA 68:6; JER 28:16, JER 29:32; LAM 1:18, LAM 1:20, LAM 3:42; HOS 13:16**God is ready to forgive those who rebel against him****JER 33:8** See also DAN 9:5–9:9**The end times will be characterised by open rebellion against God****2TH 2:3** See also 1JN 2:18

6223: rebellion, of Israel

Despite God's repeated mercy, Israel's history is seen as a history of rebellion against God.

The history of Israel is seen as a history of rebellion

PSA 78:40 See also PSA 78:8, PSA 78:17, PSA 78:56; DEU 31:27; PSA 105:28, PSA 106:7, PSA 107:11; ISA 63:10; EZK 20:8, EZK 20:13, EZK 20:21

God's compassion and readiness to deliver his people

NEH 9:28 See also NEH 9:16–9:31; PSA 106:43

Examples of Israel's rebellion

DEU 1:26, DEU 1:43, DEU 9:7, DEU 9:23

Prophetic condemnation of Israel's rebellion

HOS 7:13 See also ZEP 3:1

Isaiah depicts Israel as a rebellious nation

ISA 1:2–1:5 See also ISA 1:20, ISA 1:23, ISA 1:28, ISA 30:1, ISA 30:9, ISA 48:8, ISA 65:2–65:3

Jeremiah denounces the Israelites as rebels

JER 6:28 See also JER 2:29, JER 3:13, JER 4:17, JER 5:23

Ezekiel condemns Israel as a rebellious house

EZK 2:5–2:8 See also EZK 3:9, EZK 3:26–3:27, EZK 12:2–12:3, EZK 12:9, EZK 12:25, EZK 17:12, EZK 24:3, EZK 44:6

The rebellion of Israel in the parables of Jesus Christ

MAT 21:33–21:44 parallels MRK 12:1–12:11, LUK 20:9–20:18; ; LUK 13:6–13:9

Israel's rebellion is a warning to believers

1CO 10:6 See also 1CO 10:1–10:12; HEB 3:7–4:2; PSA 95:7–95:11; JUD 1:5, JUD 1:7

6224: rebellion, against human authority

Human authority is frequently defied and resisted. To rebel against God's chosen leaders is to defy God himself.

Examples of rebellion against human leaders

GEN 14:3–14:4 See also 2KI 18:7, 2KI 24:1, 2KI 24:20 parallels 2CH 36:13, JER 52:3; 2CH 13:6; MRK 15:7

Rebellion against parents

DEU 21:18–21:21

The rebellion of nations

1KI 12:19 parallel 2CH 10:19; ; 2KI 1:1

Accusations of rebellion

NEH 2:19, NEH 6:5–6:8

Rebellion against God's chosen leaders

EXO 23:21 See also NUM 16:1–16:3, NUM 20:2–20:5; JOS 1:18; 2SA 15:10

Rebellion against legitimate authority is condemned

ROM 13:2 See also 1PE 2:13

6227: regret

Deep feelings of sorrow arising from past events now seen as sins, mistakes or misfortunes. It can either lead to true repentance or destructive bitterness.

Examples and expressions of regret

1SA 26:21 See also GEN 27:33–27:35; NUM 12:10–12:12 Aaron and Miriam when they had spoken against Moses; NUM 14:1–14:2; JDG 11:34–11:35 Jephthah when he returned home from fighting the Ammonites 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; 2SA 24:14 parallel 1CH 21:13 1KI 21:27 Ahab after he murdered Naboth and seized his vineyard; DAN 6:14; MAT 26:75 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:61–22:62 Peter when he disowned Jesus Christ; MAT 27:3–27:4 Judas after betraying Jesus Christ

Divine expressions of regret

GEN 6:6 See also 1SA 15:10–15:11, 1SA 15:35; 2SA 24:16 parallel 1CH 21:15

Actions which may lead to regret

PRO 5:11–5:14; ; 1TI 6:9–6:10

The bitterness of vain regrets

There is no remedy for bitter regrets

HEB 12:16–12:17 See also GEN 27:41; 2SA 18:33; PRO 28:17; EZK 7:16–7:18; LUK 13:24–13:28; REV 1:7

The unending remorse of the lost

DAN 12:2 See also ISA 66:24; MAT 8:12, MAT 25:30; MRK 9:47–9:48; LUK 16:22–16:23; REV 14:11

Regret is an element of true repentance

2CO 7:8–7:10 See also NUM 14:39–14:40; 2SA 12:13–12:17; 2KI 22:18–22:20 parallel 2CH 34:26–34:28 Josiah's response on finding the Book of the Law; EZR 10:1, EZR 10:6; PSA 38:2–38:8, PSA 51:3; JER 3:21–3:25; JOL 2:12; JON 3:6–3:9 the repentance of Nineveh; MAT 5:4; LUK 15:17–15:19 the prodigal son; ACT 2:37

Absence of regret

Sinning without shame

JER 6:15; ; ZEP 3:5; ; 1CO 5:1–5:2

When the wicked die

2CH 21:20

At the end of life

2SA 23:5; ; 2TI 4:6–4:8

In God's new creation

ISA 65:17–65:19 See also ISA 35:10; REV 21:4

6230: rejection

The deliberate and conscious act of turning away from someone, or refusing to accept something that is being offered.

6231: rejection of God

The deliberate rejection of God lies at the heart of human sin. It is seen in rebellion against God's authority, purpose and instruction and results in the rejection of God's servants and, ultimately, in the rejection of his Son.

Rejection of God**Rejection of God's authority**

2KI 17:15 See also ISA 1:4

Rejection of God in favour of other gods

DEU 32:15–32:18 See also EXO 22:20; DEU 31:20; 1SA 8:8; ISA 1:28, ISA 65:11; JER 15:6; EZK 14:5

Rejection of God as king

1SA 8:7 See also 1SA 10:19

Rejection of God's ways

PSA 95:10; ISA 30:15 See also EXO 16:7–16:8; NUM 11:18–11:20, NUM 14:27; PSA 81:11–81:13; ISA 8:6, ISA 30:1–30:2; LUK 7:30

Rejection of the covenant

1KI 19:10 See also LEV 26:15; 1KI 19:14; HOS 8:1

Rejection of the promised land

NUM 14:1–14:4, NUM 14:31; ; NEH 9:30

Rejection of God's compassion

MAT 23:37 See also 2CH 36:15; NEH 9:30; HOS 11:1–11:4

Rejection of God's word**Rejection of God's instruction**

1SA 15:10–15:11; 1TH 4:8 See also 1SA 15:23, 1SA 15:26; PSA 50:17; PRO 1:24–1:25, PRO 5:12

Rejection of God's law

LEV 26:43; HOS 4:6 See also 2KI 17:26; ISA 5:24; JER 6:19, JER 8:8–8:9; EZK 5:6, EZK 20:13, EZK 20:16, EZK 20:24; AMO 2:4; MRK 7:13 parallel MAT 15:6

Rejection of God's messages

ISA 30:12 See also ISA 65:12; JER 6:10, JER 7:13, JER 35:17, JER 36:23–36:24; ACT 13:46

Rejection of God's messengers

2CH 36:16; ACT 7:52 See also 2CH 30:10; JER 20:8; ZEC 7:12; MAT 21:33–21:39 parallels MRK 12:1–12:8, LUK 20:9–20:15; ACT 7:35, ACT 7:39

Rejection of Jesus Christ**Jesus Christ's rejection was prophesied**

PSA 118:22; ISA 53:3 It is generally accepted that God's servant in Isaiah chapter 53 refers to Jesus Christ; **MRK 8:31** parallels MAT 16:21, LUK 9:22 See also ISA 49:7, ISA 50:6, ISA 52:14, ISA 53:7–53:8 MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17; ACT 4:11; 1PE 2:7 MRK 9:12 parallel MAT 17:12; LUK 17:25; ROM 9:33; ISA 28:16

The rejection of his earthly ministry

JHN 1:11 MAT 13:54–13:58 parallel MRK 6:1–6:6; ; LUK 4:28–4:29; JHN 5:40, JHN 5:43, JHN 6:41–6:42, JHN 8:59, JHN 9:16, JHN 10:31; MAT 27:22–27:23 parallels MRK 15:12–15:14, LUK 23:20–23:23; ; JHN 11:53, JHN 19:6, JHN 19:15; ; ACT 2:23, ACT 4:10, ACT 7:52

6232: rejection of God, results of

Rejecting God angers and grieves him. To reject God can be to reject all the benefits of the gospel, and can lead to judgment and punishment.

Rejection grieves God**God rejected as Creator**

GEN 6:6

God rejected as a husband

EZK 6:9 See also JER 2:2, JER 3:20, JER 31:32; HOS 1:2

God rejected as a father

HOS 11:1–11:4 See also DEU 32:18; JER 3:19, JER 31:20

God rejected by Israel, his vineyard

ISA 5:4 See also JER 2:21

Rejection angers God and brings his wrath

EZR 8:22; JHN 3:36 See also LEV 26:27–26:28; 2CH 36:16; ZEC 7:12; ROM 2:8

The results of rejecting God**Judgment**

JER 1:16; JHN 12:48 See also LEV 26:14–26:17; PSA 50:22; PRO 1:24–1:26; ISA 28:22; JER 6:19, JER 15:6, JER 26:4–26:6; AMO 2:4–2:5; JHN 3:18–3:19

God rejects his people

DEU 32:19; ; PSA 78:59, PSA 119:118; ; JER 6:30, JER 7:29; ; HOS 9:7

God rejects those who reject him

HOS 4:6; MAT 10:33 parallel LUK 12:9 See also 1CH 28:9; 2CH 15:2; LUK 9:26

God hides his face

DEU 31:17–31:18, DEU 32:20; ; PSA 88:14; ; ISA 1:15; ; MIC 3:4

God rejects the sanctuary and its worship

LEV 26:31; ; 1KI 9:6–9:7 parallel 2CH 7:19–7:20; ; LAM 2:7; ; EZK 7:24, EZK 10:18–10:19, EZK 11:22–11:23

God's people are removed from his presence into exile

2KI 17:18–17:20, 2KI 17:23, 2KI 23:27, 2KI 24:3, 2KI 24:20 parallel JER 52:3; ; JER 7:15, JER 15:1

Examples of others rejected by God

Esau: ROM 9:13; ; MAL 1:2–1:3; 1SA 15:23, 1SA 15:26, 1SA 16:1, 1SA 28:15–28:16; JER 22:24–22:25 Jehoiachin

God's rejection is not final

LEV 26:44; ROM 11:15 See also 1SA 12:22; 2CH 7:14; PSA 66:20; ISA 41:9, ISA 49:21, ISA 54:5–54:8; JER 31:37, JER 33:24–33:26; ZEC 10:6; ROM 11:1, ROM 11:25–11:29

6233: rejection, human experience of

Feelings of rejection by God may be a result of alienation caused directly or indirectly by sin. God's people also experience rejection by a hostile world. Experiences and feelings of rejection are to be met with prayer, forgiveness and perseverance, together with confidence in God's commitment to and compassion for, his people.

Feelings of rejection by God**Feelings of national rejection**

PSA 74:1; ISA 49:14 See also PSA 44:9, PSA 108:11; ISA 40:27; JER 13:17, JER 14:9; LAM 1:2, LAM 5:20; EZK 37:11

Feelings of personal rejection

PSA 13:1; MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34 Jesus Christ experiences separation from his Father as a consequence of bearing human sin. See also PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 43:2, PSA 88:14

God's servants experience rejection**Samuel**

1SA 8:5–8:7

Elijah

1KI 19:10 See also 1KI 18:22, 1KI 19:1–19:4

The psalmist

PSA 41:7 See also PSA 22:6–22:8, PSA 31:12–31:13, PSA 69:20, PSA 71:10

Jeremiah

JER 15:10 See also JER 20:7–20:9, JER 20:14–20:15, JER 20:18

Jesus Christ

ISA 53:5; JHN 1:11 See also LUK 23:18

Jesus Christ's disciples

JHN 15:18 See also MAT 5:10–5:11 parallel LUK 6:22; JHN 17:14; ACT 13:50, ACT 14:19, ACT 16:22; 2TI 3:12; 1PE 4:12

Responding to rejection**Appealing to God**

2CH 6:42; PSA 27:9, PSA 71:12 See also PSA 22:9–22:11, PSA 22:19–22:21, PSA 44:23–44:24, PSA 51:11–51:12, PSA 77:7–77:12, PSA 132:10; JER 15:15, JER 20:12; LAM 5:21–5:22

Offering forgiveness

LUK 23:34 See also GEN 50:17; ACT 7:59–7:60; 2TI 4:16

Rejoicing in suffering

MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23; ; ACT 5:41; ; ROM 5:3; ; JAS 1:2–1:3

Persevering

ACT 5:28–5:29, ACT 5:42

Encouragement for those experiencing rejection**God's commitment to his people**

ISA 49:15–49:16 See also PSA 27:10, PSA 94:14; JER 31:20; LAM 3:21–3:24; HOS 11:1–11:4; MAT 10:30–10:31 parallel LUK 12:7

God's compassion and forgiveness

LAM 3:31–3:32 See also DEU 32:36; PSA 130:7–130:8; ISA 12:1–12:2, ISA 49:13; EZK 39:25; HOS 11:8–11:9; 2CO 2:7–2:8 God's readiness to forgive is to be reflected in the attitude of his people towards one another.

God's strengthening

ISA 40:28–40:31; ; 2TI 4:17

God's vindication of his people

PSA 135:14; ; ISA 50:6–50:9, ISA 54:17; ; ROM 8:18; ; 1PE 4:13; ; REV 2:10

Support from fellow believers

2CO 1:4 See also ACT 14:22; 2CO 6:6–6:7

6236: sexual sin

Sexual relations are to be seen as an aspect of God's good creation which can be corrupted and devalued through human sin.

6237: sexual sin, nature of

Any transgression of the limits that God has set for the enjoyment of sex. Such sins are often life-dominating, but may be broken through the power and grace of Jesus Christ.

The origin of sexual sin

Fallen human nature

GAL 5:19 See also ROM 13:12–13:14; COL 3:5–3:6

The heart

MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21–7:22

The offensiveness of sexual sin

It defiles the sinner

MAT 15:20 parallel MRK 7:23 See also ROM 1:24; 1CO 6:18

It defiles society

LEV 18:24–18:25 See also 1CO 5:6; REV 19:2

It offends other people

2PE 2:7–2:8 See also GEN 9:22–9:25, GEN 34:7, GEN 38:24; 2SA 13:21–13:22; 2CO 12:21

It offends God

2SA 11:27 See also JER 13:26–13:27; MAL 3:5

Sexual sin under the old covenant

Pre-marital sex

DEU 22:13–22:21

Adultery

EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18 See also LEV 18:20; DEU 22:22–22:24

Prostitution

LEV 19:29; ; DEU 23:17–23:18

Rape

DEU 22:25–22:29

Homosexual intercourse

LEV 18:22 See also LEV 20:13

Bestiality

EXO 22:19; ; LEV 18:23, LEV 20:15–20:16; ; DEU 27:21

Incest

LEV 18:6–18:18, LEV 20:17, LEV 20:19; ; DEU 22:30, DEU 27:20, DEU 27:22–27:23; ; EZK 22:11

Intercourse during menstruation

LEV 18:19, LEV 20:18

Sexual sin under the new covenant

The OT laws are confirmed and strengthened

MAT 5:27–5:28 See also MAT 5:31–5:32; ROM 1:24–1:27; 1CO 6:15–6:16, 1CO 7:9; HEB 13:4

The need for holiness in the lives of believers

1TH 4:3–4:7 See also ACT 15:29; EPH 5:3; HEB 12:16; 1PE 1:15–1:16; LEV 11:44; 1PE 4:1–4:3

The church must be kept pure

REV 2:14–2:16 See also 1CO 5:1–5:5, 1CO 5:9–5:11; REV 2:20

God's judgment on sexual sin

In this life

REV 2:21–2:23 See also GEN 19:24; NUM 25:1–25:9; 2SA 12:11–12:12; PRO 7:26–7:27; 1CO 10:8

In the world to come

REV 21:8 See also EPH 5:5–5:6; 2PE 2:6; JUD 1:7; REV 22:14–22:15

God's power over sexual sin

It can be forgiven

JHN 8:10–8:11 See also 2SA 12:13; PSA 51:0; MAT 21:31–21:32; LUK 7:36–7:38, LUK 7:47–7:50; REV 2:21

Hearts can be changed

1CO 6:9–6:11

Resisting sexual sin

By remembering God's word

PSA 119:9 See also PRO 6:23–6:24, PRO 7:5

By resisting temptation

GEN 39:6–39:12; ; PRO 7:24–7:25

By mortifying lust

JOB 31:1 See also MAT 5:29–5:30

By living in the Spirit

GAL 5:16

By living for holiness

ROM 6:19

By enjoying sex within proper limits

PRO 5:18–5:20; ; 1CO 7:2, 1CO 7:9

6238: homosexuality

Sexual relations between people of the same sex. The biblical emphasis upon the loving union of male and female, as an integral part of God's creation ordinance, establishes the context against which the censure of homosexual practice is to be set.

God's creation order for sexuality

GEN 1:27–1:28, GEN 2:18–2:24; MRK 10:6–10:9 parallel MAT 19:4–19:5; ; EPH 5:31

OT prohibitions of homosexual practice

LEV 18:22 See also LEV 20:13

Homosexual practice is incompatible with the kingdom of God

1CO 6:9–6:10 The meanings of the Greek words for “male prostitutes” and “homosexual offenders” are disputed, but the terms are commonly associated with particular forms of homosexual behaviour. See also 1TI 1:9–1:11

Sexual disorder is one consequence of rejecting God

ROM 1:21–1:27 1KI 14:24, 1KI 15:12; ; 2KI 23:7

Examples of homosexual practice

In Sodom and Gomorrah: GEN 19:4–19:8; ; JUD 1:7; JDG 19:16–19:24 in Israel in a time of moral decadence

6239: prostitution

Scripture condemns the offering of sex for money or favours. However, it also stresses the prospect of new life in Christ for prostitutes, and points to some prostitutes as examples of faith.

Prostitution among the heathen

For money

GEN 38:15–38:16; ; JOS 2:1; ; JOL 3:3

Religious prostitution

GEN 38:21–38:22; ; JOB 36:14

Prostitution in Israel

It was forbidden under God’s law

LEV 19:29; DEU 23:17–23:18

Priests were forbidden to marry prostitutes

See also LEV 21:7, LEV 21:14

The penalties for prostitution

GEN 38:24; ; LEV 21:9

Efforts to remove the shrine-prostitutes

1KI 15:11–15:12, 1KI 22:45–22:46

The lure of prostitution

PRO 7:10 See also 1CO 6:9

The prevalence of prostitution

1KI 14:24 See also 1KI 3:16; JER 5:7; HOS 4:13–4:14, HOS 6:10; MIC 1:7

Warnings against prostitution

It has dire consequences

PRO 6:25–6:27 See also JDG 16:1–16:2; PRO 23:26–23:27, PRO 29:3; LUK 15:30

Christians must avoid it

1CO 6:15–6:16

Prostitutes can be redeemed

MAT 21:31–21:32 See also LUK 7:37–7:50; 1CO 6:9–6:11; HEB 11:31; JAS 2:25; JOS 6:22–6:25

Prostitution as a metaphor

For worldly corruption

REV 17:1–17:5 See also ISA 23:15–23:17; NAM 3:4

For apostasy

DEU 31:16 See also EXO 34:15–34:16; LEV 20:5; JDG 2:17, JDG 8:27, JDG 8:33; 1CH 5:25; PSA 106:39; ISA 1:21; EZK 16:16–16:17, EZK 16:26, EZK 16:28, EZK 16:33–16:34, EZK 16:41, EZK 23:1–23:35; HOS 4:10–4:12, HOS 5:4

6240: rape

The sexual violation of an individual (normally, though not necessarily, female). This is a deeply traumatic and degrading experience for the victim and is an evil that Scripture condemns.

Lust is the motivation for rape

2SA 13:1–13:15

Women and rape

Women are particularly vulnerable to male assault

2SA 13:14 See also ZEC 14:2

Women were protected under the law

DEU 22:25–22:29

Women are to be loved and cared for

EPH 5:25, EPH 5:28–5:29 See also GEN 12:18–12:20; 1PE 3:7

The trauma of rape

Its psychological and emotional effects

2SA 13:19–13:20 See also GEN 34:6–34:7

Its physical effects

JDG 19:26–19:28 See also JDG 20:4–20:5

Avenging the victim of rape

GEN 34:7–34:31; ; 2SA 13:22–13:32; ; JDG 20:6–20:11; ; ROM 12:19, ROM 13:3–13:4; ; JAS 1:20

Examples of rape

Female rape

GEN 34:1–34:3; ; JDG 19:24–19:25; ; 2SA 13:2–13:13; ; ZEC 14:2

Attempted male rape

GEN 19:4–19:9; ; JDG 19:22–19:23; ; LEV 18:22, LEV 20:13

6241: seduction

The deliberate enticement or persuasion of someone into the abandonment of godly principles. Scripture speaks of both sexual and spiritual seduction.

Sexual seduction

Warnings to avoid temptation

PRO 7:1–7:22; 2TI 2:22 See also PRO 1:10, PRO 2:16–2:19

Examples of enticement

GEN 39:6–39:12; NUM 25:1–25:3 See also NUM 31:15–31:16; JDG 16:1, JDG 16:4–16:5; 2SA 11:1–11:4; 1KI 11:1–11:6; REV 2:14–2:16, REV 2:20–2:22

The law as a deterrent

EXO 22:16–22:17 See also HEB 13:4

Resisting temptation

JOB 31:1 See also MAL 2:14; MAT 5:27–5:30; 1CO 7:2–7:3; PHP 4:8; 1TH 4:3–4:6

Spiritual seduction

Through Satan

GEN 3:1 See also JHN 8:44; 2CO 2:11, 2CO 11:3, 2CO 11:14; EPH 6:11

Through lying spirits and false prophets

1JN 4:1 See also 1KI 22:19–22:23 parallel 2CH 18:18–18:22; 1TI 4:1; MAT 24:24–24:25 parallel MRK 13:22–13:23

Through false teachers

2PE 2:1, 2PE 2:14–2:15 See also 2TI 3:6–3:7, 2TI 3:13; 1JN 2:18–2:19; 2JN 1:7–1:8; JUD 1:10–1:12

The need for vigilance

1TH 5:21–5:22 See also ACT 20:28–20:31

The process of seduction

A thought planted

GEN 3:2–3:3 See also MAT 4:3; JAS 1:14; 1JN 2:15

An advantage promised

GEN 3:4–3:5 See also MAT 4:6

Attraction

GEN 3:6 See also 1JN 2:16

Persistence on the part of the seducer

MAT 4:8–4:9 See also GEN 19:9; JDG 16:15–16:16

Yielding

GEN 3:6 See also JAS 1:15

6242: adultery

Sexual relations involving at least one partner who is married to someone else. Such relations break the marriage covenant and are condemned in Scripture.

Jesus Christ extended the understanding of adultery to include inner lust.

Adultery is condemned by God

God's law forbids it

EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18 See also LEV 18:20; MAT 19:18 parallels MRK 10:19, LUK 18:20; JAS 2:11

It is listed with other evil practices

PSA 50:18; ; JER 7:9–7:10; ; HOS 4:1–4:2; ; LUK 18:11; ; 1TI 1:9–1:10

The lure of adultery

It begins with lust

PRO 6:25; MAT 5:27–5:28 See also 2SA 11:2–11:3; JOB 31:1, JOB 31:9; JER 5:8; MAT 15:19

It is seductive

PRO 7:14–7:21 See also PRO 5:3, PRO 5:20

It is secretive

JOB 24:15; ; PRO 7:8–7:10, PRO 30:20

It is a snare to the unwary

PRO 7:7, PRO 22:14; ; ECC 7:26

It is resisted by the wise

PRO 2:16 See also GEN 39:7–39:12; PRO 7:4–7:5

Adultery breaks the marriage covenant

PRO 2:17 See also HOS 2:2; MAL 2:14

The consequences of adultery

It destroys individuals and society

PRO 6:32–6:34 See also PRO 5:4–5:5, PRO 5:9–5:11, PRO 6:26–6:29, PRO 7:22–7:27; JOB 31:11–31:12

It was punishable by death under OT law

LEV 20:10 See also DEU 22:22, DEU 22:23–22:24; JHN 8:4–8:5

Adulterers face God's judgment

HEB 13:4 See also 2SA 12:11–12:12; MAL 3:5; 1CO 6:9; REV 2:22

Remarriage after divorce may be adultery

MAT 19:9 parallel MRK 10:11 See also MAT 5:32; LUK 16:18; ROM 7:3

Hypocrisy in relation to adultery

ROM 2:22 See also 2SA 12:5–12:6; HOS 4:14; JHN 8:7–8:9

Examples of adultery

2SA 11:1–11:4 See also JER 5:7 the people of Jerusalem; JER 29:23 the exiles in Babylon; HOS 3:1–3:3 Hosea's wife, Gomer; JHN 8:3 the woman caught in adultery; 2PE 2:14 false teachers in the church

Children born of adultery

ISA 57:3 “offspring of adulterers” was a term of abuse. See also 2SA 12:15–12:18 David and Bathsheba’s child died when he was seven days old; HOS 2:4–2:5, HOS 5:7

6243: adultery, spiritual

In Scripture there is a close link between sexual sin and spiritual corruption and immorality as promoted by false teachers. Scripture frequently uses the language of sexual sin to expose the infidelity of God’s people.

The link between sexual sin and spiritual adultery

In practice

NUM 25:1–25:3 See also EXO 34:15; HOS 4:14

In false teaching

REV 2:20–2:25 See also NUM 31:15–31:16; 2TI 3:6; 2PE 2:13–2:15; JUD 1:4, JUD 1:8; REV 2:14–2:16

Spiritual adultery and God’s covenant relationship with his people

God as a husband to his people

EZK 16:8 The spiritual relationship between God and his people is defined in terms of the intimate and exclusive bond of marriage. See also ISA 54:5; JER 3:14, JER 31:32; EPH 5:31–5:32

God is jealous for his people’s affections

EXO 34:14 Just as husband and wife are jealous for their relationship in love, so God is jealous for the affections of his people. See also EXO 20:4–20:5; DEU 4:23–4:24, DEU 6:13–6:15

The history of spiritual adultery among God’s people

Before Israel’s kings

DEU 31:16 See also LEV 17:7–17:9, LEV 20:4–20:6; JDG 2:16–2:17, JDG 8:27, JDG 8:33–8:34

In the northern kingdom of Israel

HOS 1:2 See also 1CH 5:25; EZK 23:1–23:8; HOS 2:2–2:3, HOS 4:10–4:12, HOS 5:3–5:4

In the southern kingdom of Judah

JER 3:1–3:3 See also 2CH 21:10–21:11; ISA 57:3–57:8; JER 2:20, JER 5:7–5:8, JER 23:13–23:14; EZK 16:15–16:22, EZK 23:11–23:21

In Jesus Christ’s generation

MAT 12:38–12:39 See also MAT 16:4

God’s judgment on spiritual adultery

JER 19:3–19:5 See also JER 3:6–3:10, JER 16:10–16:13; EZK 23:36–23:49

Believers are not to be drawn into spiritual adultery

1JN 2:15–2:17 See also 1CO 10:6–10:11; COL 3:5; HEB 3:12–3:14, HEB 10:26–10:31; JAS 4:4–4:5; 1JN 5:21

6245: stubbornness

Proud and disobedient resistance to God’s will and rejection of his commands.

Stubbornness is an attitude of heart

JER 7:24 See also DEU 9:27; JDG 2:19; PSA 78:8; ISA 48:4; JER 3:17, JER 5:3, JER 9:14, JER 16:12, JER 18:12; HOS 4:16; ZEC 7:11

The practical consequences of stubbornness

EPH 4:18 See also EXO 13:15, EXO 33:3; LEV 26:19; 2CH 26:16; NEH 9:16–9:17; JOB 20:6–20:7; PSA 10:4; PRO 1:24–1:31, PRO 28:14, PRO 29:1 sudden destruction for the unrepentant; ISA 2:11 a humbling on judgment day; JER 5:3, JER 11:8, JER 13:10; DAN 5:20 King Nebuchadnezzar deposed; HOS 13:6 The people of Israel forget their God; ZEP 3:11; MRK 6:51–6:52 Jesus Christ’s disciples amazed; MAT 18:15–18:17; ROM 2:5 The self-righteous store up wrath for the day of judgment.

Commands not to be stubborn

NEH 9:29 See also EXO 33:5; 2CH 30:8; PSA 95:8; MRK 16:14

Stubbornness can be God’s judgment on sin

ISA 63:17 When people persistently refuse to obey God, he brings about a condition where they cannot obey him, and consequently cannot receive his blessing. See also EXO 4:21, EXO 14:17; DEU 2:30; JOS 11:20; PSA 81:11–81:12; ROM 9:18, ROM 11:7–11:8

God’s appeal to stubborn people

ISA 65:2 See also ROM 10:21; 2CH 32:24–32:25; JOB 33:16–33:18; ISA 46:12; JER 7:22–7:24; EZK 2:4–2:5; ZEC 7:11–7:12; ACT 19:8–19:9

6248: temptation

Pressure to yield to influences that can lead people away from God and into sin.

6249: temptation, universality of

Scripture makes clear that all human beings are subject to temptation. It provides examples of individuals who have faced and yielded to such influences.

The inevitability of temptation to do wrong

1CO 10:13 See also PRO 7:21–7:23; MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13; LUK 17:1; ROM 7:15; 1CO 10:12; 2CO 11:3; 1PE 1:6

Examples of those who were tempted

Adam and Eve tempted

GEN 3:6–3:7 Sin enters the world through temptation, which leads to the fall of humanity.

Esau tempted

See also GEN 25:29–25:34

Achan tempted

JOS 7:21

Samson tempted

JDG 14:16–14:17

David tempted

2SA 11:2–11:4

Solomon tempted

1KI 11:1, 1KI 11:4

Gehazi tempted

2KI 5:20–5:23

Peter tempted

MAT 26:69–26:75 parallels LUK 22:55–22:62, JHN 18:16–18:18, JHN 18:25–18:27

Help for those facing temptation

ROM 8:31 See also JOS 1:5; ROM 8:37–8:39; HEB 4:15–4:16, HEB 13:5; 1JN 2:1, 1JN 4:4; REV 3:10

6250: temptation, sources of

Temptation comes from a number of sources but not from God.

Temptation arising from sinful human nature

EPH 2:1–2:3; JAS 1:14 See also MAT 5:29–5:30 parallel MRK 9:43–9:47; MAT 6:23; ROM 7:18–7:23

Temptation from other people

2PE 2:18 See also GEN 3:6; PRO 5:3–5:6

Temptation from Satan

GEN 3:1 See also 1CH 21:1; MAT 4:1 parallels MRK 1:13, LUK 4:2; MRK 4:15 parallel LUK 8:12; 1CO 7:5; 1TH 3:5

Temptation from the world

1JN 2:16 See also MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14

Attractions which lead to temptation

Money

1TI 6:9–6:10

Power

See also DEU 8:17–8:18; 2CH 26:16

Lust

PRO 6:25, PRO 7:21

Pride

PRO 11:2

Temptation does not come from God

JAS 1:13 See also MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4

6251: temptation, resisting

Being tempted is not in itself a sin. Sin arises when believers give in to temptation. Scripture urges believers to resist temptation, and gives them encouragement to face it.

Encouragement to those facing temptation

JAS 1:12 See also ROM 8:37; HEB 2:18, HEB 4:15–4:16; JAS 1:2–1:3; 1JN 4:4

Finding in God and his word resources to overcome temptation

DAN 11:32 See also PRO 2:1–2:2, PRO 2:12–2:15; MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4; 1TI 6:11–6:12; JAS 4:7

Practical suggestions for overcoming temptation

Overcoming temptation through prayer

MAT 26:41 parallels MRK 14:38, LUK 22:40 See also MAT 18:8–18:9; 1CO 7:5

Overcoming temptation through personal discipline

HEB 12:4, HEB 12:7; ; 2PE 3:17

Encouragements to resist temptation

GAL 6:1; 1TH 5:22 See also PRO 1:10–1:15; ROM 6:12–6:14

Examples of those who did not give in to temptation

JOB 1:22 See also GEN 39:7–39:10; JOB 2:10; JER 35:5–35:6; DAN 1:8

Jesus Christ resisted temptation

MAT 4:4 parallel LUK 4:4 See also MAT 4:7 parallel LUK 4:12; MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8

6252: temptation, and Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ, like every other human being, knew temptation. However, he never yielded to it. The sinlessness of Christ refers to his obedient refusal to give

in to temptation. It does not mean that he did not experience temptation himself.

The temptation of Jesus Christ

MRK 1:13 parallels MAT 4:1–4:10, LUK 4:1–4:13

The temptation to avoid the cross

MAT 16:21–16:23 parallel MRK 8:31–8:33 See also MAT 26:36–26:44 parallels MRK 14:32–14:42, LUK 22:40–22:46; MAT 27:39–27:44 parallels MRK 15:31–15:32, LUK 23:36–23:37, LUK 23:39

The temptation to please the crowd

LUK 11:16 See also MAT 12:38–12:39 parallel LUK 11:29; JHN 2:18, JHN 6:30

The significance of the temptation of Jesus Christ

Believers can identify with Jesus Christ in his temptation

HEB 2:18

Believers can have confidence in the face of temptation

HEB 4:15–4:16

6253: temptation, avoiding causing

Any behaviour which might cause others to do wrong is to be avoided.

Warnings not to cause temptation

LUK 17:1

Special care is needed to avoid tempting those whose faith is young

MAT 18:6 See also MRK 9:42; LUK 17:2

Temptation is linked to passing judgment on others

ROM 14:13

Allowance must be made to avoid causing temptation to those whose faith is weak

ROM 14:15, ROM 14:21

Avoiding causing temptation by exercising Christian freedom responsibly

1CO 8:9–8:13

Examples of causing temptation

NUM 25:1–25:2; PRO 16:29 See also HAB 2:15; MAT 18:6

Examples of restraining sin or temptation

GEN 37:21–37:22; ; ACT 20:28–20:31; ; EPH 6:10–6:13; ; HEB 12:1–12:3; ; 1PE 5:8–5:9; ; 1JN 3:7

6257: unbelievers

Those who are unwilling to believe and trust in God, especially as he has made himself known in and through Jesus Christ.

Characteristics of unbelievers

A refusal to believe in God

NUM 14:11; ; PSA 78:32; ; JHN 5:38; ; ACT 14:2

A refusal to trust in God

PSA 78:22; ; HEB 4:2

A persistence in sin

PSA 78:32

Descriptions of unbelievers

They are blind

2CO 4:4 See also JHN 9:39–9:41

They are disobedient

HEB 3:12, HEB 3:18–3:19

Unbelievers can become believers

1TI 1:13 See also MRK 9:24

The effect of tongues and prophecy on unbelievers

1CO 14:22–14:25

Relationships between believers and unbelievers

Believers should not marry unbelievers

2CO 6:14–6:15

An unbelieving husband or wife

1CO 7:12–7:16 See also 1PE 3:1

Eating with unbelievers

1CO 10:27–10:29

The consequence of remaining an unbeliever

JHN 3:18 See also LUK 12:46; JHN 8:24, JHN 12:48; REV 21:8

Examples of unbelievers

Some Israelites: NUM 14:13–14:39; ; DEU 1:34–1:35; ; 1CO 10:10; MAT 17:20 the disciples; ; MRK 8:11–8:12 some Pharisees; ACT 14:2, ACT 17:5

6260: uncircumcised

Those who are outside the covenant of God.

Circumcision marked the covenant people of God

God's covenant with Abraham

GEN 17:10–17:12, GEN 17:14 See also JOS 5:6–5:7

Uncircumcised aliens participating in Jewish religious practices had first to be circumcised
EXO 12:48; ; EZK 44:6-44:7, EZK 44:9; ; ACT 11:3, ACT 21:21

The term “uncircumcised”

Used to describe Gentiles

JDG 14:3, JDG 15:18; ; 2SA 1:20; ; EZK 28:10, EZK 31:18, EZK 32:19, EZK 32:21, EZK 32:24-32:32

As a term of derision

ISA 52:1 See also GEN 34:14; 1SA 14:6, 1SA 17:26, 1SA 17:36, 1SA 31:4 parallel 1CH 10:4

Uncircumcision represents a wrong inner spiritual attitude

JER 9:25-9:26 The tribes mentioned also practised male circumcision. See also ACT 7:51; ROM 2:25-2:27, ROM 3:29-3:30; 1CO 7:18-7:19; GAL 5:6, GAL 6:15; COL 2:13

In Christ the barrier between the circumcised and uncircumcised is overcome

EPH 2:11-2:13 See also ROM 4:9-4:12; 1CO 12:13; COL 3:11

6500: Salvation

- 6510: salvation

6510: salvation

The transformation of a person's individual nature and relationship with God as a result of repentance and faith in the atoning death of Jesus Christ on the cross. All humanity stands in need of salvation, which is only possible through faith in Jesus Christ.

6511: salvation, nature of

Salvation involves a change in the relationship between God and a person. Salvation includes God's adoption of believers into his family, his acceptance of them as righteous and his forgiveness of their sins. It also includes personal renewal and transformation through the work of the Holy Spirit.

Salvation as a change in status before God

Access to God

ROM 5:1-5:2 See also EPH 2:13; HEB 4:16

Adoption into the family of God

JHN 1:12; ; ROM 8:22-8:24; ; GAL 4:4-4:7

Forgiveness of sin

ACT 5:30-5:31 See also PSA 32:1-32:2; MAT 26:28; ACT 10:43, ACT 13:38; EPH 1:7; COL 2:13

Heavenly citizenship

PHP 3:20-3:21 See also EPH 2:19; COL 3:1-3:2; HEB 12:22-12:24

Inheritance from God

ROM 8:17 See also COL 1:12; REV 21:7

Peace with God

EPH 2:13-2:17 See also ISA 53:5; JHN 16:33; ROM 5:1-5:2; COL 3:15

Righteousness in the sight of God

ROM 1:17 See also ISA 61:10; ROM 3:22, ROM 4:3-4:13, ROM 4:25-5:1 The idea of being righteous in the sight of God lies at the heart of Paul's doctrine of justification by faith; 1CO 1:30; 2CO 5:21; PHP 3:8-3:9; 2TI 4:8; HEB 11:7

Salvation as a change in a person's nature

Becoming a new creation

2CO 5:17 See also ROM 6:4; GAL 6:14-6:15; EPH 2:15

Deliverance from God's righteous condemnation

ROM 8:1-8:2 See also ISA 50:8; ROM 5:15-5:17, ROM 8:33-8:39; COL 1:22

Deliverance from the power of sin and evil

GAL 1:3-1:4 See also ROM 6:14, ROM 7:21-7:25, ROM 8:2-8:4; 1PE 2:24; REV 1:5

Inner personal renewal

1JN 1:7 See also PSA 51:1-51:2, PSA 51:7; HEB 1:3, HEB 10:19-10:22

New birth

JHN 3:3-3:7 See also JAS 1:18; 1PE 1:23; 1JN 3:9

The presence of the Holy Spirit

ROM 8:10-8:11 See also GAL 5:2-5:25

6512: salvation, necessity and basis of

Scripture stresses that fallen human beings are cut off from God on account of their sin. All need to be saved, if they are to enter into a new relationship with God as their Creator and Redeemer. Salvation is not the result of human achievement, privilege or wisdom, but depends totally upon the graciousness of a loving God, supremely expressed in the cross of Jesus Christ. People must respond in repentance and faith if they are to benefit from God's offer of salvation in Christ.

The necessity of salvation

The universal rule of sin in human nature

ISA 64:6; ; ROM 3:19-3:23, ROM 5:12-5:18, ROM 7:24; ; EPH 2:3

Sin cuts humanity off from God

ISA 59:1–59:2 See also GEN 3:22–3:24; EPH 2:1–2:5, EPH 4:18

Sin enslaves humanity to evil

JER 13:23; ; HOS 5:4; ; ZEC 7:11–7:12; ; ROM 7:14–7:20; ; 2PE 2:13–2:19

Salvation is grounded in the love of God**Salvation is not based on human achievement**

ROM 3:28; EPH 2:8–2:9 See also ACT 15:7–15:11; ROM 4:1–4:3, ROM 5:1–5:2; GAL 2:16, GAL 2:21; 2TI 1:9

Salvation is grounded in God's love for his people

EPH 2:4–2:5 See also DEU 7:1–7:8; JHN 3:16–3:17; ROM 5:8; 2TH 2:16; 1JN 4:9–4:19

Salvation is grounded in God's grace

ROM 3:22–3:24 See also JHN 1:16; ACT 15:11; ROM 5:15–5:17; 2CO 6:1–6:2; EPH 1:5–1:8, EPH 2:4–2:10; 1TI 1:14–1:15; TIT 2:11, TIT 3:4–3:7; HEB 2:9

Salvation and the work of Jesus Christ**Salvation is grounded in the work of Jesus Christ**

ACT 5:30–5:31; 1TI 1:15 See also JHN 4:42; ACT 4:10–4:12; ROM 5:9–5:10; PHP 3:20–3:21; 2TI 1:9–1:10; TIT 3:5–3:7; HEB 7:24–7:25; 1JN 4:14

Jesus Christ's death was totally sufficient for salvation

1PE 3:18 See also JHN 17:1–17:4; ACT 4:10–4:12; GAL 1:3–1:4; EPH 1:5–1:10; 1TI 2:5–2:6; 2TI 1:9–1:10; HEB 10:10; 1JN 4:9–4:10; REV 7:9–7:10

Salvation demands a human decision

JHN 3:36; ACT 3:19 See also MRK 1:15; LUK 8:50; JHN 3:17–3:18; ACT 2:37–2:39; HEB 12:25; 1PE 2:4–2:8; 1JN 5:10

6513: Saviour, God as

See [1320: God, as Saviour](#)

6514: Saviour, Jesus Christ as

See [2324: Jesus Christ, as Saviour](#)

6600: Aspects of salvation

- 6602: acceptance
- 6606: access to God
- 6608: adoption
- 6614: atonement
- 6620: calling
- 6622: choice
- 6624: confession, of sin
- 6626: conversion
- 6632: conviction
- 6634: deliverance

- 6636: drawing near to God
- 6638: election
- 6644: eternal life
- 6648: expiation
- 6650: finding
- 6652: forgiveness
- 6658: freedom
- 6666: grace
- 6674: imputation
- 6676: justification
- 6682: mediation
- 6684: mediator
- 6686: mercy
- 6694: mystery
- 6696: necessity
- 6698: newness
- 6700: peace
- 6708: predestination
- 6710: privileges
- 6712: propitiation
- 6714: ransom
- 6716: reconciliation
- 6720: redemption
- 6728: regeneration
- 6730: reinstatement
- 6732: repentance
- 6738: rescue
- 6740: returning to God
- 6742: sackcloth and ashes
- 6744: sanctification
- 6750: sin-bearer
- 6752: substitution
- 6754: union with Christ

6602: acceptance

The favourable reception of someone or something. God in his grace accepts human beings, their worship and their offerings. People are called to accept Jesus Christ and the message of the gospel and to respond to being accepted by accepting one another.

6603: acceptance, divine

God's gracious favour shown both to Israel and to the Gentiles. God accepts people who respond to him, and worship that is offered sincerely and is accompanied by wholehearted commitment.

God's acceptance of human beings**God's gracious acceptance of Israel**

2KI 13:23 See also EZK 20:40–20:41; ROM 11:1

God's acceptance of those who respond to him

GEN 4:7; EZK 43:27; JHN 6:37 See also EXO 28:38; ROM 14:3; HEB 12:6; 2PE 1:10-1:11

God's acceptance of the Gentiles

ROM 15:16 See also ISA 56:6-56:7; ACT 10:34-10:35, ACT 15:7-15:8

Prayers for acceptance by God

DEU 21:8; ; 2SA 24:23

God's acceptance of human worship**Acceptable sacrifices**

LEV 22:19-22:21; 1PE 2:5 See also LEV 1:3-1:4, LEV 19:5-19:7, LEV 22:27-22:29; MAL 3:3-3:4; JHN 4:23; ROM 12:1; PHP 4:18; HEB 12:28, HEB 13:16

Acceptance of gifts offered for the tabernacle

NUM 7:5 See also NUM 31:51-31:54

Unacceptable offerings

JER 14:10-14:12 See also LEV 7:18, LEV 22:25; MAL 1:8-1:10, MAL 2:13

Acceptable service

PRO 21:3; JAS 1:27 See also 1SA 15:22; PSA 51:6-51:7; JER 6:19-6:20; AMO 5:21-5:24; 2CO 6:17-6:18; ISA 52:11

God accepts prayer and praise

PSA 6:9; HEB 13:15 See also JOB 33:26, JOB 42:8-42:9; PSA 119:108; LUK 18:13-18:14

6604: acceptance, human

The response of human beings to the revelation and grace of God. It is seen in receiving Jesus Christ, his words and the message of the gospel, and in the acceptance of one another for his sake. Believers are called, too, to accept instruction and discipline and to submit to God's will for their lives.

Human beings are to accept Jesus Christ**Receiving Jesus Christ**

JHN 1:12 See also COL 2:6

Accepting Jesus Christ by accepting others

JHN 13:20 See also MAT 10:40, MAT 18:5 parallels MRK 9:37, LUK 9:48; LUK 10:16; JHN 12:44

Accepting Jesus Christ's words

JHN 17:8 See also MAT 11:14, MAT 19:11-19:12; JHN 3:33-3:34

Refusing to accept Jesus Christ and his words

JHN 1:11, JHN 3:11, JHN 3:32, JHN 5:43-5:44, JHN 6:60

Acceptance of the gospel**The gospel is worthy of acceptance**

1TI 1:15; JAS 1:21 See also MAT 13:23 parallels MRK 4:20, LUK 8:15; 1CO 15:3; 1TI 4:9-4:10

Examples of those accepting the gospel

ACT 2:41 3,000 on the day of Pentecost; ; ACT 8:14 the Samaritans; ; ACT 11:1 the Gentiles; 1CO 15:1; ; 2CO 11:4; GAL 1:9 believers in Galatia; 1TH 1:6; ; 2TH 2:13

Rejection of the gospel

ACT 22:18; ; ROM 11:15; ; 1CO 2:14

Acceptance of one another**A right self-acceptance**

1CO 15:10 Paul accepts himself as a sinner saved by God's grace and entrusted with an important ministry; **GAL 5:14** Loving others requires a proper self-love: the recognition that people are made in God's image and are the objects of his love. See also LEV 19:18; MAT 22:39 parallel MRK 12:31; MRK 12:33; ROM 13:9; 1TI 1:12-1:14; JAS 2:8

Acceptance of one another because of God's example

ROM 15:7 See also JHN 13:34, JHN 15:12

Acceptance of those whom God has accepted

ROM 14:1 See also DEU 10:18-10:19 God's people should reflect his concern for the weak and defenceless; MAT 19:13-19:14 parallels MRK 10:13-10:14, LUK 18:15-18:16 Jesus Christ rebukes his disciples for turning away children. ACT 9:11-9:17, ACT 22:12-22:13 ACT 9:27 Barnabas' acceptance of Saul ACT 10:15, ACT 10:28, ACT 10:47

Acceptance of outsiders who join God's people

LEV 19:33-19:34 See also EZK 47:22-47:23

Acceptance of itinerant ministers

GAL 4:14 See also 1CO 16:10-16:11; PHP 2:29-2:30

Acceptance of things given**Acceptance of gifts**

1SA 25:35 See also GEN 33:10-33:11; 1SA 10:4; 1TI 4:3-4:4

Refusal to accept gifts

GEN 14:23-14:24 Abraham refuses gifts offered by the king of Sodom; ; 2KI 5:15-5:16 Elisha refuses a gift offered by Naaman; ; EST 4:4 Mordecai refuses fine clothes from Esther.

Acceptance of instruction

JOB 22:22; ; PRO 4:10, PRO 10:8, PRO 19:20; ; ISA 29:24

Acceptance of discipline

JOB 5:17 See also DEU 21:18; PSA 94:12; PRO 3:11–3:12, PRO 10:17; HEB 12:5–12:7; REV 3:19

Acceptance of God's will

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42 See also JOB 2:10; PSA 40:8; ISA 50:5; ROM 8:28

Acceptance of bribes forbidden

EXO 23:8; DEU 10:17; ; 2CH 19:7; PSA 15:5; ; PRO 17:23; ; ISA 33:15

6606: access to God

The privilege of entering into the presence of God through the work of Jesus Christ.

Only the pure have access to God

PSA 24:3–24:4; 1JN 3:21–3:22 See also PSA 41:12, PSA 66:18–66:19, PSA 73:28; MAT 5:8; 1PE 3:12; PSA 34:15–34:16

The wicked do not have access to God

PSA 101:7; ISA 59:2 See also GEN 4:14, GEN 4:16; LEV 22:3; DEU 31:18; PSA 5:5; ISA 1:15, ISA 64:7; JER 7:15, JER 15:1, JER 23:39, JER 52:3; EZK 39:23; HOS 5:6; MIC 3:4

Access to God through the priests and sacrificial system**Access to God by this means in the OT**

EXO 29:44–29:45 See also EXO 29:29–29:30, EXO 29:36, EXO 29:38–29:39

This OT access to God fulfilled in Jesus Christ

HEB 4:14–4:16, HEB 7:23–7:25 See also HEB 2:17, HEB 7:18–7:19, HEB 10:10–10:12, HEB 12:18–12:24

Access to God by the priesthood of all believers

1PE 2:5 See also 1PE 2:9; REV 1:6

Access to God through the Tent of Meeting and the tabernacle**Access to God by this means in the OT**

EXO 33:7–33:11 See also EXO 40:1–40:2, EXO 40:34–40:35; NUM 1:51, NUM 3:10, NUM 3:38, NUM 18:7, NUM 18:22; 2CH 1:3

This OT access to God fulfilled in Jesus Christ

HEB 9:23–9:24 See also ACT 7:44; HEB 8:1–8:2, HEB 8:5–8:6, HEB 9:11

Access to God through the Most Holy Place**Access to God by this means in the OT**

HEB 9:7–9:8 See also LEV 16:2, LEV 16:12–16:17, LEV 16:32–16:33; 1KI 6:16, 1KI 8:6 parallel 2CH 5:7; 1KI 8:10–8:11 parallel 2CH 5:13–5:14; 2CH 3:8

Access to God by this means fulfilled in Jesus Christ

HEB 9:3–9:5 **HEB 9:12, HEB 10:19–10:22** See also MAT 27:51 parallel MRK 15:38; HEB 6:19–6:20

Believers have access to God by grace

PSA 21:6 See also PSA 51:10–51:11, PSA 145:18; HOS 6:1–6:2; ACT 17:27; 2CO 4:14; JAS 4:8; JUD 1:24

Believers have access to God through Jesus Christ

ROM 5:1–5:2; EPH 2:18, EPH 3:12 See also JHN 10:9, JHN 14:6

6608: adoption

The deliberate action by which a family gives to a person all the privileges of being a member of that family.

6609: adoption, nature of

The giving by God of the status and privileges of being his children. God adopts those who believe in him and grants them the benefits of his salvation.

A family adopts a child

GEN 15:3 See also GEN 48:5; EXO 2:10; EST 2:7

God adopts the nation of Israel

DEU 14:2 See also DEU 7:7; ISA 63:16; AMO 3:1–3:2; ROM 9:4

God is Israel's father

JER 31:9 See also MAL 1:6

Israel is God's son

HOS 11:1 See also DEU 14:1

God adopts believers as his children

JHN 1:12–1:13

God is the Father of believers

2CO 6:18 See also MAT 6:9 parallel LUK 11:2

Believers are adopted as an outcome of predestination

EPH 1:5

Believers are adopted as an outcome of redemption

GAL 4:5

Believers are adopted as an outcome of justification

GAL 3:24–3:26 See also JHN 1:12–1:13

Believers are adopted by grace

EPH 1:3–1:6 See also EZK 16:3–16:6; ROM 4:16; EPH 1:11

The final adoption of believers will occur at the resurrection

ROM 8:23 See also EPH 1:13–1:14; 1JN 3:2

6610: adoption, descriptions of

The words used by the NT to describe believers point to their status and privileges as the adopted children of God.

Believers are no longer slaves but sons

GAL 4:7–4:9 See also JHN 8:34–8:36; ROM 8:15; PHM 1:16

Believers are children of God

1JN 3:1–3:2 The title “child of God” is thought by some to be distinct from that of “son of God” (see below). “child” is thought to emphasise God’s fatherhood, whilst “son” is thought to emphasise the Christian’s privileges. These terms are however, sometimes used interchangeably. See also LUK 20:36; ROM 8:21; PHP 2:15; 1JN 3:2, 1JN 5:2

Believers are sons of God

ROM 8:14 See also ROM 9:26; GAL 3:26

Believers are children of the resurrection

LUK 20:36

Believers are children of light, sons of light

JHN 12:36; ; EPH 5:8; ; 1TH 5:5

Believers are heirs of God

ROM 8:17 See also GAL 3:29, GAL 4:7; TIT 3:7; HEB 6:17

Believers are brothers of Jesus Christ

HEB 2:11–2:12 See also MAT 12:48–12:50; ROM 8:29; HEB 2:17

Believers are brothers of other believers

1JN 3:14 See also 1JN 4:19–4:20; REV 12:10, REV 19:10

Believers are members of God’s household, his family

EPH 2:19 See also GAL 6:10; HEB 3:2–3:6

6611: adoption, privileges and duties of

As adopted members of the family of God, believers receive both the privileges and responsibilities of being children of God.

The privileges received by believers through adoption**Believers are given the Spirit of adoption**

GAL 4:6 See also ROM 8:15

Believers have access to their heavenly Father

EPH 2:18 See also EPH 3:12; HEB 4:16

Believers become heirs with Christ of heaven

ROM 8:17 See also GAL 3:29, GAL 4:7; COL 1:12; 1PE 1:4

The benefits God gives to those he adopts**Believers are pitied by him**

PSA 103:13

Believers are protected

PRO 14:26

Believers are provided for

MAT 6:31–6:33

Believers receive loving discipline

HEB 12:6

Believers are never forsaken

PSA 94:14

Believers are assured by the Spirit

ROM 8:16

The responsibilities of God’s adopted children**Believers are to walk in the light**

See also JHN 12:35–12:36; EPH 5:8; 1TH 5:4–5:5

Believers are to shun evil

2CO 6:17–6:18; ; PHP 2:15

Believers are to purify themselves

2CO 7:1; ; 1JN 3:2–3:3

Believers are to live obediently

MAT 12:50; ; 1PE 1:14; ; 1JN 5:2–5:3

Believers are to live in peace

MAT 5:9; ; ROM 14:19

Believers are to live in love

GAL 5:13; ; 1PE 4:8; ; 1JN 3:18

Believers are to be watchful

1TH 5:5–5:6

6614: atonement

Reconciliation; sin has alienated humanity from God and provoked God’s anger. God has responded by providing the means of restoring this broken relationship, bringing both sides to a place where they are at one again (“at-one-ment”).

6615: atonement, necessity and nature of

Scripture stresses the seriousness and reality of human sin, and that human beings are unable to atone for their own sins. In his grace, God provides a means by which the situation can be remedied.

Atonement is necessary because of human sinfulness

Atonement is necessary because sin cuts people off from God

ISA 59:2 See also ISA 64:7; EZK 39:23; HAB 1:13; JHN 9:31

Atonement is necessary because sin provokes God's wrath

EPH 2:1–2:3 See also GEN 6:5–6:7; EXO 32:30–32:35; ROM 1:18–1:20, ROM 2:8

God's gracious nature is the basis for atonement

Atonement is grounded in God's reluctance to punish sinners

EZK 18:32 See also EZK 33:11; 1TI 2:1–2:4; 2PE 3:9

Atonement is grounded in God's readiness to forgive sin

EXO 34:6–34:7 The punishment of subsequent generations makes God's abhorrence of sin quite clear, but the extension of his love and forgiveness "to thousands" puts the emphasis in these verses on God's grace and compassion. See also PSA 145:8; DAN 9:9; JON 4:2

Atonement is grounded in God's covenant love

NUM 14:19 The Hebrew word for "great love" means God's loving faithfulness to those within the covenant. See also PSA 25:6–25:7, PSA 103:8–103:12; JOL 2:13

God's provision of atonement is a means of dealing with sin

Atonement through sacrifice

LEV 9:7 See also EXO 30:10; NUM 15:22–15:26

God's promised new covenant of forgiveness was fulfilled in Jesus Christ's atoning death

HEB 10:16–10:17 See also JER 31:33–31:34; MAT 26:28; HEB 9:15, HEB 12:24

Images used to portray the at-one-ment, or restored relationship, between God and humanity

Atonement as forgiveness of sins

EPH 1:7–1:8 See also LEV 19:22; ACT 13:38; COL 2:13–2:14

Atonement as cleansing and purification

LEV 16:30 See also ISA 6:6–6:7; TIT 2:14; 1JN 1:7; REV 7:14

Atonement as reconciliation

2CO 5:19 See also ROM 5:9–5:11; EPH 2:14–2:16

Atonement as healing

1PE 2:24 See also 2CH 7:14; PSA 103:2–103:3; ISA 53:5

Atonement as God buying people back for himself

REV 5:9 See also MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45; ACT 20:28; 1PE 1:18–1:19

Atonement as making holy: creating a relationship of consecrated nearness to God

HEB 10:10 See also COL 1:22; HEB 13:12

6616: atonement, in OT

The OT laid down complex regulations by which the guilt of sin could be removed through the sacrificial system. Particular emphasis was placed upon the role of the high priest, who was required to make annual atonement for the sins of the people.

The covenantal framework of atonement

As God's covenant partners, the Israelites undertook to keep his laws

EXO 24:3 See also DEU 26:17; JOS 24:24

The sin offering made atonement for unintentional sins under the covenant

LEV 9:7 See also LEV 4:13–4:14; NUM 15:22–15:26

The guilt offering atoned for sins where reparation was required

LEV 19:20–19:22 See also LEV 6:1–6:7

Deliberate flouting of God's law could not be atoned for

NUM 15:30–15:31 See also NUM 35:33; 1SA 3:14

The Day of Atonement provided for the removal of the nation's sin

LEV 16:34 See also EXO 30:10; LEV 16:1–16:33 The nation's sin was atoned for by sprinkling the atonement cover in the Most Holy Place with the blood of the sacrificial goat; the removal of the people's sin was symbolised by the driving of the scapegoat into the wilderness; HEB 9:7

The atonement cover

EXO 25:17–25:22 The locating of God's presence above the atonement cover in the tabernacle demonstrated that it was only on the basis of atonement that God could accompany his people. See also EXO 30:6; LEV 16:2; NUM 7:89

Atonement was effected by the blood of the sacrifice

LEV 17:11 The blood signified that the life of the animal had been given in place of that of the worshipper. See also HEB 9:22

The role of priests in making atonement

Priests were dedicated to God in order to make atonement for others

EXO 29:44 See also LEV 8:22–8:30

The priests had to make atonement for their own sins

HEB 5:1–5:3 See also LEV 9:8–9:11

The priests represented the people before God to atone for their sin

HEB 5:1 See also EXO 28:36–28:38; LEV 10:16–10:17

The people had constant reminders of the need for atonement

Rituals of cleansing included an atoning offering
LEV 12:7–12:8, LEV 14:18–14:22, LEV 14:53, LEV 15:15

Atonement was a feature of Israel's festivals
NUM 28:22, NUM 28:30, NUM 29:5, NUM 29:11

Abuses of the system of atonement

The sinful conduct of the priests who made atonement

HOS 4:7–4:8 See also ISA 2:12–2:17; JER 6:13–6:14; EZK 22:26; MAL 1:6–1:8

The sinful conduct of the people who sought atonement without repenting of their sins

HOS 8:11–8:13 See also ISA 1:10–1:17, ISA 66:3; JER 7:21–7:24; AMO 4:4

The need for repentance for a relationship of atonement

PRO 16:6 See also ISA 15:22; PSA 51:16–51:17; MIC 6:6–6:8

The prophets foretold a renewing of God's relationship with Israel, involving atonement for sin

Isaiah's message about the obedient servant
ISA 53:4–53:12

Jeremiah's prophecy of a new covenant
JER 31:31–31:34

Ezekiel's vision of a new temple
EZK 43:18–43:27

6617: atonement, in NT

In dying for the sins of the world, Jesus Christ fulfilled and replaced the OT sacrificial system, so that all who believe in him are restored to fellowship with God. Christ is the true high priest, who finally liberates his people from the guilt of sin, by offering himself as the supreme sacrifice.

The atoning purpose of Jesus Christ's death

Jesus Christ's death on behalf of others

JHN 10:11 See also JHN 10:14–10:18; 2CO 5:15; HEB 2:9; 1JN 3:16

Jesus Christ's atoning death for sin

1CO 15:3 See also ROM 4:25, ROM 8:3; GAL 1:4; 1PE 3:18

The atoning significance of Jesus Christ's death is expressed by references to his blood

ROM 5:9; REV 5:9 See also EPH 2:13; 1PE 1:18–1:19; 1JN 1:7; REV 7:14

Jesus Christ's atoning death is commemorated in the Lord's Supper

1CO 11:23–11:25 See also MAT 26:26–26:28 parallels MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:19–22:20

Explanations of the atonement

Jesus Christ's death as an atoning sacrifice

ROM 3:25 See also 1CO 5:7; EPH 5:2; 1JN 4:10; REV 5:6

Jesus Christ's atoning death as redemption

MRK 10:45 parallel MAT 20:28 See also ACT 20:28; GAL 3:13–3:14; EPH 1:7; COL 1:13–1:14

The atonement is effective because of Jesus Christ's sinlessness

2CO 5:21 See also HEB 4:15; 1PE 2:22–2:24; 1JN 3:5

Jesus Christ's death fulfils and replaces the Day of Atonement

Jesus Christ makes atonement as the new high priest

HEB 7:26–7:28

Jesus Christ is the mediator of the new and better covenant

HEB 8:6–8:7, HEB 9:15

Jesus Christ has made atonement in the true heavenly sanctuary

HEB 8:1–8:2, HEB 9:24

Jesus Christ's atoning blood brings effective cleansing

HEB 9:12–9:14

Jesus Christ's single sacrifice replaces the many required under the old covenant

HEB 10:11–10:14

Access to the heavenly sanctuary is now open

HEB 10:19–10:20

By dying with Christ, believers are released from this age into the life of the age to come

ROM 6:1–6:7 See also ROM 7:4–7:6; GAL 2:19–2:20, GAL 6:14; EPH 2:6–2:7; COL 2:11–2:13

God the Father and the atoning death of his Son

God's sending of his Son to make atonement

1JN 4:14 See also JHN 3:16; ROM 8:32; 2CO 5:18; GAL 4:4–4:5

God's grace displayed in making atonement for the ungodly

EPH 2:4–2:5 See also ROM 5:6–5:8; EPH 2:8–2:9; TIT 3:4–3:5

The worldwide scope of Jesus Christ's atoning death

1JN 2:2 See also JHN 1:29; 2CO 5:19; 1TI 2:5

The appropriate response to the atonement

The response of repentance

ACT 3:19 See also ACT 2:38; ACT 17:30; ACT 20:21

The response of faith

ACT 10:43 See also JHN 3:14–3:15; ACT 16:31; ROM 3:22; GAL 2:16

The response of baptism

ACT 22:16 See also ACT 2:38; 1PE 3:21

6620: calling

God's summoning of individuals and people to himself, so that they will belong to him and serve him in his world. The calling of a believer may involve a specific place, task or vocation in life.

God calls individuals to belong to him and serve him

God calls all people everywhere

ACT 17:30 See also PRO 8:4; ISA 45:22; ISA 55:1; MAT 9:13; MAT 11:28–11:30; MAT 22:9; JHN 7:37; ACT 2:39; ROM 10:18; PSA 19:4

Few respond positively to God's call

MAT 22:14 See also ISA 65:12; ISA 66:4; JER 7:13; JER 35:17; MAT 22:2–22:10 parallel LUK 14:16–14:24

Responding to God's call results in salvation

HEB 9:15; JUD 1:1 See also JHN 5:25; JHN 10:3; ROM 1:6; ROM 8:28–8:30; ROM 11:29; 1CO 1:9; 1CO 1:24–1:29; 1CO 7:18–7:22; GAL 1:6; EPH 4:1; PHP 3:14; 2TH 1:11; 2TH 2:14; 1TI 6:12; HEB 3:1; 1PE 5:10; 2PE 1:3; 2PE 1:10; REV 17:14

God calls Christians to live differently

2TI 1:9; 1PE 2:9 1CO 7:15; ; COL 3:15; GAL 5:13 serving one another; EPH 1:18; EPH 4:4; ; 1PE 2:20–2:21; 1PE 3:9; 1TH 4:7

God called particular individuals to do specific tasks at specific times

Abraham: GEN 12:1–12:3; ; ISA 51:2; ; HEB 11:8; EXO 3:4 Moses; ; 1SA 3:4–3:10 Samuel; ; ISA 6:8 Isaiah; ISA 41:2; ISA 45:4; ISA 42:6; ISA 49:1; JER 1:4–1:5 Jeremiah; ; HOS 1:2 Hosea; ; AMO 7:15 Amos; JON 1:1–1:2; JON 3:1–3:2; MAT 4:18–4:22 parallel MRK 1:16–1:20; ; LUK 5:2–5:11; ; JHN

1:35–1:42; ACT 13:2 Barnabas and Paul; ROM 1:1; ; 1CO 1:1; ; GAL 1:15

God called a people, Israel, to serve him in a special way

ISA 43:1 See also HOS 11:1–11:2

The believer's place in life is understood to be a calling

1CO 7:17 See also 1CO 7:20; 1CO 7:24

6622: choice

A deliberate act of will or decision, in which God chooses individuals or peoples to be his or calls them to perform certain tasks or responsibilities. Human beings are also required to make choices, particularly between good and evil.

God's sovereign choice

MAL 1:2–1:3 See also ROM 9:10–9:15; EXO 33:19; 1CO 1:27–1:28; JAS 2:5

God's chosen people

Israel

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:4–19:6; DEU 14:2; PSA 65:4; ISA 14:1; ISA 41:9; JER 3:14

NT believers

EPH 1:4 See also ROM 8:28–8:33; 1PE 2:9

God chooses people for special tasks

EXO 3:10 See also 1SA 9:17; 1SA 16:1–16:13; HAG 2:20–2:23; MRK 3:13–3:19 parallel LUK 6:13–6:16; ACT 9:10–9:15; GAL 1:15–1:16

God chose where he was to be worshipped

DEU 12:5 See also DEU 12:11; DEU 12:14; DEU 12:18; DEU 12:26; DEU 14:23; DEU 16:2; DEU 16:6–16:7; DEU 16:11; DEU 16:15–16:16; DEU 26:2; DEU 31:11

People must choose between good and evil

JOS 24:15; PRO 16:16 See also EXO 32:26; DEU 30:19; 1KI 18:21; PRO 3:31; PRO 8:10; JHN 7:17

Examples of bad choices

JAS 4:4 See also PRO 1:28–1:33; ISA 65:12; ISA 66:3–66:4; MAT 27:21 parallel MRK 15:9–15:11

Examples of wise choices

HEB 11:24–11:26 See also JOS 24:21–24:24; RUT 1:16; 1KI 3:5–3:14

6624: confession, of sin

An admission of sin on the part of individuals or groups of people. Genuine repentance and confession herald divine forgiveness.

Confession of sin leads to divine forgiveness

Under the old covenant

PRO 28:13 See also LEV 16:21 Part of the ritual of the Day of Atonement involved the high priest confessing the sins of the nation, while laying his hands on the head of a sacrificial goat; LEV 26:40–26:42; 1KI 8:33–8:36 parallel 2CH 6:24–6:27; 1KI 8:46–8:52 parallel 2CH 6:36–6:39; PSA 32:3–32:5

Under the new covenant

1JN 1:8–1:10 See also JAS 5:13–5:16

Confession of sin accompanied by acts appropriate to repentance

NUM 5:5–5:8 See also LEV 5:5–5:6; EZR 10:10–10:11; NEH 9:1–9:3; LUK 19:8; ACT 19:18–19:19

Examples of confession of sin

On behalf of the nation

NEH 1:5–1:7 See also EZR 9:5–9:15; ISA 59:12–59:13, ISA 64:6–64:7; JER 14:7, JER 14:20; DAN 9:4–9:14

By the people as a whole

1SA 7:5–7:6 See also EZR 9:4–9:7, EZR 9:10–9:15; NEH 9:33–9:35; PSA 106:6; JER 3:24–3:25

By individuals

PSA 51:1–51:5 See also 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:10; 2SA 24:17 parallel 1CH 21:17; JOB 7:20, JOB 42:5–42:6; ISA 6:5

Confession of sin to other people

JOS 7:20–7:21 See also LUK 15:17–15:24; JAS 5:16

6626: conversion

Turning or returning to God in repentance, faith and obedience by those who do not know God or who have turned from him. Although conversion can be seen as a human act or decision, Scripture stresses that the work of God lies behind this human decision, guiding and motivating it.

6627: conversion, nature of

True repentance results in a turning from sin and an inner renewal which can only be brought about by God, who draws people to himself and who, through Jesus Christ, gives forgiveness and new life.

Conversion as turning to God

Turning back to God

DEU 4:30–4:31; LUK 1:16–1:17 See also DEU 30:2–30:3, DEU 30:10; LUK 22:32; JAS 5:19–5:20

Turning from idolatry

ACT 14:15 See also 1SA 7:3; JER 3:12–3:13, JER 4:1–4:2; 1TH 1:9–1:10

Turning from sinful ways

2KI 17:13–17:14; ISA 55:6–55:7 See also 2KI 13:11, 2KI 14:24, 2KI 15:9; JER 18:11, JER 25:5; EZK 18:23; DAN 9:13

Conversion as a turning away from unbelief to faith

It is linked to repentance

ACT 3:19 See also EZK 14:6, EZK 18:30; ACT 26:20

It is linked to coming to faith

ACT 11:21

Conversion brings new life

It results in a transformed life

2CO 5:17 See also ROM 12:2; 2CO 3:18; GAL 6:14–6:15

It is symbolised in baptism

ROM 6:3–6:4 See also COL 2:12, COL 3:1–3:3

It demands a new lifestyle

HOS 12:6; MAT 18:3–18:4 See also GAL 5:22–5:24; EPH 4:1, EPH 5:8–5:11; 1PE 2:11–2:12

Conversion brings a new relationship with God

It brings a new status

GAL 4:7 See also GAL 3:26–3:29; 1JN 3:1; 1PE 2:9–2:10

It brings a new understanding

2CO 3:15–3:16 See also JER 31:34; HEB 8:11

Conversion is a work of God

God turns people to himself

JER 24:7; LAM 5:21 See also 1KI 8:58; JER 31:18; EZK 36:26–36:27; JHN 6:44, JHN 15:16; EPH 2:12–2:13

God gives new birth

JAS 1:17–1:18 See also JHN 3:3–3:6; TIT 3:4–3:5; 1PE 1:23

6628: conversion, God's demands for

Through his servants, God calls people to turn to him. He wants to save the world which is alienated from him, and to restore those of his backslidden people who return to him and renew their commitment to the covenant.

The need for conversion

The world is alienated from God

ROM 1:21–1:23 See also ROM 1:28, ROM 3:11–3:12; PSA 14:3

The world does not know God

GAL 4:8 See also 1CO 1:21, 1CO 15:34; 1TH 4:5; 2TH 1:8

God's people have turned away from him

MAL 3:7 See also NUM 14:43; DEU 9:12; ISA 15:11 Saul; 1KI 11:9 Solomon; 2CH 25:27 Amaziah; JER 8:5; EZK 6:9; DAN 9:11; ACT 7:39

God's demands for the conversion of all people

ISA 45:22; ACT 17:30 See also PSA 65:5; JON 4:11; ZEC 9:10

God's demands for the conversion of his own people

God's desire to save his people

EZK 33:11 See also JER 3:22; JOL 2:12–2:13; ZEC 1:3

God's faithfulness to his people

JER 3:14 See also LEV 26:40–26:42; 2CH 30:9; HOS 3:5; HOS 6:1–6:3

God's promise of restoration

2CH 7:13–7:14 See also 1KI 8:48–8:49 parallel 2CH 6:38–6:39; NEH 1:9

The call to conversion through God's servants

The encouragement of his leaders

JOS 24:14–24:15 Joshua; ; 2KI 11:17 Jehoida; 2KI 23:24–23:25; ; 2CH 34:31–34:33; 2CH 15:11–15:15 Asa; ; 2CH 19:4 Jehoshaphat; ; 2CH 29:6–29:10 Hezekiah; ; PSA 51:13 David

The ministry of his prophets

JER 35:15 See also 2CH 24:19; JER 25:4; HOS 14:1–14:2; JON 3:2

The preaching of believers

ACT 26:16–26:18 See also ACT 2:38; ROM 10:14–10:15; ISA 52:7

Rejection of God's call to conversion

ISA 9:13 See also JER 3:10; HOS 5:4; HOS 7:10; AMO 4:6–4:11

6629: conversion, examples of

Scripture gives examples of individuals and peoples who have turned to God in conversion.

Examples of conversion in the OT

Peoples who turned to God

ISA 19:22 Egypt; ; JON 3:5–3:10 Nineveh

Individuals who turned to God

2KI 5:15 Naaman; ; 2CH 33:12–33:13 Manasseh; ; DAN 4:34–4:37 Nebuchadnezzar; ; JON 1:16 sailors on board ship with Jonah

Examples of conversion in the NT

Examples of people in general

JHN 4:42 people of Sychar; ; ACT 2:41 3,000 people on the day of Pentecost; ; ACT 8:12 Samaritans; ; ACT 9:35 people of Lydda and Sharon; ; ACT 15:3 Gentile converts

Examples of individual converts

LUK 15:18 the prodigal son; ; LUK 19:8–19:9 Zacchaeus; ; ACT 8:35–8:38 the Ethiopian eunuch; ACT 9:3–9:18 parallels ACT 22:6–22:11, ACT 26:12–26:18; ACT 10:44–10:48 Cornelius; ; ACT 13:12 the proconsul, Sergius Paulus; ; ACT 16:14–16:15 Lydia; ; ACT 16:29–16:34 the Philippian jailer

The prophetic vision of the future conversion of Israel and the nations

Israel's turning back to God

HOS 3:5 See also JER 50:4–50:5; HOS 11:10–11:11; ROM 11:26

The conversion of the nations

JER 16:19 See also PSA 22:27–22:28; ISA 2:3 parallel MIC 4:2; ZEC 14:16

6632: conviction

The proving of a person guilty of sin or a crime. Scripture stresses that God has declared the guilt, together with its consequences, of sinful humanity. The term can also refer to a state of being convinced; i.e., the holding of a strong belief, especially a conscious awareness of one's guilt and the atoning death of Jesus Christ as the means of remission of that guilt.

Conviction is proving a person guilty of sin or a crime

Proving someone guilty of sin

JHN 8:46 See also JHN 16:8–16:9 NIV footnote at verse 8; 1CO 14:24; JAS 2:9; JUD 1:15

Proving someone guilty of a crime

DEU 19:15 See also EXO 22:9; LEV 17:3–17:4 NUM 35:30; DEU 17:6 2SA 14:13; PSA 5:10, PSA 109:7; PRO 24:25 LUK 23:4, LUK 23:14, LUK 23:22; JHN 18:38 ACT 24:13, ACT 25:7

God's conviction of sinful humanity

He declares them to be guilty

ROM 3:19–3:20 See also PSA 5:9, PSA 10:7, PSA 14:1–14:3 parallel PSA 53:1–53:3; PSA 140:3; ECC 7:20; ISA 59:7–59:8; ROM 3:10–3:18

He also declares the consequences of their guilt

GEN 2:17, GEN 3:17–3:19; ; ROM 1:32, ROM 5:12, ROM 5:16–5:19; ; 1CO 15:22

Conviction as holding a strong belief

ROM 14:5 See also GEN 45:28; MAT 17:20; LUK 20:6 parallels MAT 21:26, MRK 11:32 The people were convinced that John was a prophet; LUK 16:31 ACT 17:4, ACT 19:26, ACT 28:24 ACT 26:9, ACT 26:26; ROM 2:19, ROM 4:21, ROM 8:38–8:39 Paul's conviction that it is impossible to be separated from God's love; ROM 14:14 Paul's personal convictions about food regulations; ROM 15:14; 2CO 5:14; PHP 1:25; 1TH 1:5; 2TI 1:5 Paul is convinced by Timothy's faith; 2TI 1:12, 2TI 3:14

Conviction as the conscious awareness of one's guilt**Examples of conviction not resulting in repentance**

EXO 9:27 See also EXO 10:16; NUM 14:40, NUM 22:34; DEU 1:41; JDG 10:10 1SA 15:24, 1SA 24:17, 1SA 26:21 MAT 27:3–27:4 Judas Iscariot; ACT 24:25 Governor Felix

Examples of conviction leading to repentance

ACT 2:37 2SA 12:13; ; PSA 51:3–51:4; MAT 26:75 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:62 Peter; LUK 15:17–15:18, LUK 15:21; ACT 16:30 the Philippian jailer; ; ROM 7:9

6634: deliverance

God frequently rescues people from danger, suffering and sin, often through human agency.

The source of deliverance**Deliverance comes from God**

PSA 3:8 See also EXO 3:7–3:8; PSA 18:2; DAN 3:16–3:17; JON 2:9

There is no deliverance by other gods

2KI 18:33 parallel ISA 36:18

There is no escape from God

ISA 43:13

Deliverance may be declined

MAT 26:53–26:54; ; JHN 18:36; ; HEB 11:35

Different kinds of deliverance**From danger**

1SA 17:37 See also LUK 8:23–8:24; 2CO 1:9–1:10; 2TI 4:17

From illness

PSA 103:3; ; ISA 38:16

From trouble

PSA 34:17, PSA 34:19, PSA 54:7

From slavery

EXO 20:2

From enemies

JER 38:10–38:13; ; DAN 6:19–6:22; ; LUK 1:74; ; 2TH 3:2

From Satan

LUK 13:16, LUK 22:31–22:32

From the fear of death

HEB 2:14–2:15

From all fears

PSA 34:4; ; REV 1:17

From sin

GAL 1:4 See also PSA 32:7; 2TH 2:13; REV 1:5

From the coming wrath

LUK 3:7; ; 1TH 1:10, 1TH 5:9

Deliverance for God's people**God promises deliverance**

JER 15:11 See also DAN 12:1

God's people are to pray for deliverance

MAT 6:13 See also 2KI 19:19 parallel ISA 37:20; PSA 59:1–59:2

The means of deliverance**Direct intervention by God**

EXO 14:13; ; 2KI 7:6

Deliverance by angels

ACT 12:7

Deliverance by human agency

GEN 37:17–37:22; ; JDG 2:16; ; ACT 23:16–23:24

God's people as deliverers**Abraham**

GEN 14:14–14:16

Moses

ACT 7:35–7:36 See also PSA 77:20

Joshua

EXO 17:8–17:13

The judges

JDG 2:16 See also JDG 3:9, JDG 3:15, JDG 3:31, JDG 4:1–4:10, JDG 4:23, JDG 6:12, JDG 6:16, JDG 10:1, JDG 11:32, JDG 13:2–13:5, JDG 13:24–13:25

Samuel

1SA 7:3–7:13

Saul

1SA 11:9–11:13

Jonathan

1SA 14:45

David

2SA 8:1, 2SA 8:14

Jesus Christ**LUK 4:18–4:19** See also ISA 61:1–61:2; 1TI 2:5; HEB 2:14–2:15**Ministers and others through the gospel**

ACT 26:17–26:18; ; 2TI 2:25–2:26; ; JAS 5:19–5:20

Gifted Christians**MAT 10:1** parallel LUK 9:1 See also MRK 16:17; ACT 3:6, ACT 8:6–8:7, ACT 16:16–16:18; 1CO 12:10**The proper response to deliverance****Praise**

LUK 5:25; ; ACT 3:8

Delight

1SA 2:1

Thanksgiving

PSA 30:11–30:12, PSA 106:47, PSA 107:6–107:8, PSA 107:14–107:15, PSA 107:20–107:21, PSA 107:30–107:31; ; ROM 7:24–7:25

Trust

PSA 40:1–40:3

Obedience

PSA 56:12–56:13; ; LUK 8:38–8:39; ; JHN 5:14, JHN 8:10–8:11

6636: drawing near to God

Under the old covenant, coming near to God was closely linked with the sacrificial system, but under the new covenant Jesus Christ's sacrifice has given believers free access into God's presence.

Drawing near to God under the old covenant**Access to God was restricted****EXO 24:1–24:2** See also EXO 19:20–19:24, EXO 20:18–20:19; LEV 21:21; DEU 5:22–5:27; PSA 65:4**Priests drew near to God in order to minister to him****EZK 44:15** See also LEV 10:1–10:3; EZK 40:46, EZK 42:13, EZK 43:19, EZK 45:4**The people drew near to God to offer worship****LEV 15:13–15:15** See also LEV 9:1–9:5; PSA 96:8, PSA 100:2–100:4; MIC 6:6–6:8**Drawing near to God under the new covenant****HEB 10:19–10:22** See also 1CO 8:8; HEB 7:11–7:19, HEB 10:1–10:10**God prompts his people to draw near to him****ISA 55:1–55:3** See also ISA 55:6–55:7; JER 3:21–4:2**Some refuse to draw near to God****ZEP 3:2** See also JER 2:30–2:31**All people will ultimately draw near to God****Israel****JER 31:6** See also JER 30:21–30:22; HOS 3:4–3:5**All nations****ISA 66:22–66:23****God draws near to those who draw near to him****JAS 4:8** See also PSA 145:18; JER 3:22, JER 30:21–30:22; ZEC 1:3; MAL 3:7; HEB 7:19**6638: election**

Scripture affirms that God chooses a people as his own, not on account of their numerical strength or moral merits, but on account of his love for them. Election is on the basis of divine grace, not human merit.

6639: election, to salvation

God chooses to bring individuals to salvation through faith in Jesus Christ.

Election is part of God's eternal decree**Election is from eternity****EPH 1:4** See also 2TH 2:13; 2TI 1:9**Election is God's sovereign prerogative****ROM 9:15–9:24, ROM 11:1–11:6** See also EXO 33:19; ISA 65:1; JER 18:1–18:12; JHN 15:16, JHN 17:6; ROM 9:10–9:13; EPH 2:10**God's election places individuals within the covenant of grace****NEH 9:7–9:8** See also GEN 15:7–15:8, GEN 15:18–15:21, GEN 18:19; GAL 3:29**Election is not on the basis of merit****1CO 1:26–1:31** See also DEU 7:7–7:8, DEU 9:4–9:6; JAS 2:5**God's election of his people is the foundation of his saving action****Election does not suspend God's use of the means of salvation****2TH 2:13–2:14** See also MAT 1:21; EPH 2:8–2:10; JAS 1:18; 1PE 1:2**Election works in tandem with the call of the gospel****MAT 22:14** See also ROM 8:29–8:30**Election is evidenced through a positive response to the gospel****1TH 1:4–1:5** See also JHN 6:37–6:40

Election is a motive for praise**ROM 11:28–11:36; EPH 1:3–1:14** See also 1TH 1:2–1:4**Election is a source of practical comfort****ROM 8:31–8:39** See also JHN 10:27–10:29, JHN 17:2**Election is an incentive for righteous behaviour****COL 3:12–3:14** See also JHN 15:16–15:17; PHP 2:12–2:13; 2TH 2:13–2:15; 2PE 1:3–1:11**Election is a stimulus to the preaching of the gospel****2TI 2:10****6640: election, privileges of**

God chose a people to enjoy a unique relationship with him which entailed the privilege of belonging to him, sharing in all his inheritance, serving him, praising him and proclaiming him.

God elected Israel out of all the nations of the world**DEU 7:6** See also DEU 14:1–14:2; 1KI 3:8; 1CH 16:13; PSA 105:6, PSA 105:43, PSA 135:4; ISA 41:8–41:9; EZK 20:5–20:6**The election of the nation is anticipated in the election of the patriarchs****DEU 4:37–4:38** See also DEU 10:15; ACT 13:17–13:19**Election was not based on merit****DEU 7:7–7:8** See also DEU 9:4–9:6; EZK 16:1–16:14**God conferred privileges on the people he elected****Election meant that God dwelled in their midst****2CH 6:6** See also 1KI 14:21 parallel 2CH 12:13; 2KI 21:7 parallel 2CH 33:7; 2CH 6:34–6:35, 2CH 7:12, 2CH 7:16; NEH 1:9; PSA 132:13**Election meant that God showed divine favour****PSA 33:12** See also PSA 65:4, PSA 106:4–106:5; ISA 14:1, ISA 43:1, ISA 43:20, ISA 44:1–44:5, ISA 45:4; ZEC 1:17**God gave responsibilities to the people he elected****Election calls for obedient and holy living****LEV 20:26** See also EXO 19:5–19:6**Election means increased accountability****AMO 3:2** See also 2KI 23:26**God's choice of Israel does not automatically imply election to salvation****ROM 9:6–9:8** See also ROM 11:7–11:8**6641: election, responsibilities of**

God's election lays responsibilities upon those who have been chosen. Election to salvation has the natural consequence of election to service.

Election to leadership**JER 1:5** See also JDG 13:2–13:5; PSA 105:26, PSA 106:23**Election to religious service****DEU 21:5** See also DEU 18:3–18:5; 1SA 2:27–2:28; 1CH 15:2; 2CH 29:11**Election to build the house of God****Election to build the tabernacle****EXO 31:2–31:5** See also EXO 35:30–35:33, EXO 31:6–31:11, EXO 35:34–36:2**Election to build the temple****1CH 28:6** See also 1CH 28:10, 1CH 29:1**Election of foreign kings as instruments of discipline****ISA 45:1** ISA 44:28, ISA 48:14–48:15; ISA 7:17, ISA 7:20; JER 25:9, JER 27:6, JER 43:10**Election to kingship****1CH 28:4** ISA 16:1–16:13; ; PSA 78:70–78:71, PSA 89:3–89:4; 1SA 10:20–10:24 Saul; ; 1CH 28:5–28:7 Solomon**Election of the Messiah****The OT predicts the coming of a ``chosen one''****ISA 42:1–42:7** See also ISA 9:6–9:7, ISA 49:5–49:7**The NT identifies Jesus Christ as God's chosen Messiah****LUK 9:35** parallel MAT 3:16–3:17 See also MAT 12:15–12:21; ISA 42:1–42:4; 1PE 1:18–1:21, 1PE 2:4–2:6**Election to apostleship****LUK 6:13–6:16** parallel MRK 3:14–3:19 See also JHN 6:70, JHN 13:18, JHN 15:16, JHN 15:19; ACT 1:2, ACT 1:21–1:26, ACT 9:15–9:16, ACT 22:14–22:15; ROM 1:1; 1CO 1:1**6644: eternal life**

The state of being in a permanent living relationship with God, through Jesus Christ, begun in this life and consummated at the resurrection of believers.

6645: eternal life, nature of

Triumph over death and infinitely extended life. It also means a unique quality of life, knowing God in this life and sharing the life of Christ. Its source is God himself.

Eternal life is knowing God and enjoying his eternal blessings

JHN 17:3; PSA 16:11 See also PSA 21:4–21:6; EPH 1:3–1:14

Eternal glory is the believer's inheritance

2CO 4:17 See also DAN 12:3; 2TI 2:10; 1PE 5:4, 1PE 5:10

Contrasted with eternal judgment and rejection

MAT 25:46 Interpreters differ over whether “eternal punishment” implies an experience that continues for ever, or annihilation which is eternal in the sense of being irreversible. See also DAN 12:2; MAT 25:46; JHN 3:16; 2TH 1:8–1:9

The work of helping others come to eternal life

JHN 4:35–4:36

Eternal life as endless life

The guarantee of the resurrection

1CO 15:20–15:22 “firstfruits” because the resurrection of Jesus Christ is seen as the beginning of a harvest. See also PSA 49:15; ISA 26:19; 1TH 4:14

Death will be vanquished

REV 21:4 See also ISA 25:8; 1CO 15:26, 1CO 15:50–15:57

Believers will live for ever

JHN 11:25–11:26 See also LUK 20:34–20:36; JHN 6:51, JHN 6:54, JHN 6:58, JHN 8:51; 1JN 2:17

Eternal life as a quality of life

JHN 10:10 See also JHN 4:14

One of the blessings associated with the kingdom of God

MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:30, LUK 18:30; ; LUK 18:18

Life with Christ

JHN 6:67–6:69, JHN 15:5; ; COL 3:4; ; 1TH 5:10

Eternal life as experiencing Jesus Christ's life

GAL 2:20 See also 2CO 4:10–4:11; ROM 6:4, ROM 6:8, ROM 8:10–8:11

God is the source and giver of eternal life

God the Father

JHN 17:3 See also DEU 5:26; PSA 36:9, PSA 42:2, PSA 56:13; MAT 22:32 parallel MRK 12:27; LUK 20:38; 1TI 6:13

God the Son

JHN 14:6 See also JHN 1:4, JHN 11:25–11:26, JHN 17:3; 1JN 1:1–1:2, 1JN 5:20

God the Holy Spirit

JHN 6:63 See also 2CO 3:6; GAL 6:8

6646: eternal life, gift of

Eternal life cannot be earned or merited but must be received as a gift from God.

Fruitless attempts to earn eternal life

JHN 5:39–5:40 It is possible to study the mere letter of Scripture while ignoring coming to its focus, Jesus Christ; **GAL 3:11–3:12** See also ROM 3:20, ROM 3:28

Jesus Christ is the source of eternal life

1JN 5:11–5:12 See also JHN 11:25–11:26, JHN 14:6; ROM 5:21; HEB 5:9, HEB 9:12; 2TI 1:1, 2TI 1:10; 1JN 5:20

Eternal life is a gift

ROM 6:23 See also JHN 6:27, JHN 10:28; ROM 2:7, ROM 5:15–5:17; EPH 2:8–2:9; 1PE 3:7; 2PE 1:3

Received by faith

JHN 3:36 Faith in Jesus Christ, God's son, is the only way to gain eternal life. See also JHN 3:16, JHN 5:24, JHN 6:40, JHN 20:31; 1TI 1:16

The need for personal commitment

JHN 12:25–12:26 See also MAT 7:14; MRK 8:37–8:38; ACT 11:18 Repentance is the first step of commitment; ROM 6:8–6:11

6647: eternal life, experience of

Eternal life is a present possession, to to be experienced here and now, but it also offers rich and joyful future prospects.

Eternal life as a present possession

JHN 5:24 See also ROM 6:22; GAL 2:20; EPH 2:4–2:5; COL 2:13, COL 3:1–3:4; 1TI 6:12

The Holy Spirit as a sign of new life

ROM 8:9; ; 1CO 3:16, 1CO 6:19; ; EPH 1:13–1:14; ; 2TI 1:14

Eternal life as a future hope

1PE 1:3–1:5

Present experience the basis for future hope

See also COL 1:27; 2TH 2:16–2:17

Eternal life contrasted with present suffering

ROM 8:18 See also MAT 5:11–5:12; LUK 18:28–18:30 parallels MAT 19:29, MRK 10:29–10:30; JAS 1:12

The life to come

1TI 4:8 See also ROM 2:7; 2CO 5:4; COL 1:5; JUD 1:21

Being with Christ for ever

2CO 5:8 See also LUK 23:43; JHN 14:2–14:3, JHN 17:24; 1TH 4:15–4:17

Assurance of eternal life

The keeping power of God

JHN 10:28–10:29 See also ROM 8:38–8:39; 1PE 1:3–1:5

The believer's confidence in God

JHN 17:2–17:3 See also PSA 73:26; JOB 19:25; 1JN 5:11–5:13

The sure and certain hope

TIT 1:2, TIT 3:5–3:7; ; 2PE 1:10–1:11

6648: expiation

The removal of the guilt of sin in God's sight by the offering of a vicarious sacrifice which, in its death, bears the sin of the individual or nation concerned.

Expiation is necessary because sin is punishable by God

EXO 32:30 See also NUM 16:46–16:48; DEU 21:8; PSA 79:8–79:9

Expiation and the sacrificial system

Unintentional sins expiated by the sin offering

LEV 4:1–5:6; ; NUM 15:22–15:29

Unintentional sins requiring restitution expiated by the guilt offering

LEV 5:14–6:7, LEV 19:20–19:22

The nation's sins expiated on the annual Day of Atonement

EXO 30:10 See also LEV 16:3–16:34; HEB 9:7

Blood as a symbol of substitutionary sacrifice

LEV 17:11 See also EZK 45:19–45:20; HEB 9:22, HEB 13:11

The rite of expiation administered by the priests

LEV 9:7 See also LEV 7:7, LEV 9:15, LEV 10:17–10:18; NUM 6:11

Expiation and special provision for the poor

LEV 12:7–12:8 See also LEV 5:7–5:13, LEV 14:21–14:32

The sin offering as a constant reminder of the need for expiation

Sin offerings for occasions of dedication

EXO 29:31–29:33 See also LEV 8:14–8:15; NUM 8:12; 2CH 29:21–29:24; EZR 6:17

Sin offerings for occasions of purification

LEV 12:6–12:7, LEV 14:19–14:20, LEV 14:49–14:53, LEV 15:13–15:15, LEV 15:28–15:30; ; NUM 19:1–19:13

Sin offerings as part of the regular cycle of worship

NUM 28:15, NUM 28:22, NUM 28:30, NUM 29:5, NUM 29:11, NUM 29:16

The death of Jesus Christ as the fulfilment and replacement of the old sacrificial system

The death of Jesus Christ as a substitutionary, expiatory sacrifice

1JN 2:2 See also 1CO 15:3; GAL 1:4; HEB 1:3; 1PE 3:18

God's provision of Jesus Christ as an atoning sacrifice

ROM 3:25 See also ISA 53:10; ROM 8:3; 1JN 4:10

The blood of Jesus Christ as an atonement for sin

HEB 9:13–9:14 See also MAT 26:28; EPH 1:7; 1JN 1:7; REV 1:5

The sacrifice of Jesus Christ as final and unique

HEB 7:27 See also ROM 6:10; HEB 9:25–10:14

6650: finding

Discovering something or someone that is being looked for. The whole of Scripture points to God seeking out lost human beings and finding them. The delight of people at finding things (such as lost coins or wayward sons) is seen as a parable of the joy of God over repentant sinners.

Finding by searching

People do not always find what they are searching for

PRO 20:6 See also GEN 27:36–27:40; 2SA 17:20

God is sometimes found without being sought

ROM 10:20 See also ISA 65:1; ROM 9:30–9:31

Promises that God can be found

DEU 4:29; MAT 7:7–7:8 parallel LUK 11:9–11:10 See also JER 29:13–29:14

People's joy in finding God

Finding the kingdom

MAT 13:44 See also MAT 13:45–13:46

Finding the infant Jesus

MAT 2:9–2:11 See also LUK 2:10–2:12, LUK 2:16–2:18

Finding the Messiah

JHN 1:41 See also MRK 1:36; JHN 1:45

Finding the risen Christ

JHN 20:20 See also MAT 28:1–28:9; LUK 24:40–24:43

Results of finding God

Finding truth

JHN 8:31–8:32 See also PSA 25:4–25:5; JHN 16:13; 1TI 2:3–2:4

Finding rest and security

PSA 36:7 See also PSA 91:4; MAT 11:28–11:29

Finding mercy**PRO 28:13** See also PSA 6:9; MAT 5:7**Finding satisfaction****ECC 2:24–2:25****Finding success****ISA 18:14** See also GEN 39:23**Finding life****PRO 8:35** See also MAT 7:13–7:14, MAT 10:39**God's joy in finding repentant sinners****LUK 15:3–15:7** See also LUK 15:8–15:32**Other aspects of finding in life****Finding things**

DEU 14:21; ; MAT 17:24–17:27

Finding people

GEN 41:38; ; ACT 19:1; ; 2TI 1:16–1:17

Finding a wife

GEN 24:1–24:4; ; PRO 18:22

Finding wisdom

PRO 3:13, PRO 24:14; ; JAS 1:5

Finding God's will

NUM 9:8; ; JHN 7:17; ; ROM 12:2

Sin finds people out

NUM 32:23; ; 2SA 12:1–12:14; ; ACT 5:1–5:11

6652: forgiveness

The freeing of a person from guilt and its consequences, including punishment; usually as an act of favour, compassion or love, with the aim of restoring a broken personal relationship. Forgiveness can involve both the remission of punishment and the cancellation of debts.

6653: forgiveness, divine

God forgives the sins of believers on the basis of the once for all sacrifice offered by Jesus Christ on the cross. Believers' sins are no longer held against them, on account of the atoning death of Jesus Christ.

God's nature and forgiveness**EXO 34:5–34:7** See also NUM 14:17–14:20; NEH 9:16–9:17; PSA 103:1–103:18; ISA 43:25; MIC 7:18–7:20; 1JN 1:8–1:9**God's promise of forgiveness****JER 31:31–31:34** See also 2CH 7:14; ISA 55:6–55:7; HEB 8:8–8:12**People's need of forgiveness****1JN 1:8–1:10** See also PSA 51:1–51:5; ISA 6:1–6:5; ROM 3:9, ROM 3:23**The means of forgiveness****Under the old covenant****HEB 9:22** See also LEV 4:27–4:31, LEV 5:17–5:18**Under the new covenant****MAT 26:27–26:28** See also JHN 1:29; EPH 1:7–1:8; COL 2:13–2:15**The assurance of forgiveness****1JN 1:8–1:9** See also PSA 51:7, PSA 103:8–103:12, PSA 130:3–130:4; PRO 28:13; ISA 1:18; ACT 2:38; JAS 5:13–5:16; 1JN 2:1–2:2**6654: forgiveness, Jesus Christ's ministry of**

A central feature of Jesus Christ's ministry was his declaration that believers' sins were forgiven through their faith in him.

Jesus Christ's ministry of forgiveness was foretold**MAT 1:20–1:21; JHN 1:29****Jesus Christ's exercise of forgiveness****LUK 23:33–23:34** See also JHN 8:3–8:11**Jesus Christ has authority on account of his divinity to forgive sins****MAT 9:1–9:8** parallels MRK 2:1–2:12, LUK 5:17–5:26 Jesus Christ's authority to forgive is authenticated by his healing of the paralytic.**People's offence at Jesus Christ's exercise of forgiveness****MRK 2:5–2:7** parallels MAT 9:2–9:3, LUK 5:20–5:21**Parables of forgiveness**

See also MAT 18:23–18:35 the unmerciful servant; LUK 7:36–7:50, LUK 15:11–15:32 the lost son

The church's ministry of forgiveness in Jesus Christ's name**JHN 20:21–20:23** See also ACT 2:38, ACT 13:38, ACT 26:15–26:18**6655: forgiveness, application of**

God's forgiveness of believers' sins leads them to pray for his forgiveness of others and to be forgiving in their dealings with other people.

Prayers for forgiveness on behalf of others

For God's own people

EXO 32:30–32:32 See also NEH 1:4–1:11; DAN 9:4–9:19; AMO 7:1–7:6

For other human beings

GEN 18:20–18:33

For one's persecutors

LUK 23:33–23:34 See also MAT 5:43–5:44; ACT 7:59–7:60

Prayers for forgiveness for oneself

LUK 11:4 parallel MAT 6:12 See also NEH 9:1–9:3; PSA 51:1–51:17

Examples of forgiveness given

PSA 32:1–32:5 See also ISA 6:1–6:7; JHN 8:3–8:11

The call to exercise forgiveness

As a principle of life

LUK 6:37 See also MAT 5:38–5:48 parallel LUK 6:27–6:36

Within the church

COL 3:12–3:13 See also 2CO 2:5–2:11; EPH 4:32; 1PE 3:8–3:9

Forgiving enemies

PRO 24:17, PRO 25:21–25:22; ; MAT 5:44; ; ROM 12:20

Being forgiven is dependent on forgiving others

MRK 11:25–11:26 NIV footnote at verse 26. See also MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4; MAT 6:14–6:15, MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 6:37

Forgiveness is to be without limits

LUK 17:3–17:4 See also MAT 18:21–18:22

Examples of human forgiveness

ACT 7:59–7:60 See also GEN 50:15–50:21; 2SA 16:5–16:11

6658: freedom

The state of liberty that results from not being oppressed or in bondage. Scripture stresses that human beings lack freedom on account of sin, but that faith in Jesus Christ brings freedom from the power of sin and the law.

6659: freedom, acts of in OT

The OT provides many examples of God delivering his people from bondage, of which the greatest is the exodus. These acts of deliverance foreshadow and prepare the way for the redeeming work of God through Jesus Christ, revealed in the NT.

God's people regain their freedom

The exodus from Egypt as an act of deliverance

EXO 20:2 See also EXO 12:42, EXO 16:6, EXO 16:32 The people of Israel were frequently reminded that God had delivered them from Egypt; JOS 24:6; JDG 6:8; 2SA 7:6; 1KI 8:16; 2CH 7:22; PSA 80:8; JER 2:6, JER 11:4; HOS 12:9; AMO 2:10; MIC 6:4; HAG 2:5; HEB 8:9; JUD 1:5

The return from exile in Babylon as an act of deliverance

ISA 35:3–35:10 See also ISA 43:14–45:5, ISA 45:14–45:17, ISA 49:8–49:26, ISA 51:22–52:12, ISA 54:1–54:17, ISA 61:1–62:12; EZK 36:24–36:36, EZK 37:15–37:28

Freedom granted to individuals to reflect God's past deliverance

DEU 15:12–15:15 the sabbath year: all servants to be freed after six years; LEV 25:10, LEV 25:39–25:43

God's purposes in bringing about his people's freedom

God sets his people free to be his own

EXO 19:4; ; NUM 15:41; ; HOS 13:4

God sets his people free to serve him

EXO 19:3–19:6; ; LEV 25:55

God sets his people free to praise him

ISA 43:21

God sets his people free to be holy

LEV 11:45; ; DEU 28:9–28:10

God sets his people free to receive his promised gifts

EXO 3:8 The inheritance is the promised land of Canaan, which foreshadows the gospel inheritance of eternal life in the kingdom of God; ; NUM 14:7–14:8; ; DEU 8:7–8:9; ; EZK 20:6

Freedom is conditional upon obedience

Israel is commanded to remember the exodus as a matter of obedience

EXO 13:8–13:10

Israel's freedom depends upon continuing obedience to the LORD

DEU 28:25, DEU 28:47–28:48

Examples of Israel forfeiting freedom through sin

JDG 2:14, JDG 3:7–3:8, JDG 3:12, JDG 4:1–4:2, JDG 6:1; ; 2KI 17:6–17:23; ; PSA 137:1–137:4

6660: freedom, through Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ, the promised deliverer, sets his people free from the present effects of sin and from the

power of sin and will finally deliver them completely from its presence.

The OT points ahead to a new and greater freedom and to a new deliverer

The OT predicts Jesus Christ as the deliverer
ISA 61:1 See also ISA 42:6–42:7

The redemption of the exodus foreshadows the redemption achieved by Jesus Christ
COL 1:13–1:14 See also 1CO 10:1–10:4

Jesus Christ fulfils the OT predictions of him as deliverer
LUK 4:18–4:19 See also ROM 11:26; ISA 59:20

The freedom that comes through Jesus Christ
JHN 8:32–8:36 See also MAT 1:21

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the penalty of sin
1TH 1:10 See also JHN 3:36; ROM 8:1–8:2; HEB 9:15; REV 1:5

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the spiritual death that accompanies sin
ROM 6:1–6:7 See also EPH 2:1–2:5; HEB 9:14

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the fear of death
HEB 2:14–2:15

Jesus Christ will finally set his people free from death itself
1CO 15:22–15:23 See also ROM 5:12–5:17, ROM 7:24

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the power of sin
ROM 6:11–6:14 See also ROM 6:22–6:23

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the pollution of sin
2PE 1:2–1:4 See also GAL 1:3–1:4

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the power of Satan
COL 1:13–1:14 See also MRK 3:27 The strong man is, by implication, Jesus Christ; ACT 26:17–26:18

Jesus Christ will set his people free from the presence of sin
PHP 3:21 See also EPH 5:27; COL 1:22; 1TH 3:13, 1TH 5:23; REV 21:4

Freedom as the result of being rescued from trials by Jesus Christ
2TI 3:11 See also ACT 26:17; 2TI 4:18; 2PE 2:9

6661: freedom, and the law

Jesus Christ sets his people free from the condemnation and oppression of the law. Through the Holy Spirit, believers are able to fulfil the law obediently according to God's intentions.

Jesus Christ sets believers free from the law

Jesus Christ's life of perfect obedience to the law was the fulfilment of it
MAT 5:17 See also GAL 4:4–4:5; 1PE 2:22

Jesus Christ's death fulfils the demands of the law
2CO 5:21 See also HEB 7:27, HEB 9:11, HEB 9:26–9:28, HEB 10:11–10:14; 1PE 2:24, 1PE 3:18

On account of Jesus Christ's death, believers can be righteous independently of the law
ROM 3:21–3:26 See also JHN 1:17; ROM 10:4; PHP 3:9

Believers are set free from the law's condemnation

GAL 3:21–3:25 See also ROM 6:1–6:14, ROM 7:1–7:6; GAL 3:13, GAL 4:5, GAL 4:21–4:31 The lives of Abraham, Sarah, Hagar, Ishmael and Isaac are interpreted figuratively, to illustrate the believer's freedom from the law's condemnation; GAL 5:1; EPH 2:14–2:15; COL 2:13–2:14

The freedom of believers rests on the power of the Holy Spirit

ROM 7:1–7:6; 2CO 3:17–3:18 See also ROM 8:1–8:17; GAL 5:16–5:18, GAL 5:22–5:26

The believer's freedom to obey the law voluntarily

PSA 119:32 See also PSA 37:31, PSA 119:45, PSA 119:97; JER 31:33; 2CO 3:3; JAS 1:25, JAS 2:12

6662: freedom, abuse of Christian

Although Christians have been set free from condemnation by grace, they remain under an obligation to be obedient to God. Abuses of Christian freedom result from a failure to take responsibilities towards God seriously.

Christian freedom can be abused

Believers are freed from condemnation

ROM 8:1 See also ISA 50:8–50:9; ROM 8:33–8:39; COL 1:22; REV 1:5

Sin need not enslave believers

JHN 8:34–8:36 See also ROM 6:16–6:18, ROM 7:14–7:25; 1CO 7:22–7:23; 2PE 2:19

Believers must resist sin

ROM 6:12, ROM 6:14 See also HEB 12:1–12:2; 1JN 5:16–5:18

The false idea that grace gives believers the freedom to sin

ROM 6:1–6:2, ROM 6:15 See also ROM 3:5–3:8; 1CO 10:23; GAL 2:17–2:21

The dangers of abusing Christian freedom**Becoming a stumbling-block to others**

1CO 8:9–8:12 See also ROM 15:1–15:3

Indulging oneself

GAL 5:13 See also ROM 14:1–14:18

Using freedom to cover up evil

1PE 2:16

Examples of abuse of Christian freedom**Falling back into deliberate sin**

See also ROM 6:1–6:2; HEB 12:1; 1JN 3:6; 1JN 5:16–5:18

Disobedience towards God

1JN 3:4; ; 2CO 10:6; ; EPH 5:6

Selfishness

1JN 3:17 See also LUK 6:32–6:34

Eating food sacrificed to idols

1CO 8:1–8:13; ; REV 2:14, REV 2:20

6663: freedom, of the will

The ability to make decisions without being coerced by external forces. Scripture stresses that people are confronted with free choices between good and evil and commands them to choose good. However, it also notes that limitations are placed upon human actions through the enslaving power of sin.

Freedom of the will**Freedom of the will to choose between good and evil**

DEU 11:26–11:28 See also DEU 30:15–30:16, DEU 30:19; JOS 24:15; 1CH 28:9; JER 26:3; EZK 18:21–18:23

Freedom of the will to seek and find God

ISA 55:6 See also AMO 5:4; ACT 2:21; ROM 10:11; ISA 28:16; REV 22:17

The effect of sin upon freedom of the will**Sin prevents human beings from breaking free from its bondage**

ROM 7:14–7:20 See also ROM 6:16, ROM 6:22, ROM 7:25 Paul stresses that it is only through Jesus Christ that human beings can be freed from servitude to sin.

Sin hardens human hearts

HEB 3:13 See also DAN 5:20; ROM 1:21; EPH 4:17–4:19

God hardens human hearts

EXO 9:12 See also EXO 4:21, EXO 10:20, EXO 14:4, EXO 14:8; DEU 2:30; JOS 11:19–11:20; ROM 1:22–1:24, ROM 9:17–9:18

Human beings harden their own hearts

1SA 6:6 See also EXO 8:15, EXO 8:32; PSA 95:8; PRO 28:14; HEB 3:8, HEB 3:15, HEB 4:7

6666: grace

The unmerited favour of God, made known through Jesus Christ, and expressed supremely in the redemption and full forgiveness of sinners through faith in Jesus Christ.

6667: grace, in OT

In the OT, grace is evident in the special relationship between God and his people.

God's grace was expressed in the covenant relationship

DEU 7:7–7:9; 2KI 13:22–13:23 See also GEN 9:8–9:11, GEN 17:1–17:8; EXO 6:2–6:8; DEU 8:17–8:18; NEH 1:5–1:6; ISA 55:1–55:3; EZK 16:1–16:8

God's grace affirmed**God's grace shown in his compassion**

PSA 86:15; LAM 3:22; JOL 2:13 See also EXO 33:19; DEU 13:17–13:18; 2CH 30:9; EZR 8:22; PSA 103:13; EZK 39:25; HOS 2:19; JON 4:1–4:2; MIC 7:18–7:20; ZEC 10:6; MAL 3:17

God's grace shown in his readiness to forgive

ISA 55:7; JER 33:6–33:9 See also DAN 9:9–9:10; MIC 7:18–7:20

God's grace shown in his favour, provision and healing

LEV 26:9; JER 32:40–32:41 See also NUM 10:29; DEU 13:17–13:18; 2SA 22:28; PSA 30:4–30:5; ISA 49:8; JER 9:23–9:24, JER 33:6–33:9; NAM 1:7; ZEC 12:10

God made his grace known to individuals

NEH 9:16–9:20 The Israelites confess their sins; **JOB 10:12** See also GEN 24:35–24:36 Abraham; GEN 32:9–32:10 Jacob; GEN 39:20–39:21 Joseph; EXO 33:12–33:13 Moses; DEU 33:23 Naphtali; JDG 2:18 in the period of the judges; 1SA 2:21 Hannah; 1KI 3:6 Solomon; EZR 7:27–7:28 Ezra; NEH 2:8 Nehemiah; PSA 6:9 David; ISA 26:10 God's grace may be unavailing.

God's grace implored

2CH 33:12; PSA 51:1; ISA 33:2 See also GEN 24:12; EXO 32:11; 1KI 8:28–8:30; 2KI 13:4; NEH 9:32; PSA 25:16, PSA 69:13; DAN 9:17–9:19; HOS 14:2; HAB 3:2; ZEC 1:12

6668: grace, and Jesus Christ

Grace is demonstrated pre-eminently in Jesus Christ and the work he came to do.

God's promise of grace has been fulfilled in Jesus Christ

JHN 1:14, JHN 1:16–1:17; 2TI 1:8–1:10 See also JHN 3:16–3:17; ACT 13:38; ROM 1:1–1:5, ROM 5:8, ROM 5:16–5:17; EPH 1:3–1:8; TIT 2:11–2:14, TIT 3:4–3:5; 1PE 1:3–1:5

Grace was expressed in Jesus Christ's life and ministry

MAT 9:36 parallel MRK 6:34 **2CO 8:9** See also MAT 9:10–9:13 parallels MRK 2:15–2:17, LUK 5:27–5:32; MAT 11:4–11:5, MAT 19:13–19:15 parallels MRK 10:13–10:16, LUK 18:15–18:17; LUK 2:40, LUK 4:22, LUK 19:9–19:10, LUK 23:34; JHN 10:11; ACT 10:37–10:38; HEB 2:9; 1JN 3:16

Grace is demonstrated in Jesus Christ's atoning death on the cross

JHN 1:16–1:17; EPH 2:4–2:5; 1PE 2:10 See also JHN 3:16; ROM 3:22–3:24, ROM 5:1–5:2, ROM 8:32; 1CO 1:4–1:6; 2CO 5:18–5:19; GAL 2:21; EPH 4:7; 2TH 2:16–2:17; 1TI 1:13–1:14; 1PE 1:3–1:5; 1JN 4:10

6669: grace, and salvation

Deliverance through Jesus Christ is the result of accepting God's undeserved favour.

Salvation is all God's doing

ROM 5:6–5:8, ROM 9:14–9:16; EPH 1:7; 1TI 1:15–1:16 See also EXO 33:19; ACT 4:12, ACT 20:24; ROM 5:15–5:17; 2CO 6:2; COL 1:13–1:14; 2TH 2:16; TIT 2:11; HEB 7:23–7:25; REV 7:10

There is nothing human beings can do to save themselves

TIT 3:4–3:7 See also LUK 18:9–18:14; ROM 11:5–11:6

Salvation is not by keeping God's law

GAL 5:4 See also ROM 5:20–5:21, ROM 6:14, ROM 8:1–8:4; GAL 2:21, GAL 3:17–3:18; 1TI 1:9

Salvation must be accepted as a free gift by faith

EPH 2:4–2:9 See also ACT 15:7–15:11, ACT 16:30–16:31; ROM 3:21–3:24, ROM 4:14–4:16, ROM 5:1–5:2; HEB 4:16

6670: grace, and Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit is both an expression of God's grace and the means by which it is experienced.

The Holy Spirit is himself a gracious gift of God

ACT 2:38, ACT 6:5–6:8; TIT 3:4–3:7; 1JN 3:24 See also JHN 6:63, JHN 20:21–20:22; ACT 5:32, ACT 11:15–11:17, ACT 15:6–15:8; 1CO 2:12; GAL 3:14

Through the Holy Spirit God brings believers out of slavery and into his family

ROM 8:15–8:16 See also GAL 4:6–4:7; EPH 2:17–2:18

Through the Holy Spirit God equips believers to serve him

1CO 12:4–12:7 See also JHN 7:37–7:39; ACT 1:8, ACT 2:4, ACT 4:31; ROM 5:5; GAL 3:5; HEB 2:4

The Holy Spirit in God's gracious work of redemption

ROM 8:1–8:2 See also 1CO 2:4–2:5, 1CO 2:13; 1TH 1:4–1:5; 1PE 1:12

The Holy Spirit in God's gracious work of sanctifying and sustaining his people

2CO 3:17–3:18; 2TH 2:13 See also ACT 9:31; ROM 8:26–8:27, ROM 14:17–14:18, ROM 15:13; GAL 5:4–5:5, GAL 5:22–5:23, GAL 6:8; EPH 2:22, EPH 3:16–3:20; PHP 1:18–1:19; 2TI 1:14; HEB 10:29; JAS 4:4–4:6

6671: grace, and Christian life

The Christian life, from its beginning to its end, is totally dependent upon the grace of God.

God's grace compensates for human weaknesses

2CO 12:8–12:9; 1PE 5:10 See also 1CO 2:1–2:5; 2CO 9:8; HEB 2:14, HEB 4:15, HEB 5:2; JAS 4:6; 2PE 3:17–3:18

Believers are to pray for grace

HEB 4:16 See also PSA 25:16; HOS 14:1–14:2; COL 1:9, COL 4:12

Christian experience may be summed up in terms of grace

1CO 15:10 See also ACT 18:27; ROM 5:2; GAL 1:15; PHP 1:7

Believers should go on to experience more of God's grace

ACT 20:32 See also ACT 13:43; COL 1:3–1:6; HEB 13:9; 1PE 5:12; 2PE 3:18

Believers are enabled to serve Jesus Christ by his grace

1PE 4:10 See also ACT 15:39–15:40; ROM 5:17, ROM 12:6, ROM 15:15; 1CO 3:10; 2CO 12:9; GAL 2:9; EPH 3:7–3:9

God's grace is seen in Christian character, especially in generosity

2CO 8:6–8:7 Referring to a collection being taken up for the poor Christians in Jerusalem. See also ACT 4:33, ACT 11:22–11:23; 2CO 9:13–9:14; COL 4:6

An ongoing experience of God's grace requires the believer's co-operation

2CO 6:1 See also PHP 2:12–2:13; HEB 12:15; 1PE 5:5; JAS 4:6

6672: grace, in human relationships

Undeserved favour or kindness, mercy, compassion and generosity are to be found in human relationships and are strongly encouraged in Scripture.

Examples of grace in human relationships

RUT 2:10; 2SA 9:1–9:7; ACT 28:2 See also GEN 33:8–33:11; JOS 2:12–2:14; 1SA 15:6, 1SA 24:18; 1KI 2:7; PSA 37:25–37:26; ACT 4:8–4:10; 1CO 4:13

Grace in relationships encouraged

LUK 6:27–6:28 parallel MAT 5:44 See also PRO 14:9; ROM 15:7; PHM 1:14

Grace in relationships expressed as mercy and compassion

EPH 4:32 See also 2CH 10:7; ZEC 7:9; MAT 9:13; HOS 6:6; MAT 18:32–18:33; LUK 10:36–10:37, LUK 17:3–17:4; ROM 15:1–15:2; 1PE 3:8; JUD 1:22

Grace in relationships expressed as generosity and kindness

DEU 15:10–15:11 See also 1SA 25:8; PSA 112:5; PRO 11:25–11:27; 1CO 10:24; 2CO 9:11–9:13; GAL 6:9–6:10; 1TI 6:18; 2TI 2:24; HEB 13:16; 2PE 1:5–1:7

6674: imputation

The crediting by God to believers with righteousness on account of Jesus Christ. Paul argues that Abraham did nothing which earned him the status of being righteous in the sight of God. Rather, Abraham believed the promise of God, and for that reason was granted the status of being righteous before God. Likewise, all who trust in Jesus Christ have righteousness imputed to them—that is, reckoned as if it was theirs. Imputation should not be confused with impartation. Believers are not made right ethically (impartation), but put right relationally (imputation). What God changes is not the character of believers but their legal standing before him. From this new position, believers are called to co-operate with the Holy Spirit in sanctification so that their character increasingly reflects their new standing.

Righteousness imputed through faith not works

The example of Abraham

ROM 4:1–4:3 See also GEN 15:1–15:6; ROM 4:9–4:22; GAL 3:6–3:9

The testimony of David

ROM 4:6–4:8 See also PSA 32:1–32:2

The principle holds true for everyone

ROM 4:4–4:5, ROM 4:23–4:24 See also 1CO 1:30; 2CO 5:19; GAL 3:7–3:9; PHP 3:9

Believers' sins are imputed to Jesus Christ

2CO 5:21

Imputed righteousness expresses itself in good works

JAS 2:20–2:24 James does not contradict, but complements Paul's teaching by showing that the person who has been credited with righteousness will always express this in works.

6676: justification

The acquittal, or declaration of being righteous, before God as judge. It is a central aspect of Paul's understanding of what God achieved for believers through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.

6677: justification, necessity of

Sinful, law-breaking humanity needs a means of justification because of its failure to keep God's law and live up to God's requirements.

Justification in human relationships

The acquittal of the innocent

DEU 25:1 See also PRO 17:15; ISA 43:9, ISA 43:26; ROM 8:33

Justification of oneself

JOB 32:2 See also LUK 10:29, LUK 16:15, LUK 18:9–18:14

The need for justification

The reality of God's righteousness

PSA 11:7 See also PSA 33:5, PSA 35:28; JER 23:6; MAT 6:33; JHN 17:25; ROM 1:17, ROM 3:22

The reality of God's justice

PSA 9:8 See also JOB 36:3; PSA 11:7, PSA 33:5; ISA 5:16; JER 9:24; LUK 18:7; REV 19:11

The reality of God's judgment

GEN 18:25 See also JDG 11:27; PSA 51:4; MIC 6:2; MAT 12:36; ROM 2:16

The reality of God's law

JAS 4:12 See also EXO 20:2–20:17 parallel DEU 5:6–5:21; PSA 19:7; ISA 33:22; ROM 7:12, ROM 7:16, ROM 8:3–8:4; 1TI 1:8

Human guilt shows the need for justification

PSA 143:2 See also ROM 3:23; 1JN 1:8, 1JN 1:10

People are unable to justify themselves, even through the law

ISA 64:6; ROM 3:20–3:21; GAL 2:15–2:16 See also AMO 4:4; MAT 5:20; LUK 10:29, LUK 16:15, LUK 18:9–18:14; ROM 1:17, ROM 3:20; GAL 2:21, GAL 3:2–3:3, GAL 2:11 Paul opposes Peter's position on circumcision; GAL 5:4; PHP 3:4–3:8

6678: justification, and Jesus Christ's work

On account of the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, the demands of the law of God are met, and believers are granted the status of being righteous in the sight of God.

Justification is grounded in the death of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ's death shields believers from God's wrath

ROM 5:9 See also ROM 3:24, ROM 4:25, ROM 5:18; 1PE 2:24

Jesus Christ's death fulfils the demands of the law of God

ROM 8:3–8:4 See also ROM 3:25–3:26; GAL 3:13; 1JN 2:2

Justification is grounded in the resurrection of Jesus Christ

ROM 4:25, ROM 10:9–10:10 See also ACT 2:22–2:39, ACT 4:10–4:12, ACT 17:30–17:31; 1PE 3:18–3:21

Justification means believers are reckoned as righteous through the death of Jesus Christ

ROM 5:19; 1CO 1:30; 2CO 5:21 See also 1CO 6:9–6:11; PHP 3:8–3:9 The term "imputation" is used to refer to the process by which God treats believers as being righteous in his sight on account of Jesus Christ's death.

Justification is received by faith

ROM 1:17 parallel GAL 3:11 See also HAB 2:4; ROM 5:1; EPH 2:8

The example of Abraham

GEN 15:6 See also ROM 4:1–4:5, ROM 4:9–4:22; GAL 3:6–3:9, GAL 3:16–3:18

The example of David

ROM 4:6–4:8; ; PSA 32:1–32:2

Apostolic teaching on the need of faith for justification

ACT 13:39 See also ROM 3:22, ROM 3:25, ROM 3:27–3:30, ROM 4:5, ROM 5:1, ROM 9:30–9:32, ROM 10:10; 1CO 6:11; GAL 2:16, GAL 3:8, GAL 3:14; EPH 2:8

Justification is a gift of God's grace

ROM 3:24 See also ROM 5:15–5:17, ROM 8:33; TIT 3:7

Not by works or the law

GAL 3:11 See also ROM 3:20, ROM 4:5; GAL 2:16, GAL 2:21, GAL 3:2–3:5, GAL 3:24, GAL 5:4–5:6; EPH 2:8–2:9

6679: justification, results of

Justification brings a changed relationship with God and a future hope. It will also bring a change in behaviour.

The results of justification

Peace with God, access to his presence and the hope of his glory

ROM 5:1–5:2 See also ROM 8:30; TIT 3:7

Assurance of forgiveness

ROM 5:9; ; EPH 1:13–1:14

Knowing Jesus Christ and participating in his resurrection

PHP 3:10–3:11 See also ROM 6:5

Freedom from condemnation

ROM 8:31–8:34 See also ROM 8:1–8:4; GAL 3:13–3:14

Freedom from domination by sin

ROM 6:14, ROM 6:17–6:18

Adoption into God's family

See also ROM 8:15–8:17; GAL 4:6–4:7

Righteousness in the sight of God

ROM 5:17; PHP 3:8–3:9 See also ROM 3:20–3:22; 1CO 1:30

Justification must lead to good works

JAS 2:24 See also ROM 6:15–6:18; GAL 5:13–5:16; JAS 2:14–2:26

6682: mediation

The achieving of fellowship and reconciliation between separated parties. Scripture declares that Jesus Christ is the only true mediator between God and humanity.

Jesus Christ is the only mediator between God and humanity

1TI 2:5–2:6

Mediation through the covenants

Through the covenants of law

GAL 3:19 See also PSA 119:29; JHN 1:17

Through the covenants of promise

HEB 12:24 See also GEN 12:3, GEN 17:7, GEN 17:11; ISA 59:21; HEB 8:6, HEB 9:15

Mediation through the prophetic word

EZK 3:4 See also EXO 4:15–4:16; JER 1:9

Jesus Christ is the supreme mediator of the prophetic word

JHN 7:40 See also MAT 11:27, MAT 17:5; JHN 14:6, JHN 14:9–14:10; REV 19:13

Mediation through priestly intercession and blessing

Mediation by sacrifice

1CH 21:26 parallel 2SA 24:25 See also DEU 33:10; 1KI 18:30–18:38; HEB 9:22–9:23

Jesus Christ as both priest and sacrifice

HEB 7:27 See also ISA 53:10; HEB 2:17, HEB 9:11–9:15

Mediation by praying for others

1SA 12:23 See also GEN 20:7; EXO 32:30–32:32; PSA 106:23; JER 9:1

Jesus Christ's continuing intercession

ROM 8:34 See also ISA 53:12; HEB 7:25, HEB 9:24

Mediation through blessing

DEU 21:5 See also GEN 12:2–12:3; NUM 6:22–6:27; 2SA 6:18 parallel 1CH 16:2

Jesus Christ mediates overflowing blessing

GAL 3:14 See also ACT 3:25; ROM 15:29; GAL 3:8; EPH 1:3

Mediation for suffering and guilty believers

JOB 9:32–9:35 See also JOB 16:19–16:21; 1JN 2:1

Universal mediation

COL 1:20

Mediation between people and Jesus Christ

See also MAT 12:22, MAT 15:30; MRK 2:3–2:12, MRK 5:23, MRK 9:17–9:18; LUK 4:38–4:39; JHN 4:47–4:49

Mediation between individuals

GEN 37:21–37:22 Reuben for Joseph; ; GEN 41:9–41:13 the baker for Joseph; ; 1SA 19:1–19:7 Jonathan for David; ; 2SA 14:1–14:24 Joab for Absalom; ; PHM 1:10–1:21 Paul for Onesimus

6684: mediator

An intermediary who intervenes between two separated or alienated parties, with the aim of achieving reconciliation and fellowship. Scripture declares that Jesus Christ is the only true mediator between God and humanity.

A person who brings together those who are separated from each other

2SA 14:14

Mediators between God and humanity before the time of Jesus Christ

Abraham

GEN 18:22–18:32 See also GEN 20:7

Moses

DEU 5:5 See also EXO 32:30–32:32; DEU 5:27, DEU 9:18

Prophets

DEU 18:18 See also 2CH 36:15; JER 7:25; AMO 3:7; MAT 23:34

Priests

NUM 3:10 See also EXO 19:6; LEV 9:7; NUM 16:48, NUM 18:7

The suffering servant

ISA 49:6 See also ISA 42:1, ISA 42:4, ISA 53:4–53:6, ISA 53:10–53:12

Angels

ACT 7:53 See also JOB 5:1, JOB 16:19–16:21, JOB 33:23; DAN 4:13, DAN 4:23

Jesus Christ is the only true mediator

1TI 2:5

Jesus Christ as greater than all OT mediators

JHN 1:17 See also HEB 1:3, HEB 3:1–3:6, HEB 7:26–7:28, HEB 8:6, HEB 9:23–9:24

Mediators between people

2SA 14:1–14:33 Joab; ; MAT 5:9 Christians; ; ACT 9:26–9:27 Barnabas; 1CO 1:10–1:12; ; PHP 4:2–4:3; ; PHM 1:17–1:21

6686: mercy

A quality of compassion, especially as expressed in God's forgiveness of human sin. Scripture stresses God's forbearance towards sinners. In his mercy, God shields sinners from what they deserve and gives gifts that they do not deserve.

6687: mercy, nature of God's

A central aspect of God's character, expressed in his covenant relationships with undeserving people.

God is merciful

DAN 9:9; EPH 2:4 See also 2SA 24:14; NEH 9:31; PSA 5:7, PSA 25:6; JER 3:12; LUK 1:78; 1TI 1:2; JAS 5:11; 1PE 1:3; 2JN 1:3; JUD 1:2

God's mercy is expressed in his faithfulness to his covenant with his people

MIC 7:18–7:20 See also DEU 4:31, DEU 7:9; 1KI 8:23–8:24; NEH 1:5, NEH 9:30–9:31; PSA 143:1; ISA 63:9; LUK 1:54–1:55, LUK 1:69–1:75

God's faithfulness and mercy are never-ending

PSA 103:17 See also PSA 25:6, PSA 106:1, PSA 119:132

God's mercy and grace are seen in Jesus Christ

JHN 1:14 See also ROM 3:22–3:24, ROM 5:15; EPH 1:7; HEB 4:16; JUD 1:21

God's mercy is not confined to the Jewish nation

ROM 3:29–3:30 See also ISA 49:6; JON 4:2; ROM 10:12, ROM 11:28–11:32, ROM 15:8–15:12; GAL 3:14; EPH 3:6–3:8; COL 1:27

God chooses when and where to exercise his mercy

ROM 9:15–9:16 See also EXO 33:19; DEU 7:7–7:8; PSA 33:12; JHN 15:16; 1CO 1:27–1:29

God's responds in mercy to those who call to him

PSA 6:9 There are many appeals to God's mercy in the book of Psalms. See also 1KI 8:28; 2CH 6:19; JOB 9:15; DAN 9:18

6688: mercy, demonstration of God's

God demonstrates his mercy in his various dealings with his people.

God as a parent

PSA 103:13–103:14; EPH 1:4–1:6 See also ISA 49:15, ISA 63:7–63:8, ISA 66:13; JER 31:20; HOS 11:1–11:4; MAL 3:17; 2CO 1:3

God's mercy and compassion to those in distress

ISA 49:13 See also EXO 2:23–2:24; PSA 91:14–91:16, PSA 111:2–111:9, PSA 113:7–113:9, PSA 142:1–142:3; ISA 63:9; JON 2:2; 2CO 4:1; HEB 4:16

In judgment, God's mercy is just and true

DEU 32:36 See also PSA 143:1; ISA 11:3–11:5, ISA 30:18, ISA 54:7–54:8, ISA 60:10; HAB 3:2; REV 19:11

God may choose to show no mercy

PSA 59:5 See also JOS 11:20; JER 21:7; JAS 2:13

God's mercy shown in his actions**The act of salvation**

EPH 2:4–2:5 See also EXO 15:13; JDG 2:18 In the OT, salvation was seen in physical, as much as in spiritual, terms; PSA 13:5, PSA 28:6–28:8, PSA 31:21–31:22 PSA 40:10–40:11, PSA 57:1, PSA 69:16, PSA 86:15–86:16 PSA 98:2–98:3, PSA 116:4–116:6; NEH 9:27; 1PE 1:3, 1PE 2:10; 2PE 3:15

His forgiveness

PSA 51:1–51:2 See also NUM 14:18–14:19; PSA 25:6–25:7, PSA 79:8, PSA 130:1–130:4; ISA 55:7; HOS 14:1–14:4; MIC 7:18–7:19; 1TI 1:15–1:16; 1JN 1:9

His blessing

DEU 13:17–13:18 Moses concerning idolatry. See also DEU 7:12–7:13, DEU 30:3

6689: mercy, of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ displays the same attitude of grace and mercy towards men and women as his Father does.

Jesus Christ is merciful

LUK 4:16–4:21 See also ISA 61:1–61:2 **JHN 15:12–15:13** See also 2CO 8:9, 2CO 13:14; EPH 4:7; PHP 2:1; 1TI 1:16; 2TI 1:18, 2TI 2:1; JUD 1:21

Jesus Christ's concern for people in need

MAT 9:36 parallel MRK 6:34 See also MAT 14:14, MAT 15:32 parallel MRK 8:2; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34

Jesus Christ's response to appeals for mercy

MAT 20:30–20:34 See also MAT 8:2–8:3 parallels MRK 1:39–1:40, LUK 5:12–5:13; MAT 8:5–8:13, MAT 9:18–9:30, MAT 15:22, MAT 17:14–17:18; JHN 11:6; 2CO 12:8–12:9

Jesus Christ's mercy in response to judgment

JHN 12:47

Jesus Christ as high priest

HEB 2:17–2:18 See also HEB 4:15

Jesus Christ's mercy is shown in his actions**In salvation**

EPH 5:2 See also LUK 19:10; GAL 2:20; EPH 5:25; 1TI 1:14–1:16; TIT 3:4–3:7

In forgiveness

LUK 23:34 See also MRK 2:10

In blessing

MRK 10:13–10:16 parallel MAT 19:13–19:15

6690: mercy, response to God's

God's merciful dealings with believers should move them to show similar acts of mercy to others, as well as to rejoice in his graciousness and proclaim it to others.

The proper response to God's mercy

A self-giving faith

ROM 12:1 See also PSA 13:5, PSA 52:8; EPH 2:8; 1TI 1:16; HEB 4:16; 1PE 5:5; JAS 4:6

A merciful attitude towards others

LUK 6:36 See also MIC 6:8; ZEC 7:9; MAT 5:7, MAT 9:13; LUK 10:27–10:37; JAS 2:12–2:13

A forgiving attitude towards others

MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4 See also MAT 6:14, MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 6:37, LUK 17:3–17:4; 2CO 2:7; EPH 4:32; COL 3:13

Mercy is to be a characteristic of daily living

HEB 13:1 See also MAT 25:37–25:40; ROM 12:9–12:21; JUD 1:23

By God's mercy, the believer can persevere

2CO 4:1 See also 2TH 3:3–3:5

Sharing God's grace and mercy with others

2CO 8:1 See also 2CO 5:14–5:20

6691: mercy, human

Believers are urged to show the same qualities of mercy and compassion towards one another as God demonstrates to them. A lack of mercy is regarded as characteristic of godless people.

The need for human mercy

PRO 18:23 See also DEU 28:49–28:50; 2SA 12:6; 1KI 3:26; JOB 19:21; PRO 21:10; ISA 47:6, ISA 49:15; ZEC 7:9–7:11

Believers should be merciful

MIC 6:8; MAT 5:7; LUK 6:36 See also ZEC 7:9; JAS 2:12–2:13; 1PE 3:9; JUD 1:22

Lack of mercy characterises the godless

ISA 13:18 See also JER 6:23, JER 21:7, JER 50:42; AMO 1:11–1:12; HAB 1:13–1:17; MAT 23:23

Lack of mercy on Israel's part was sometimes obedience to God

DEU 7:2 Concerning the peoples they were to displace in the promised land. See also DEU 13:6–13:9, DEU 19:11–19:13, DEU 19:21, DEU 28:53–28:54; JOS 6:17–6:19; 1SA 15:18–15:19

Mercy as a greeting and a blessing

As a greeting

1TI 1:2 See also 2TI 1:2; 2JN 1:3; JUD 1:2

As a blessing

GAL 6:16 See also 2TI 1:16–1:18; JUD 1:21

6694: mystery

Normally, God's plan of salvation which, though once unknown to human beings, is now revealed by God.

God's character and purpose cannot be discerned by human reason

JOB 11:7 See also JOB 38:1–42:6

God reveals his plans through dreams, interpreted by his servant

DAN 2:28 Nebuchadnezzar's dreams require the interpretation that God discloses to Daniel before they can be understood as a revelation of divine purposes for Babylon and the surrounding nations. See also DAN 2:17–2:49, DAN 4:9

God's mysteries are revealed to a man inspired by his Spirit

DAN 4:18 See also AMO 3:7

The mystery of God's kingdom

MAT 13:11 parallels MRK 4:11, LUK 8:10 God's plan to establish his kingdom is revealed only to those chosen to receive it. To those "outside" it is hidden in parables.

Mystery as God's plan of salvation

God's plan, now revealed, has been hidden for long ages

EPH 3:9 The use of "mystery" in this sense is found particularly in Paul's letters. See also ROM 16:25; 1CO 2:7; COL 1:26

God's plan is fulfilled in Jesus Christ

EPH 1:9 See also EPH 3:4; COL 2:2; 1TI 3:16 The "mystery of godliness" is the revealed secret that produces godliness in people.

God's plan through Jesus Christ is for the salvation of Gentiles as well as Jews

EPH 3:6 See also ROM 11:25; COL 1:27

Ultimately God's plan is for the transformation of the whole creation

EPH 1:9–1:10 See also 1CO 15:51–15:53; REV 10:7, REV 17:5–17:8

God's plan is revealed by his Spirit so that his servants may publicly proclaim it

EPH 3:8–3:9 See also EPH 3:4–3:6, EPH 6:19; COL 1:25–1:27, COL 4:3; REV 10:7

Mystery as other aspects of God's purposes, spiritually discerned

2TH 2:7 Paul's reference to "the secret power (literally "mystery") of lawlessness" suggests that we know some things about evil only as God reveals them. See also 1CO 13:2, 1CO 14:2

Mystery as an allegorical understanding of a biblical text, revealed to Paul by God

EPH 5:31–5:32 Paul sees Ge 2:24 as symbolising the unity between Jesus Christ and his church; the unity of husband and wife is a human reflection of that relationship.

6696: necessity

That which makes certain actions or events occur. Scripture relates it to particular events which must happen to bring about God's plan of salvation and also to the behaviour that believers are to adopt as a result of their commitment to Jesus Christ.

The necessity of Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

LUK 24:25–24:27 See also MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22; LUK 17:25, LUK 24:44–24:47; JHN 3:14–3:15, JHN 20:9

The necessity of Jesus Christ's obedience

LUK 4:42–4:44 See also MAT 3:14–3:15; LUK 2:49, LUK 13:31–13:33; JHN 4:4 The necessity lay in Jesus Christ's mission not in geography; JHN 9:4

The necessity of the events leading to the end times

REV 1:1 See also MRK 13:7–13:8 parallels MAT 24:6–24:8, LUK 21:9–21:11; MRK 13:10 parallel MAT 24:14; 1CO 15:50–15:55; 2CO 5:10; REV 4:1, REV 20:1–20:3, REV 22:6

Necessity and the law

GAL 5:3 See also JHN 19:7; HEB 5:3, HEB 9:16, HEB 9:22–9:23

Necessity in the life of the Christian

The necessity of conversion

JHN 3:5–3:7 See also MAT 18:2–18:3; JHN 3:3; ACT 4:12, ACT 17:30

The necessity of godly behaviour

1JN 2:6 See also ROM 15:1–15:2; 1TI 3:14–3:15, 1TI 4:7–4:8; 2TI 2:22–2:24; TIT 2:11–2:14

Necessity in the life of Paul

The necessity of Paul's calling

ACT 9:15–9:16 See also ACT 9:6

The necessity of Paul's preaching of the gospel

ACT 13:46, ACT 19:21, ACT 23:11, ACT 27:21–27:25, ACT 28:19; ; ROM 1:14; ; 1CO 9:16–9:18

The paradoxes of necessity

Freedom and necessity

ROM 6:18 See also 1CO 9:19–9:23; 2CO 9:7; PHM 1:14

Responsibility and necessity

MAT 18:7 parallel LUK 17:1 See also LUK 22:22 parallels MAT 26:24, MRK 14:21; ACT 2:23

6698: newness

Through Jesus Christ, God has made possible a new relationship between himself and sinful humanity. This involves the renewal of human nature and eventually a renewal of creation itself.

The newness of the gospel

The teaching of Jesus Christ was acclaimed as something new

MRK 1:27

The kingdom of God is like new cloth

LUK 5:36 parallels MAT 9:16, MRK 2:21

The kingdom of God is like new wine

LUK 5:37–5:38 parallels MAT 9:17, MRK 2:22

A new covenant has been established between God and his people

JER 31:31; HEB 9:15 See also 1CO 11:25; 2CO 3:6; HEB 8:1–8:13, HEB 10:20, HEB 12:24

The newness brought to believers through redemption

Believers are called by a new name

ISA 62:2 See also REV 2:17

Believers are born anew

1PE 1:3 See also JHN 3:1–3:16

A new life is made possible for believers

ACT 5:20 See also ROM 6:4; COL 3:10

Believers are a new creation

2CO 5:17 See also GAL 6:15; EPH 4:23–4:24

Believers are given a new commandment

JHN 13:34–13:35 See also 1JN 2:7–2:8

The newness of creation to come through God's redeeming action

REV 21:1–21:2 See also ISA 43:19, ISA 65:17, ISA 66:22; 2PE 3:13; REV 3:12, REV 21:5

6700: peace

The state of harmony that is available to believers through having a right relationship with God and others and is especially associated with the presence of the Holy Spirit.

6701: peace, human search for

Scripture teaches that peace is only found in God, but people try to find it elsewhere. A person's desire for peace varies according to his or her circumstances.

The places where people search for peace

People search for peace in others

GEN 5:28–5:29 See also SNG 8:10

People search for peace in material possessions

ECC 4:8 See also JOB 21:7–21:13; DAN 4:4; MAT 19:16–19:22; LUK 12:16–12:19

People search for peace in God

PSA 4:8 See also JOB 22:21; PRO 19:23; ISA 26:3; LUK 7:37–7:50

The dangers in searching for peace

It can lead to greed

ECC 4:6 See also MAT 23:25

It can lead to suffering and bondage

GEN 42:1–42:17; ; JOS 9:3–9:27; ; MRK 5:25–5:26

It can lead to destruction

1TH 5:3 See also 2KI 20:12–20:19; LUK 16:19–16:26

People's search for peace varies according to their circumstances

The desire can increase in times of suffering and difficulties

EXO 2:23 See also JER 14:19, JER 47:2–47:6; LAM 3:7–3:24; EZK 7:23–7:27; MRK 5:24–5:34 parallels MAT 9:18–9:22, LUK 8:42–8:48

The desire can diminish in times of comfort

EXO 8:12–8:15 See also JOB 12:5; HOS 10:1; AMO 6:1

6702: peace, human destruction of

Because of human sinfulness, God's provision of peace is always under threat. Scripture shows that this breaking of peace has implications for the whole of creation.

Causes of the destruction of peace

Sin and self-centredness

ISA 57:21 See also GEN 11:4–11:9; ISA 59:7–59:8; LUK 19:41–19:44

Idolatry

ZEC 10:2 See also EXO 32:7–32:10; 1TI 6:9–6:10

Fear and anxiety

JHN 20:19 See also JOS 7:3–7:5; PRO 29:25; JER 30:10, JER 46:27; MAT 6:31–6:34 parallel LUK 12:29–12:30

The sins of ancestors

LEV 26:36–26:42 See also GEN 3:16–3:19; 2KI 23:26–23:27; JER 31:29; EZK 18:2

Friends

JER 20:10 See also LAM 1:1–1:2, LAM 1:19

Enemies

PSA 35:19–35:20 See also 2KI 9:14–9:28; LAM 1:16

The consequences of the human destruction of peace

Humanity suffers

DEU 28:53–28:57; ; 1KI 2:5–2:6; ; 2KI 6:24–6:29, 2KI 25:2–25:3; ; EZK 13:10–13:16; ; REV 6:3–6:8

Nations suffer

JER 49:31–49:32 See also EZK 38:14–38:23

The land suffers

JER 25:37 See also EXO 8:12–8:14; LEV 26:27–26:35; ISA 1:7, ISA 36:16–36:20

The whole creation suffers

REV 6:3–6:4 See also GEN 6:5–6:7; ISA 24:1–24:5; ROM 8:22; REV 8:7–8:13

6703: peace, divine in OT

Providing peace for his creation is a characteristic of God. In the OT peace came through adherence to God's will as expressed in his spoken word, covenants and law. The Hebrew word "shalom" means "peace in all its fullness, in every aspect of life".

Peace provided for God's people

Through obedience to God's spoken word

GEN 2:16–2:17 See also 2KI 5:13–5:19; JOB 22:21–22:22; PSA 85:8; ISA 54:13; DAN 10:15–10:19

Through obedience to God's covenants

DEU 29:9 See also DEU 30:15–30:16; MAL 2:1–2:6

Through obedience to God's laws

PSA 119:165 See also LEV 26:3–26:12; DEU 28:1–28:7; 2CH 14:2–14:7; PSA 37:34–37:38; PRO 3:13–3:17; ISA 48:18

Peace expressed in signs

GEN 9:13–9:16 See also EXO 13:21–13:22, EXO 40:36–40:38; JDG 6:22–6:24

Peace provided for God's nation**Through provision of the land**

PSA 37:11 See also ISA 7:13–7:14; 1CH 4:40; PSA 37:3

Through provision of a holy city

ISA 33:20–33:24 See also PSA 122:6–122:8; ISA 66:10–66:13; JER 33:6–33:9; ZEC 1:16–1:17

Through provision of a house of God

HAG 2:9 See also 1CH 22:6–22:10; EZK 37:24–37:28

Through provision of the law

ISA 48:18 See also DEU 6:1–6:3, DEU 30:15–30:16

The benefits of peace**Peace and God's presence**

ISA 41:10 See also NUM 6:22–6:26; JOS 1:9; PSA 23:1–23:4, PSA 29:11; JER 30:10–30:11

Peace in captivity

JER 29:7 See also EXO 1:6–1:12; JER 31:1–31:2

Peace in suffering

PSA 119:50 See also ISA 61:1–61:4; JER 34:1–34:5

Peace in poverty

ISA 14:30 See also ISA 2:6–2:9; PSA 68:5–68:10; PRO 17:1

Peace with enemies

PRO 16:7 See also 1CH 22:7–22:9; JER 29:4–29:7

6704: peace, divine in NT

God's ultimate provision of peace is discovered in the person and work of Jesus Christ. It is only through Christ that peace with God can be achieved and maintained.

Provision of peace through the Father**Peace in a believer's relationship with the Father**

ROM 5:1 See also ROM 8:1, ROM 8:31–8:39; 1CO 1:2–1:3

Peace through the Father's provision for the believer

1TI 6:17 See also MAT 6:25–6:34 parallel LUK 12:22–12:31; MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13

Provision of peace through Jesus Christ**Through Jesus Christ's coming**

LUK 2:10–2:14 ISA 9:6–9:7; ; MIC 5:2–5:5; ; ZEC 9:9–9:10; LUK 2:25–2:32; ; EPH 2:17

Through Jesus Christ's teaching

JHN 16:33 See also JHN 14:23–14:27, JHN 15:3

Through Jesus Christ's ministry

ACT 10:36 See also MRK 4:35–4:41 parallels MAT 8:23–8:27, LUK 8:22–8:25; LUK 4:33–4:35 parallel MRK 1:23–1:25; LUK 4:38–4:41 parallels MAT 8:14–8:17, MRK 1:29–1:34

Through Jesus Christ's death

COL 1:19–1:20 See also ISA 53:5; MAT 26:26–26:28 parallels MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:19–22:20; GAL 6:14–6:16; EPH 2:13–2:17

Through Jesus Christ's resurrection

LUK 24:36 See also MRK 16:4–16:6 parallel LUK 24:1–24:8; JHN 20:19–20:21, JHN 20:26–20:29; 2CO 4:14; HEB 13:20–13:21

Through Jesus Christ's ascension

ROM 8:34 See also LUK 24:51–24:53; ACT 2:33–2:39

Provision of peace through the Holy Spirit**Through the Holy Spirit's inner witness**

2CO 1:21–1:22 See also ROM 8:14–8:17; GAL 4:6–4:7

Through the Holy Spirit's presence

ACT 9:31 See also JHN 14:16–14:18; GAL 5:16–5:18; REV 22:17

Peace as the Holy Spirit's fruit and gift

GAL 5:22 See also ROM 14:17

6705: peace, believers' experience of

Peace is the birthright of every believer in all circumstances. It is found only in God and is maintained through having a close relationship with him.

Peace for believers in differing situations**In times of sickness, pressure and hardships**

PSA 41:1–41:3; MAT 11:28 See also JOB 1:13–1:22, JOB 2:7–2:10; ACT 16:22–16:25; 2CO 12:7–12:10; 2TI 4:16–4:18

In times of death and grief

JHN 14:1–14:3 See also JOB 19:25–19:26; 2KI 22:18–22:20; ISA 57:1–57:2; 1TH 4:13–4:18

The effects of peace for believers**Forgiveness**

ACT 7:60 See also ROM 12:17–12:19

Encouragement

2CO 1:3–1:6 See also PHP 4:11–4:13

Health and healing

PRO 14:30 See also ISA 57:18–57:19

Security

PRO 1:33 See also ACT 27:21–27:26; ROM 8:28, ROM 8:35–8:39

Hope**ROM 15:13** See also ROM 5:1–5:5**How believers maintain peace****Through remaining in Christ****JHN 15:4–15:7** See also JHN 16:33; ROM 5:1–5:5**Through living by the Holy Spirit****ROM 8:6** See also ROM 14:17–14:19; GAL 5:22**Through obedience to God's word****JOS 1:8–1:9** See also PSA 119:165–119:167**Through prayer and meditation****PHP 4:6–4:9** See also PSA 1:1–1:3; ISA 26:3; 1TI 2:1–2:2**Final peace in death for believers****ISA 57:2; REV 14:13** See also 2KI 22:19–22:20; LUK 2:29**Hope of future peace for believers****Peace in heaven****1PE 1:4** See also JHN 14:1–14:3; 1TH 4:13–4:14; REV 7:9–7:17**Peace in God's new creation****REV 21:1–21:4** See also ISA 11:6–11:9; ROM 8:18–8:23; REV 22:3–22:5**6706: peace, and Holy Spirit**See [3215: Holy Spirit, and peace](#)**6708: predestination**

God's foreordination of all events and circumstances for the good of his people and the glory of his name.

Predestination depends on God's sovereignty**He is the Creator of all things****JER 32:17–32:19** See also GEN 1:1; JOB 38:1–38:4; ISA 44:24–44:28; ISA 45:12–45:13; ISA 48:12–48:14**He rules over nature and history****PRO 16:4** See also GEN 18:10–18:14; PSA 67:4; PRO 16:9; PRO 16:33; PRO 21:1; MAT 8:23–8:27 parallels MRK 4:35–4:41; LUK 8:22–8:25; MAT 10:29–10:30; ACT 17:26**His will is perfect****GEN 18:25** See also EXO 33:19; DEU 32:4; JOB 8:3; PSA 119:137; DAN 4:37**God's predestined purposes cannot be thwarted****Human beings cannot stand against his will****ROM 9:19–9:21** See also PSA 2:1–2:4; PRO 19:21; PRO 21:30; ISA 14:24–14:27; ISA 46:10–46:12; DAN 4:35**False gods are impotent before him****PSA 115:3–115:8** See also ISA 44:8–44:20; ISA 45:20; ISA 48:14**He brings good out of evil****GEN 50:20** See also GEN 15:13–15:16; GEN 45:4–45:8**Predestination undergirds biblical prophecy****It explains the prophets' confidence****1KI 22:17–22:28** See also 1PE 1:10–1:12**It is demonstrated in the fulfilment of prophecy****1KI 22:29–22:38** See also MAT 1:22; MAT 2:15; MAT 2:23; MAT 4:14; MAT 8:17; MAT 12:17–12:19; ACT 2:17–2:25; ACT 3:22–3:25; ACT 13:27–13:30; ACT 15:15–15:18**The life and ministry of Jesus Christ was predestined****In that it was predicted by the prophets****ISA 9:6–9:7** See also ISA 11:1–11:10; ISA 52:13–53:12; JER 23:5–23:6; ACT 3:18; GAL 4:4–4:5**In his sufferings and death****ACT 2:23** See also MAT 16:21; LUK 18:31–18:32; LUK 22:22; LUK 24:25–24:27; LUK 24:44–24:45; JHN 13:1; ACT 4:27–4:30**In the outcome it achieved****GEN 3:15****God's purpose in predestination is to bless his people****In the path their lives follow****ROM 8:28** See also PSA 139:14–139:16; JER 29:11; MAT 10:29–10:31 parallel LUK 12:6–12:7**In their salvation****ROM 8:29–8:30** See also GEN 12:1–12:3; MAT 11:25–11:27; MRK 4:11; JHN 6:37–6:44; ACT 13:48; 1TH 5:9**In their assurance of salvation****ROM 8:31–8:39** See also JHN 10:27–10:29; JHN 17:2; EPH 1:3–1:14 Predestination is basic to Christian certainty.**Regarding final perseverance****PHP 1:6** See also PSA 138:8; JHN 6:37–6:40; PHP 2:12–2:13; JAS 5:11**Regarding God's call to righteousness****EPH 2:10** See also JER 1:4–1:5; ACT 22:10; GAL 1:15–1:17**Regarding future inheritance****JHN 14:2–14:3** See also MAT 25:34; ROM 8:30**God predestines judgment****ISA 65:11–65:12** See also GEN 6:17 the flood; EXO 7:13; EXO 9:13–9:18; JOS 11:20; 2KI 19:25–19:26; ISA 14:24–14:27 judgment on Assyria; ISA 19:12–19:14; ISA 23:9 judgment

on Tyre; JER 49:20, JER 50:45 judgment on Babylon; 1PE 2:6–2:8; ISA 8:14–8:15

Predestination does not set aside human responsibility

PHP 2:12–2:13 See also JHN 6:37, JHN 6:40; ACT 13:48

6710: privileges

Spiritual and material benefits conferred upon people by God. They are given, not because of human merit, but because of God's graciousness, and therefore carry responsibilities with them.

Privileges as the gift of God, not the result of human merit

1CO 4:7 See also LUK 1:26–1:38; EPH 2:8–2:9; PHP 3:4–3:9

The privileged position of humanity in creation

PSA 8:3–8:6 See also GEN 1:26–1:28

The privileged position of Israel

ROM 9:4–9:5 See also DEU 7:7–7:9; 2SA 7:22–7:24; ROM 11:1–11:12

The privileged position of the believer

The privilege of forgiveness and new life

EPH 1:3–1:8 See also 2CO 5:17–5:21; EPH 2:3–2:9; COL 1:13–1:14

The privilege of access to God

EPH 2:18 See also ROM 5:1–5:2; HEB 10:19–10:22, HEB 12:18–12:24

The privilege of knowing God

JHN 17:3 See also JHN 12:44–12:46, JHN 14:6–14:7

The privilege of being God's children

GAL 4:4–4:7 See also ROM 8:14–8:17; GAL 3:26–3:29; HEB 12:5–12:11

The privilege of becoming God's people

1PE 2:9–2:10 See also EPH 2:19–2:22

The privilege of receiving divine insights

LUK 10:23–10:24 See also MAT 13:10–13:17 parallels MRK 4:10–4:12, LUK 8:9–8:10; JHN 15:15; 1CO 2:6–2:12; 1PE 1:10–1:12

The privilege of being called to serve God

JER 1:5 See also 2SA 7:18–7:21; JHN 15:15–15:16; 1CO 15:8–15:10

The privilege of giving

1CH 29:14–29:16 See also ACT 20:33–20:35; 2CO 8:1–8:15, 2CO 9:6–9:11

Privileges bring responsibilities

1CO 4:1–4:2 See also MAT 24:45–24:51 parallel LUK 12:42–12:48; 1CO 6:19–6:20; HEB 13:17

Privileges can be abused

1SA 2:12–2:17 Eli's sons; ; 2SA 11:1–11:4 King David; ; 1KI 21:1–21:16 King Ahab; ; ACT 16:35–16:39 magistrates in Philippi; ; ACT 23:1–23:3 Ananias, the high priest

Privileges can be withdrawn

MAT 21:33–21:43 parallels MRK 12:1–12:9, LUK 20:9–20:16 parable of the tenants; ; MAT 25:14–25:30 parable of the talents; ; LUK 19:12–19:27 parable of the ten minas

6712: propitiation

The satisfaction of the righteous demands of God in relation to human sin and its punishment through the sacrificial death of Jesus Christ upon the cross, by which the penalty of sin is cancelled and the anger of God averted. [The NIV is distinctive at this point, in that it generally translates this term by "atonement" and related words.].

The need for propitiation: God's anger against sin

PSA 7:11; ROM 2:5 See also EXO 32:11–32:14; NUM 32:8–32:15; DEU 6:14–6:15; 2KI 23:26; PSA 78:38; ISA 30:27–30:31; DAN 9:16–9:19; HOS 11:8–11:9; MAT 25:41–25:46; JHN 3:36; ROM 1:18; EPH 5:6

The provision of propitiation: Jesus Christ the atoning sacrifice

The promise in the OT

ISA 53:5–53:6 See also ISA 53:10–53:12

The fulfilment in the NT

ROM 3:21–3:26 See also ROM 5:9–5:10; COL 1:21–1:22; HEB 2:17, HEB 9:11–9:14; 1JN 2:2

The motivation for propitiation: God's love

1JN 4:10 See also PSA 85:2–85:3, PSA 103:8–103:12; MIC 7:18–7:19; ROM 5:6–5:8; 2CO 5:19

6714: ransom

The price paid for redemption, that is, for setting something or someone free from some form of obligation or captivity.

Ransom paid for what has been devoted to the Lord

EXO 13:12–13:13, EXO 30:11–30:16, EXO 34:20; ; LEV 27:1–27:33; ; NUM 3:40–3:51, NUM 18:14–18:17

Ransom of a person's life instead of punishment **EXO 21:28–21:32**

Ransom from poverty and misfortune, including widowhood

See also LEV 25:25–25:28, LEV 25:47–25:55; RUT 4:1–4:13; PRO 13:8

Limitations on ransom payments

NUM 35:31–35:32 See also LEV 27:29

Paying a ransom to God

PSA 49:7–49:8 See also EXO 30:12–30:16; JOB 33:24

Promises of redemption for the Lord's ransomed people

ISA 51:11 parallel ISA 35:10 See also ISA 40:2, ISA 43:3–43:5; JER 31:11; HOS 13:14

The death of Jesus Christ seen as a ransom

MRK 10:45 parallel MAT 20:28 See also ACT 20:28; 1TI 2:5–2:6; TIT 2:14; HEB 9:15; 2PE 2:1

The priceless value of the ransom of Jesus Christ

1CO 6:19–6:20 See also 1CO 7:23; 1PE 1:18–1:19; REV 5:9

6716: reconciliation

The restoration of fellowship between God and humanity and the resulting restoration of human relationships. The NT affirms that the reconciliation of the world to God is only possible on the basis of the work of Jesus Christ.

6717: reconciliation, of the world to God

On account of sin, people are alienated from God and cut off from fellowship with him. Through Jesus Christ, God reconciles the world to himself, breaking down the barriers of hostility and estrangement.

A broken relationship through sin brings alienation from God

ISA 59:2 See also GEN 3:23–3:24 the expulsion from Eden; GEN 4:13–4:14 Cain's alienation from God; ISA 48:22, ISA 64:7; JER 33:5; LUK 18:13 the tax collector's prayer for mercy; ROM 5:10, ROM 8:7; EPH 2:1–2:3, EPH 2:12, EPH 4:18; COL 1:21; JAS 4:4

God takes the initiative in bringing about reconciliation

2CO 5:18–5:19 See also ROM 5:6–5:8; GAL 4:4–4:5; EPH 2:4–2:5; 1JN 4:10

The means of reconciliation is the death of Jesus Christ

ROM 5:6 See also 2CO 5:18–5:19, 2CO 5:21; EPH 2:13, EPH 2:16; COL 1:20

The results of reconciliation are both personal and universal

Peace with God

ROM 5:1 See also ACT 10:36–10:46; EPH 2:14–2:19; COL 1:21–1:22

Access to God

ROM 5:2 See also EPH 2:18, EPH 3:12; HEB 10:19–10:22

Adoption as God's children

ROM 8:15–8:16; ; GAL 3:26, GAL 4:4–4:6; ; 1JN 3:1–3:2

Peacemaking throughout the universe

COL 1:20 See also ROM 11:15; EPH 1:7–1:10, EPH 1:22–1:23

Believers are to be the ambassadors of reconciliation

2CO 5:18–5:20

6718: reconciliation, between believers

True reconciliation between people is only possible after they have been reconciled to God through Jesus Christ. Believers are urged to settle differences among themselves in brotherly love.

The cause of the breakdown in relationships is sin

GEN 27:41 GEN 37:4–37:5, GEN 37:18–37:20; 1SA 15:12–15:14 Samuel and Saul; ; 2SA 14:28 Absalom and David; ; ACT 15:37–15:40 Paul and Barnabas; ; GAL 2:11 Paul opposes Peter

Believers should be reconciled to one another

MAT 5:23–5:24 See also MAT 5:9, MAT 5:25 parallel LUK 12:58; MAT 5:44, MAT 18:15–18:17, MAT 18:21–18:35; JHN 17:20–17:23; ROM 12:18–12:21; 2TH 3:14–3:15

The death of Jesus Christ should bring believers together in peace

EPH 2:14–2:22

The church should display reconciliation

COL 3:12–3:15 See also ROM 12:18–12:21; EPH 4:32; 2TH 3:14–3:15

Examples of reconciliation between people

GEN 33:4 See also GEN 45:1–45:5 Joseph and his brothers; JOS 22:10–22:34 Israel, Reuben and Gad; LUK 23:12 Herod and Pilate; JHN 21:15–21:17 Jesus Christ and Peter; ACT 9:26–9:28 Paul and the apostles; 1CO 7:11 a wife and her husband

6720: redemption

The buying back or release of an object or person. In Scripture redemption refers to God's ransoming of

believers only through the death of Jesus Christ upon the cross and to all the benefits that this brings.

6721: redemption, in everyday life

The purchase of a person's freedom or the buying back of an object from the possession of another. Scripture provides illustrations of these everyday meanings of the word.

The OT redemption of property, animals and individuals

Redemption of property

LEV 25:24–25:28 See also LEV 27:15–27:20; RUT 4:1–4:6; JER 32:8

Redemption of animals

EXO 13:13 See also EXO 34:20; LEV 27:13, LEV 27:27; NUM 18:14–18:17

Redemption of individuals

EXO 30:12–30:16 See also EXO 13:12–13:13, EXO 21:8, EXO 21:28–21:32, EXO 34:19–34:20; LEV 25:47–25:55; NUM 3:44–3:51

The redemption of the nation of Israel

EXO 6:6 See also DEU 9:26; 2SA 7:23–7:24 parallel 1CH 17:21–17:22; NEH 1:10; PSA 77:15, PSA 78:35, PSA 106:10; ISA 43:1–43:3; MIC 6:4

Redemption as release from sin

PSA 130:8 See also ISA 40:2

The role of the redeemer

In helping close relatives regain property or freedom

LEV 25:25 See also LEV 25:47–25:49, LEV 27:15–27:20; RUT 2:20, RUT 3:9, RUT 4:1–4:8

In avenging death

NUM 35:12, NUM 35:19–35:21

6722: redemption, in OT

The act of God by which he delivered his people from bondage. The exodus of Israel from Egypt and the later deliverance of Jerusalem from exile in Babylon are seen as definitive examples of God's redeeming acts.

God is the Redeemer of his people

God redeems his people from captivity out of love

DEU 7:8 See also EXO 6:6–6:8, EXO 15:13; PSA 130:7–130:8; ISA 43:14, ISA 47:1–47:4, ISA 63:16; JER 15:21, JER 31:11, JER 50:34

His redemption guarantees security

ISA 43:1–43:4 See also ISA 44:21–44:28, ISA 48:20, ISA 49:7, ISA 49:22–49:26, ISA 52:9–52:12

He redeems from death

PSA 49:15 See also JOB 5:20, JOB 19:25–19:26; HOS 13:14

His redemption is associated with his holiness

ISA 41:14 See also ISA 43:14, ISA 47:4, ISA 48:17, ISA 49:7, ISA 54:5

He redeems by his mighty arm

LUK 1:51 See also DEU 11:2; PSA 89:10, PSA 77:15; ISA 62:8

6723: redemption, in NT

The culmination of the OT work of redemption is seen in the cross of Jesus Christ, by which believers are liberated from bondage to sin.

Redemption is achieved through Jesus Christ

EPH 1:7

Jesus Christ's teaching on redemption

MRK 10:45 parallel MAT 20:28 See also MAT 26:26–26:28 parallels MRK 14:22–14:25, LUK 22:20–22:22

Apostolic teaching on redemption

Jesus Christ is the redemption of believers

1CO 1:30 See also 1TI 2:6; TIT 2:14

Redemption comes through the shedding of the blood of Jesus Christ

GAL 3:13 See also ACT 20:28; ROM 3:25; 1CO 6:20, 1CO 7:23, 1CO 11:23–11:25; 1PE 1:18–1:19; HEB 9:12; REV 1:5–1:6, REV 5:9

The results of redemption

Forgiveness of sin

COL 1:13–1:14

Justification and freedom from the law

GAL 3:8–3:10 See also ROM 3:23–3:25; GAL 4:5

Inclusion in the covenant

GAL 3:14 See also HEB 9:15

Freedom to live a new life

GAL 4:4–4:7 See also 1CO 6:19–6:20, 1CO 7:22–7:24; COL 1:13; TIT 2:14; HEB 9:14; REV 1:5–1:6, REV 5:9–5:10

Creation and believers await final redemption

ROM 8:19–8:23 See also LUK 21:28; ACT 3:21; EPH 1:14, EPH 4:30

6724: redeemer, God as

See [1315: God, as redeemer](#)

6725: redeemer, Jesus Christ as

See [2321: Jesus Christ, as redeemer](#)

6728: regeneration

The radical renewal of a person's inner being by the work of God's Spirit.

The need for regeneration

JHN 3:3 See also EPH 2:1, EPH 2:5; COL 2:13

Regeneration is a work of God

It originates in God the Father

JHN 1:12–1:13 Regeneration cannot be controlled by human actions or rituals; it is an act of God's sovereign will.

It is made possible by the resurrection of Jesus Christ

1PE 1:3 See also EPH 2:4–2:5

It occurs through the hearing of the Christian gospel

JAS 1:18 See also 1PE 1:23–1:25 The "word of God" is the good news about Jesus Christ.

It is effected by God's Spirit

JHN 3:5–3:8 See also JHN 6:63; TIT 3:5

Regeneration is given to those who believe in Jesus Christ

1JN 5:1

Baptism is the sign of regeneration

JHN 3:5 Water here is seen by some, though not all, interpreters as a reference to baptism, administered by the church to new converts as a sign of their new birth and their entry into the Christian community. See also ACT 2:38–2:39; EPH 5:25–5:26; TIT 3:5

The results of regeneration

Entry into God's kingdom

JHN 3:5

A new holiness of life

1JN 3:9 See also 1JN 5:18; 1PE 2:1–2:2

Love for other people

1JN 4:7 See also 1JN 5:2

Victory over the world's sinful pattern of life

1JN 5:4

6730: reinstatement

Restoration to a previous state or position. It is demonstrated in human relationships and also by God in his love and grace restoring fallen humanity and lifting up his people to their former place within his service.

The basis of reinstatement

God does not remember sin

See also PSA 103:12; ISA 38:17, ISA 43:25; EZK 20:44

God's unfailing love

PSA 89:28; ; LAM 3:22; ; HOS 11:8

God's reinstatement of fallen humanity

Humanity's unique calling

HEB 2:6–2:8 See also PSA 8:4–8:6; GEN 1:26–1:27; ISA 43:7

Humanity's fall and reinstatement

ROM 3:23–3:24; 2TH 2:14 See also ROM 5:15–5:19, ROM 8:17; EPH 1:12; HEB 2:10; 1PE 5:1

God's reinstatement of Israel

The promise of reinstatement

MIC 4:8 See also ISA 1:26, ISA 60:10; HAG 2:9; ZEC 1:17, ZEC 10:6–10:8

Reinstatement as God's people

HOS 2:23 See also ROM 9:25; 1PE 2:10

Reinstatement as God's bride

ISA 54:5–54:8 See also JER 3:12–3:14; HOS 2:14–2:20

Reinstatement in the land

JER 33:10–33:16 See also 2CH 30:9; JER 31:16–31:17; HOS 11:10–11:11

God's reinstatement of his servants

JDG 16:22 Samson's hair begins to grow again, indicating his renewed call to serve God; ; JER 15:19 God will continue to speak through a repentant Jeremiah; ; DAN 4:34–4:36 Nebuchadnezzar's sanity and kingdom is restored; ; JON 3:1–3:2 God renews Jonah's commission; ; JHN 21:15–21:17 Jesus Christ reinstates Peter after his denial.

Further examples of reinstatement

GEN 40:13 Pharaoh's cupbearer reinstated; ; 1SA 19:6–19:7 David reinstated by Saul; ; 2SA 9:7 Mephibosheth reinstated by David; ; 2SA 14:33 Absalom reinstated by David; ; DAN 3:30 Nebuchadnezzar reinstates Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; ; HOS 3:2–3:3 Gomer reinstated as Hosea's wife; ; LUK 15:22–15:24 the prodigal reinstated by his father; ; PHM 1:10 Paul asks Philemon to reinstate his slave Onesimus; ; PHM 1:24 John Mark, formerly rejected, has here been reinstated as Paul's companion.

6732: repentance

A change of mind leading to a change of action. It involves a sincere turning from sin to serve God and

includes sorrow for, and confession of, sin and where possible restitution. At points, Scripture refers to God changing his plans in response to events.

6733: repentance, nature of

Scripture stresses the necessity of repentance from sin if individuals and communities are to have full fellowship with God. It also uses the term to refer to God's relenting of sending judgment on his people, usually in response to human repentance.

Repentance is a requirement for fellowship with God

2KI 17:13; 1TH 1:9 See also PSA 34:14; ISA 55:7; ACT 14:15; JAS 4:7-4:10

Repentance involves turning from sin

Sorrow for sin

PSA 51:17; 2CO 7:8-7:10 See also JOB 42:6; PSA 34:18; ISA 57:15; ISA 66:2; JOL 2:12-2:13; LUK 18:13

Confession of sin

LUK 15:17-15:19 See also LEV 5:5; PSA 51:1-51:3; PRO 28:13; HOS 14:1-14:2

Forsaking specific sins

EZR 10:10-10:11; ; EZK 14:6; ; ACT 15:19-15:20

Making appropriate restitution

NUM 5:6-5:7; ; LUK 19:8

Repentance involves turning to God

Faith in God

ISA 30:15 See also LUK 22:32; ACT 11:21, ACT 20:21, ACT 26:18

Obedience

EZK 18:21-18:23 See also MAL 3:7-3:10

Repentance demonstrated by actions

ACT 26:20 See also ISA 1:16-1:17; DAN 4:27; MAT 3:8 parallel LUK 3:8; LUK 3:10-3:14

Repentance must be sincere

JER 3:10, JER 24:7 See also 1KI 8:46-8:50 parallel 2CH 6:36-6:39; PSA 78:34-78:37; HOS 6:1-6:4

The repentance of God

JER 26:3 See also EXO 32:14; PSA 106:45; HOS 11:8; JOL 2:13; AMO 7:1-7:6

6734: repentance, importance of

Repentance is of central importance because sin brings God's judgment and fellowship with God is only possible through full and sincere repentance. God, through his servants, calls people to repent as the only

way to escape the judgment and receive the forgiveness and restoration which he offers.

The call to repentance

LUK 5:32; JAS 5:19-5:20 See also JER 25:4-25:6; EZK 33:7-33:9; MRK 1:4 parallel LUK 3:3; LUK 24:47; 2TI 2:24-2:26

Repentance opens the way for blessing

It is the only way to escape God's judgment

EZK 18:30-18:32 See also JOB 36:12; JER 18:7-18:8, JER 26:3; HOS 11:5; JON 3:10; LUK 3:8-3:9; REV 2:5

It prepares the way for God's kingdom

MAT 4:17 parallel MRK 1:14-1:15 See also MAT 3:2

It brings forgiveness and restoration

2CH 7:13-7:14; ISA 55:7 See also DEU 30:1-30:10; NEH 1:8-1:9; JOB 22:23-22:25, JOB 36:10-36:11; ISA 44:22; ACT 2:38-2:39, ACT 3:19, ACT 5:31, ACT 11:18

God desires that all people should repent

He wants everyone to be saved

EZK 18:23

His patience with the unrepentant

2PE 3:9 See also ISA 65:2; ROM 2:4; REV 2:21

His discipline encourages repentance

JER 31:18-31:20 See also ISA 10:20-10:21, ISA 19:22; HOS 2:6-2:7, HOS 6:1

Taking God's opportunity for repentance

ISA 55:6; ACT 17:30-17:31 See also HEB 3:13-3:15, HEB 4:7; PSA 95:7-95:8

Refusing God's opportunity for repentance

Examples of those who refuse to repent

JER 35:15 See also JER 5:3; MAT 11:20, MAT 21:32; REV 9:20-9:21, REV 16:9-16:11

God confirms those who refuse to repent in their hardness of heart

MAT 13:14-13:15 parallels MRK 4:11-4:12, LUK 8:9-8:10; ; ACT 28:25-28:27; ; ISA 6:10

Repentance may not remove the effects of human sin

NUM 14:39-14:45 The Israelites' repentance could not prevent the wandering that resulted from their refusal to enter the promised land; ; 1SA 15:24-15:26 Saul's repentance is too late to escape God's judgment on his kingship; ; 2SA 12:13-12:14 Despite David's repentance the son of his adulterous relationship with Bathsheba still died; ; HEB 12:16-12:17 Esau's repentance could not bring back the birthright he had sold to Jacob.

6735: repentance, examples of

Scripture provides examples to illustrate the importance of repentance for individuals and communities.

The repentance of individuals

The call to personal repentance

ACT 2:38 See also 2TI 2:19

Examples of individual repentance

NUM 22:31–22:35 Balaam; ; 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8 David, after taking a census; ; 1KI 21:27–21:29 Ahab; ; 2KI 22:19 Josiah; ; JOB 42:6 Job; ; PSA 51:1–51:17 David, following his adultery with Bathsheba; ; LUK 15:21 the prodigal son; ; LUK 18:13 the tax collector in the temple; ; MAT 26:75 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:61–22:62 Peter's sorrow after denying Jesus Christ; ; JHN 21:15–21:17 Peter's confession and reinstatement; ; ACT 8:22–8:24 Simon the sorcerer's repentance may not have been genuine.

Corporate repentance

Examples of corporate repentance

JER 18:7–18:8; MAT 3:1–3:6 parallels MRK 1:1–1:6, LUK 3:1–3:6 See also NUM 21:7 Israel in the desert; JDG 10:15–10:16 Israel in the time of the judges; 1SA 7:3–7:4 Israel, after asking for a king; ISA 19:22 Egypt turns to God in repentance; ACT 9:32–9:35 the people of Lydda and Sharon

Leaders encouraged corporate repentance

EZR 10:1 See also 2KI 23:1–23:7 Josiah leads Judah in repentance; 2CH 15:8–15:15 Asa leads Judah in repentance; 2CH 30:6–30:9 Hezekiah leads Israel and Judah in repentance; EZR 10:10–10:12 Following the exile, Ezra leads the Israelites in repentance; JON 3:6–3:8 The king of Nineveh leads the people in repentance.

Corporate repentance within the church

REV 2:4–2:5 See also 2CO 7:9–7:11; REV 2:14–2:16, REV 2:20–2:22, REV 3:3, REV 3:19–3:20

Symbols of repentance

1KI 21:27; JON 3:5 See also 1SA 7:6; EZR 8:21; NEH 9:1; JER 36:9; JOL 1:13–1:14, JOL 2:12

6736: repentance, of God

See [1120: God, repentance of](#)

6738: rescue

Deliverance from people or forces that are overwhelming. It implies a liberator with strength and wisdom to ensure true freedom. God's physical rescue of the Israelites points to the spiritual deliverance obtained by Jesus Christ.

When rescue is the only answer

PSA 35:10 See also DEU 22:27, DEU 28:29; 1SA 12:21; ISA 42:22; DAN 8:4, DAN 8:7; HOS 5:14; MIC 5:8; ROM 7:24

God's power to rescue in times of need

ISA 41:10; ; 1CO 10:13; ; 2CO 12:9–12:10; ; HEB 13:6

God's people cry to him for rescue

JDG 10:15 See also 1SA 7:8; PSA 22:11, PSA 35:17, PSA 43:1, PSA 69:13–69:14, PSA 71:2, PSA 107:19, PSA 140:1, PSA 142:6, PSA 143:9, PSA 144:7; PRO 24:11; ROM 15:31 Paul's need for protection

God's physical rescue of his people

From their enemies

EXO 3:8 See also JDG 6:14 EXO 18:10; 1SA 11:13; 2SA 22:17–22:20 parallel PSA 18:16–18:19; 2KI 13:5; 1CH 11:14; 2CH 20:15, 2CH 32:22; NEH 9:27; EST 4:14; JER 20:13 2CH 20:29 Israel's enemies recognise God's rescue of his people.

From trouble

DAN 6:27 See also GEN 45:7; JOB 5:19; PSA 32:7, PSA 91:14–91:15, PSA 126:1; PRO 11:8; JOL 2:32; JON 2:10; 2PE 2:9

From oppression

PSA 72:12–72:14, PSA 82:3–82:4

God's spiritual rescue of believers

From the guilt, penalty and power of sin

ISA 61:1 See also LUK 4:18; JER 29:11–29:14; ROM 8:21; 1TH 1:10; JUD 1:24

From the dominion of Satan

COL 1:13 See also MAT 6:13; LUK 1:74, LUK 9:1, LUK 11:21–11:22, LUK 13:16

From spiritual attack

2TI 4:18

From fear and the fear of death

HEB 2:14–2:15 See also PSA 34:4; 1CO 15:54–15:57; 2CO 1:10; REV 2:10

Rescuers sent by God

ACT 7:34 Moses; JDG 3:9, JDG 3:15, JDG 10:1

Examples of people rescued

ACT 7:10 Joseph; ; JER 38:6–38:13 Jeremiah; DAN 3:17, DAN 3:28, DAN 6:21–6:23, DAN 6:27; ACT 12:11 Peter; ACT 23:27, ACT 26:17; ; 2TI 3:11

6740: returning to God

Scripture declares that all humanity has turned away from God, and must return to him. The term “repent-

tance” is often used to refer to this process of returning to God and the inward and outward changes that it demands of people. Scripture also indicates that believers can wander away from God; they too must return to him.

All people have turned away from God

ISA 53:6, ISA 64:6 See also JOB 25:4; JER 17:9; JHN 3:19; ROM 3:23

Wayward people must return to God

ISA 44:22; HOS 14:1; ZEC 1:3 See also 2CH 30:9; NEH 1:9; JOB 22:23; JER 24:7; LAM 3:40; HOS 6:1, HOS 12:6; JOL 2:12

Means of returning to God

Realisation of estrangement from God

LAM 3:40 See also ISA 24:5; 2SA 24:10; 2CH 6:29–6:31; ROM 3:20

Acknowledgment of sin

PSA 51:3 See also EXO 9:27; NUM 14:39–14:40, NUM 22:34; JOS 7:20; ISA 15:24–15:25; MAT 27:3–27:4

Sorrow for sin

PSA 38:18 See also PSA 51:1–51:2; 2CO 7:9–7:10

A sense of guilt for sin

2SA 24:10 See also EZR 9:5–9:6; PSA 38:1–38:4, PSA 38:17–38:18, PSA 51:3; ACT 2:37–2:38

Repentance

ISA 1:27; ACT 2:37–2:38 See also ISA 59:20

A parable of returning to God

LUK 15:11–15:24

Examples of people returning to God

Israelites: JDG 10:15; ; 2CH 15:4; 2SA 12:13–12:14 David; ; JON 3:5–3:10 the people of Nineveh

6742: sackcloth and ashes

Sackcloth is a coarse, black cloth made from goat’s hair that was worn together with the burnt ashes of wood as a sign of mourning for personal and national disaster, as a sign of repentance and at times of prayer for deliverance.

Sackcloth and ashes worn as a sign of mourning for the dead

By Jacob for Joseph
GEN 37:34

By David, Joab and the people for Abner
See also 2SA 3:31

Sackcloth and ashes worn as a sign of mourning for personal or national disaster

JOB 16:15, JOB 42:6 See also EST 4:1; LAM 2:10; JOL 1:8

Sackcloth and ashes worn as a sign of repentance for sin

By Ahab
1KI 21:27

By David and the elders
See also 1CH 21:16

By the Israelites
NEH 9:1

By the Ninevites and their king

See also JON 3:5–3:9 Even the animals were to wear sackcloth.

By others

ISA 15:3; ; JER 49:3; ; EZK 27:31; ; MAT 11:21 parallel LUK 10:13

Sackcloth and ashes worn at times of prayer for deliverance

By Hezekiah and his companions
2KI 19:1–19:2

By Daniel
DAN 9:3

Sackcloth was worn in many different ways

See also 1KI 20:31; 2KI 6:30; ISA 3:24, ISA 58:5; JOL 1:13

Sackcloth used figuratively

ISA 50:3

6744: sanctification

The process of becoming consecrated to God, which is an integral aspect of being a member of the people of God. This process of being made holy through the work of the Holy Spirit ultimately rests upon the sacrificial death of Jesus Christ, which the OT anticipates and foreshadows.

6745: sanctification, nature and basis of

The process of renewal and consecration by which believers are made holy through the work of the Holy Spirit. Sanctification is the consequence of justification and is dependent upon a person being in a right relationship with God.

Sanctification is grounded in the holiness of God

God is holy

EZK 39:7 See also LEV 22:32; JOS 24:19; PSA 30:4; HOS 11:9; ISA 6:3; REV 6:10

God demands that his people should reflect his holiness

LEV 19:2 See also LEV 11:44–11:45; LEV 20:7–20:8; HEB 2:11; 1PE 1:15–1:16

Sanctification is the will of God for his people

1TH 4:3 See also EPH 1:4; EPH 2:10; 2TH 2:13; 1PE 1:1–1:2

The basis for sanctification

God's election of his people

1CO 1:2; ; EPH 1:4–1:11; ; 1TH 5:9

The atoning death of Jesus Christ

HEB 13:12 See also ROM 6:11; ROM 7:4; ROM 8:2; 1CO 1:30; 1CO 6:11; EPH 5:25–5:27; HEB 10:10–10:14; 1PE 2:5

The grace of God

LUK 1:69–1:75; ; PHP 2:13; ; 2TI 1:9; ; HEB 12:10

The work of the Holy Spirit

ROM 15:16; ; 2TH 2:13; ; 1PE 1:2

The word of God

JHN 17:17; ; EPH 5:25–5:26; ; 2TI 3:16

The need for sanctification

The universal sinfulness of humanity

ISA 64:6 See also JOB 15:14–15:15; PSA 51:5; ROM 5:12–5:19; EPH 2:3

Enslavement to evil can only be broken through the death of Jesus Christ

JHN 8:34–8:36 See also ROM 6:16–6:18; ROM 8:5–8:7; EPH 4:17–4:24

The need for renewal and growth

2PE 3:18 See also ROM 12:1–12:2; COL 1:10; 1TH 4:3–4:6; HEB 6:1–6:3

The nature of sanctification

A process which has already been initiated

1CO 1:2; 1CO 6:11

A process of growth in holiness

ROM 12:1–12:3; ; 2CO 3:18; ; EPH 4:15; ; 1TH 4:3–4:7; ; HEB 12:14; ; 1PE 2:1–2:3; ; 2PE 3:18

Consecration to God

EXO 32:29; ; 1CH 29:5; ; PRO 23:26; ; ROM 12:1

6746: sanctification, means and results of

Sanctification results from the renewing work of the Holy Spirit and leads to the renewal of believers and their being equipped for ministry in the world.

The means of sanctification

The work of the Holy Spirit

1CO 6:11 See also ROM 8:9–8:11; ROM 15:15–15:16; 1CO 12:13; 2CO 1:21–1:22; EPH 1:13–1:14; 2TH 2:13; TIT 3:4–3:7; 1PE 1:1–1:2

Meditation on the Scriptures

1PE 2:2–2:3 See also DEU 11:18; PSA 119:12–119:18; PSA 119:48; PSA 143:5–143:6; JHN 17:17; COL 3:16; JAS 1:25

The active pursuit of holiness and righteousness

1TI 6:11–6:12 See also 2CO 7:1; GAL 5:24; EPH 4:1; 1TH 5:22; 1PE 2:9–2:12; 3JN 1:11

Obedience and self-denial

ROM 6:19–6:22; ROM 8:5–8:14; ; GAL 2:20; GAL 5:16–5:24; ; 1PE 2:11

Prayer

PSA 145:18 See also MAT 7:7–7:8; ACT 4:31; 1TI 4:4; JAS 5:16; JUD 1:20

Confession of sin

1JN 1:9 See also NEH 1:6–1:9; PSA 32:5; PSA 40:11–40:12; PRO 28:13; ISA 64:5–64:7; JER 14:20–14:22; LAM 3:40

Obstacles to sanctification

A lack of faith

MAT 5:13; ; JHN 15:6; ; 2CO 12:20–12:21; ; 1TI 1:18–1:19

Rebellion against God

EZK 18:24 See also DEU 32:15–32:18; JOB 34:26; ISA 65:11–65:12; GAL 1:6–1:7; GAL 5:7–5:9; HEB 12:15; REV 2:4–2:5

Satanic temptation

1PE 5:8–5:9 See also ACT 5:3; 2CO 2:8–2:11; JAS 4:7

Self-indulgence and greed

LUK 12:15 See also LUK 21:34; ROM 13:13; 2CO 12:21; EPH 4:19

Yielding to sinful desires

1PE 1:14 See also MRK 4:18–4:19; 1CO 10:6–10:8; 1PE 2:11; 2PE 2:14–2:18; 1JN 2:16–2:17

The results of sanctification

Good works

2CO 9:8 See also EPH 2:10; COL 1:10; COL 3:15–3:17; 2TH 2:16–2:17; HEB 10:24–10:25; JAS 2:14–2:26

Becoming like Jesus Christ

1PE 2:21 See also JHN 13:15; ROM 8:28–8:30; 1CO 11:1; 2CO 3:18; GAL 3:27; 1JN 3:2–3:3

Becoming like God

MAT 5:48; ; EPH 5:1–5:2; ; COL 1:21–1:22

Perfection

MAT 5:48 See also 2CO 13:11; COL 1:28

Blamelessness in the sight of God

2PE 3:14 See also EPH 1:4; COL 1:21–1:22; 1TH 5:23

Being able to see God

HEB 12:14

6747: sanctification, and Holy Spirit

See [3233: Holy Spirit, and sanctification](#)

6750: sin-bearer

A person or animal that acts in God's sight in a substitutionary capacity, to whom are transferred the sins of others, together with the corresponding penalty for those sins.

The principle of accountability necessitates a sin-bearer

All are held responsible for their own sin and its consequences

LEV 5:17 See also LEV 5:1, LEV 20:16–20:21, LEV 24:15–24:16; EZK 18:19–18:20

Individuals and nations come under God's judgment for their sin

EZK 4:4–4:6 Ezekiel's behaviour foreshadowed God's judgment on the sin of Israel and Judah. See also EZK 16:58, EZK 18:4; MAT 11:21–11:24 parallel LUK 10:12–10:15; ROM 1:18–1:32, ROM 6:23

God's gracious provision of a sin-bearer in the OT

God takes away the sin of those who repent

ISA 44:22 See also 2SA 12:13; PSA 103:12; ZEC 3:4

The sacrifice of an animal to remove sin

LEV 5:5–5:6 See also LEV 4:1–4:35, LEV 5:14–6:7

The Day of Atonement and the removal of sin

LEV 16:8–16:10 The sacrificial goat expiated the sins of the people in the sight of God; the driving away of the scapegoat into the desert symbolised the removal of the sin of the community. See also LEV 16:15–16:19 the sin offering; LEV 16:20–16:22 the scapegoat

The function of the priests in the sin-bearing process

The priests were responsible for the sanctuary

NUM 18:1–18:7

Strict regulations governed the performance of their service

LEV 22:9 See also EXO 28:42–28:43, EXO 30:17–30:21; LEV 16:3–16:4

The priests bore the sin of the people in a representative capacity

EXO 28:36–28:38 See also LEV 10:17

Jesus Christ as sin-bearer

Jesus Christ bore the sins of the world on the cross

HEB 9:28 See also ISA 53:4–53:6, ISA 53:10–53:12; JHN 1:29; COL 2:14; HEB 10:11–10:14; 1PE 2:24; 1JN 3:5

Jesus Christ's intercessory role as high priest

1JN 2:1 See also ROM 8:34; HEB 7:25

6752: substitution

Jesus Christ died as the substitute for sinful humanity, taking humanity's place on the cross.

OT images of substitution

Examples of substitution

GEN 22:13 See also NUM 3:12–3:13, NUM 3:41, NUM 3:45, NUM 8:18; 1SA 17:9; 1KI 20:42; LAM 5:7; EZK 4:4

Substitutes atoning for sin or acting as sin bearers

LEV 1:4 See also EXO 28:38; LEV 16:21–16:22, LEV 22:19–22:20

Anticipations of the substitutionary work of Jesus Christ

ISA 53:4–53:6 NT writers have interpreted the servant as Jesus Christ: see Mt 8:17 and 1Pe 2:23–25. See also PSA 69:9

The substitutionary work of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ died for believers

MRK 10:45; ROM 5:6, ROM 5:8; 1TH 5:10 See also JHN 10:11, JHN 11:50; ROM 14:15; 2CO 5:14; GAL 2:20, GAL 3:13; 1TI 2:6; TIT 2:14; HEB 2:9; 1PE 2:21; 1JN 3:16

Jesus Christ died for sin

1PE 2:24, 1PE 3:18 See also 2CO 5:21; HEB 9:28

Jesus Christ's substitution as an example

2CO 5:15 See also 1PE 2:21

Jesus Christ's substitution as an act of love

JHN 15:13 See also EXO 32:32; ROM 9:3

6754: union with Christ

The sharing of believers in the life of Jesus Christ by faith, allowing them to share in all the benefits and riches that result from his person and work.

6755: union with Christ, nature of

The nature of the union of Jesus Christ with believers is explained using a number of central images. The NT stresses the reality, closeness and considerable benefits of this union.

A covenantal relationship

OT background

ISA 54:5–54:8 The marriage covenant is used to illustrate the intimacy of the relationship between God and his people. See also JER 3:14, JER 31:32; HOS 2:7, HOS 2:16

In the NT

EPH 5:31–5:32

A relationship deepened through the incarnation

JHN 1:14 See also ROM 8:3; 2CO 5:21; GAL 4:4; PHP 2:7–2:8; 1TI 3:16; HEB 2:14–2:18

A relationship personally entered through faith

JHN 3:16 See also JHN 1:12, JHN 2:11, JHN 7:38; ACT 16:31; ROM 3:22, ROM 8:1, ROM 10:9–10:10; 2CO 5:17; GAL 2:16

A relationship enriched through the sacraments

Baptism

ROM 6:3–6:5; GAL 3:27 See also MAT 28:19; ROM 6:8; COL 2:11–2:12

The Lord's Supper

MAT 26:26–26:28 parallels MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:17–22:20; ; 1CO 10:16, 1CO 11:23–11:29

A relationship that affects every aspect of life

1CO 6:17 See also JHN 15:1–15:8, JHN 17:20–17:26; ROM 8:9–8:11; 1CO 6:19–6:20; GAL 2:20

It is a mysterious relationship

COL 1:27 See also EPH 5:32

6756: union with Christ, significance of

The union between Jesus Christ and believers is the basis for all exhortation to faithful, holy living, as well as to sharing in all his benefits.

For the believer

Identification with Jesus Christ

MAT 10:40 See also MAT 18:5, MAT 25:40; EPH 1:1; PHP 1:1

The experience of being in Christ

ROM 8:10; 2CO 5:17 See also JHN 14:20; 2CO 13:5; GAL 2:20; EPH 3:14–3:19; COL 1:27

Conformity to Jesus Christ

COL 3:1–3:4 See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; ROM 6:5; 1CO 6:15–6:17; 2CO 4:10; EPH 2:6; PHP 3:10–3:11; 1PE 4:13; 1JN 2:6, 1JN 2:28, 1JN 3:24, 1JN 5:20

Righteousness in Christ

ROM 4:23–4:25; 2CO 5:21 See also ROM 1:17; 1CO 1:30

Blessing in Christ

EPH 1:3–1:14

For the church

In persecution

ACT 9:3–9:5 See also ACT 22:6–22:8, ACT 26:14

In service

1CO 12:12 See also ROM 12:4–12:8; 1CO 12:27; EPH 1:22–1:23, EPH 5:28–5:30; COL 3:15